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National & States Affairs

News - 1

- Maharashtra – approved development of a ₹45 Cr Eco-Nature Park at Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary, Mumbai
  - It is India's first AI-powered bird detection & monitoring centre, as part of Bhandup Bird Park project
- District Planning Committee's special fund – allocated ₹45 Cr for this sanctuary
- Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary – declared a wildlife sanctuary in 2015, India's 1st dedicated flamingo sanctuary
  - It is also designated a Ramsar site
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma

News - 2

- Droupadi Murmu (India's 15th President) – completed 4 years in office on Jul 25, 2026
  - She became India's 1st tribal Head of State
- She launched a series of citizen-centric, sustainability-focused & heritage initiatives at Rashtrapati Bhavan & President's Estates
- Key initiatives include:
  - Launch of an application-based e-Audio Guide for visitors to Rashtrapati Bhavan
  - Launch of 3rd edition of e-Upahaar, featuring 300 curated Presidential gifts for public auction
- She also launched – 'Bachpan Bal Parisar', a new facility for children residing in President's Estate
  - It comprises 'Kilkari', a dedicated play zone & 'Samarth Anganwadi-cum-Palna'
- She also flagged off 'RAAHI', a fare-free, wheelchair-accessible, 27-seater electric bus service for staff & residents of President's Estate
  - RAAHI – Rashtrapati Bhavan Access & Heritage Interconnector
- C.P. Radhakrishnan (VP) – released 1st set of 5 commemorative books marking her 4 years in office

News - 3

- As per MHA: 12,000+ e-Zero FIRs have been registered against cyber financial fraud cases over past year
  - Across 18 states & UTs that have implemented this system | Delhi – topped list
- e-Zero FIR system – launched in May 2025
  - It allows victims of cyber financial fraud to report crimes directly online or through national helpline
- Highest number of e-Zero FIRs – Delhi (6,115) | Followed by – Chandigarh (4,174), Uttarakhand (552)
- 'Police' & 'Public Order' – State subjects under 7th Schedule of Constitution
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

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News - 4

- Department of Expenditure enforced a 'One Officer, One Official Car' policy for bureaucracy
  - To curb misuse of govt vehicles, reduce public expenditure & ensure more efficient use of govt resources
- An officer who has already been allotted an official vehicle will not be provided with a second government car
- Under existing rules, entitled officers may use their official cars for limited personal travel of up to 500 km per month
  - By paying a fixed fee of ₹3,000 per month & forfeiting their standard monthly transport allowance

News - 5

- Rajnath Singh – inaugurated Department of Military Medicine, at Command Hospital (Central Command), Lucknow, UP
  - Established under – Directorate General of Medical Services (Army)
- It complements proposed Global Military Medicine Centre, envisioned under Raksha Strategy Vision 2026-30
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 6

- MoPR – launched "DAANVEER" to strengthen digital infrastructure of Gram Panchayats across India
- Launched by – Vivek Bharadwaj (Secretary, MoPR)
- DAANVEER is developed in collaboration with – National Informatics Centre (NIC) & DigiHaat
- Minister of Panchayati Raj: Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lalan Singh) | Constituency – Munger, Bihar
  MoS in Ministry of Panchayati Raj: S. P. Singh Baghel

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News - 7

- I4C ordered GitHub to remove Bitchat, an open-source, Bluetooth-based, peer-to-peer messaging application
  - Citing – Section 79(3)(b) of Information Technology Act, 2000 & Rule 3(1)(d) of Information Technology Rules, 2021
- It directed GitHub to disable access to 3 Bitchat repositories within 3 hours
- Bitchat (created by Jack Dorsey) – uses Bluetooth Low Energy mesh networks to enable encrypted communication between nearby devices
- HQs of I4C – New Delhi | CEO – Rajesh Kumar

News - 8

- GoI aims to develop a total of 44 airports, including 4 hub airports, to provide seamless international air connectivity
- Presently, there is 1 hub airport (Delhi) & 2 spoke airports (Varanasi & Amritsar)
- This model is designed to enable seamless connectivity between Tier-II & Tier-III airports & international destinations
- Under this model, Air India introduced 'Easy Connect' flights
  - It enables travellers from cities beyond major hubs to check in, drop baggage & complete immigration formalities at their origin airport

Join us

News - 9

- MoHUA approved projects for 6 urban development initiatives in Ahmedabad | Worth – ₹2,719.80 Cr
  - Under Urban Challenge Fund (UCF), a flagship scheme initiated by PM Modi
- Approved projects include: ₹852.93 Cr – for rehabilitation of main sewerage network in West Ahmedabad
  - ₹551.35 Cr – for rehabilitation of main sewerage network in East Ahmedabad
  - ₹290.24 Cr – for rehabilitation of old sewerage networks in various parts of city
  - ₹215 Cr – for an Intelligent Water Management System
  - ₹479.25 Cr – for a 125 TPD (tonnes per day) Integrated Sludge Management Facility
  - ₹331.03 Cr – for an Integrated Transit Management System (ITMS) & Automated Fare Collection System (AFCS)
- Urban Challenge Fund – approved by Cabinet in Feb 2026
  - It is designed to facilitate a total investment of ₹4 lakh Cr in India's urban sector over next 5 years (FY26 to FY31)
  - UCF – a Centrally Sponsored Scheme with a total Central Assistance of ₹1 lakh Cr
- It includes a Credit Repayment Guarantee Sub-Scheme, providing a central guarantee of up to ₹7 Cr or 70% of loan amount
- Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs: Manohar Lal Khattar | Constituency – Karnal, Haryana
  MoS in Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs: Tokhan Sahu

News - 10

- SC – issued interim order barring posting, reposting, uploading, extraction, modification, dissemination or monetisation of audio-video recordings of court proceedings on social media & other digital platforms
  - Without prior permission of SG of Supreme Court or Registrar Generals of concerned High Courts
- It was issued by a 3-judge bench comprising CJI Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi & Justice V. Mohana
- Present CJI of Supreme Court – Justice Surya Kant (53rd) | Established on – Jan 26, 1950
  Retirement age: Chief Justices & Judges of HC – 62 years | CJI & judges of the SC – 65 years
  Sanctioned strength of judges in the SC – 38 (including CJI)

News - 11

- Kerala began integrating ANNAM.AI smart weather stations under its 100-day action plan for climate-smart agriculture
  - It marks state's rollout of a Centre of Excellence for AI in Agriculture initiative developed at IIT Ropar
- Punjab – 1st implementation location, where 100 AI-powered weather stations were deployed by Mar 30, 2026
- ANNAM.AI plans to train 10,000 students, rural youth & agriculture professionals in use of AI applications in agriculture
- ANNAM.AI + Syngenta = to focus on crop health monitoring, pest outbreak tracking & heat-stress management
  - During Bharat Innovates 2026 – held in France (in Jun 2026)
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

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News - 12

- Ladakh – declared 23 heritage sites as "Protected Monuments" under J&K Ancient Monuments Preservation Act
- Prominent monuments notified include: Petroglyph Site at Sharnos | Tingmosgang Fort | Ancient Caves at Saspol
  - Maitreya Buddha Rock Carving at Shey near Sindhu Ghat | Petroglyph sites at Domkhar, Lehdo, Alchi & Murgi
  - Stongday Gonpa | Meditation Cave of Onpo at Hunder | Hunder Cave | Dechen Tsomo Khar (Fort)
  - Stampuk Cave | Rock-Carved Buddha Statue at Hunder | Rigsum Gonbo Rock Carvings at Diggar | Sumoor Fort
  - Chamba Karpo (White Maitreya Buddha) at Diggar | Rock Inscriptions at Yourbaltak in Kargil
  - Petroglyph Site at Mangmore in Kargil
- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena

News - 13

- Rajasthan – became India's 1st state to execute Exploration Licence for Rare Earth Elements (REEs) & associated minerals, strengthening access to critical mineral resources
- Exploration Licence – covers 207.63 sq. km. Navatala-Devigarh region across Pachpadra tehsil (Balotra district) & Shergarh tehsil (Jodhpur district), western Rajasthan
- The licence has been granted to – M/s Central Mine Planning and Design Institute Limited (CMPDI)
- REEs identified – Lanthanum, Cerium, Praseodymium & Neodymium
- Rajasthan – became 1st state to operationalise an auctioned exploration licence block in India
  - also ranks 1st in auction of major mineral blocks
- Rajasthan: Capital – Jaipur | CM – Bhajan Lal Sharma | Governor – Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde

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News - 14

- Brookfield – launched "Lumara", a dedicated renewable energy platform in India
  - with planned investment of ~$600 million for solar, wind & Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) projects
- Funding – backed by Brookfield's Catalytic Transition Fund (CTF)
  - launched with anchor commitment from UAE-backed climate investment vehicle "ALTÉRRA" (corpus – up to $5 bn)
- Platform objective – address renewable energy deployment challenges including PPA negotiation delays, grid connection queues & land acquisition timelines
- Brookfield India portfolio – ~45 GW combined wind & solar capacity across operational & under-development projects
- India renewable energy target – 500 GW installed renewable energy capacity by 2030
- Nawal Saini – Managing Partner & Head of Energy for South Asia and the Middle East at Brookfield
- HQs of Brookfield – New York, USA (also headquartered in Toronto, Canada) | CEO – Bruce Flatt

Join us

News - 15

- India observed 16th Indian Organ Donation Day event in New Delhi (The day is observed on August 3)
  - Organised by – National Organ & Tissue Transplant Organisation (NOTTO)
- Govt launched 'Jug Jug Jiyo Abhiyaan' alongside 'e-Pratyaropan' (e-प्रत्यारोपण) portal & 'NOTTO' mobile application
- Govt also released 'National Brain Stem Death Certification Guidelines' & 'National Guidelines on Swap Transplantation'
  - To standardise procedures across States & UTs
- As per NOTTO Annual Report 2025-26, India performed 20,138 organ transplants in 2025 (highest in a single year)
- India now ranks 3rd globally in total organ transplants | Top – United States & China
- India crossed 5 lakh Aadhaar-verified organ donation pledges since launch of national digital pledge portal in 2023
- Best State for recording highest number of deceased organ donors – Tamil Nadu (266)
  - Followed by – Maharashtra (205), Telangana (198), Karnataka (154) & Kerala (152)
- Best State award for North Eastern Region – Assam | Best Union Territory – Delhi
- Best Regional Organ & Tissue Transplant Organisation (Northern Region) – PGIMER Chandigarh

News - 16

- Indian Railways – transported a live donor heart by train for 1st time in India's history
  - Aboard "Vande Bharat Express" (Train No. 20901 - Mumbai Central-Gandhinagar Capital)
  - Ensuring timely arrival for transplantation at U.N. Mehta Institute of Cardiology & Research Centre, Ahmedabad
- A dedicated 'Green Corridor' was created from Platform No. 1 of Ahmedabad Railway Station to U.N. Mehta Institute of Cardiology & Research Centre
  - Jointly managed by – RPF & Gujarat Police
- HQs of Indian Railways – New Delhi | Chairman & CEO – Satish Kumar

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News - 17

- PM Modi inaugurated & laid foundation stone of multiple development, technology & cultural infrastructure projects
- In Andhra Pradesh:
  - He dedicated multiple development projects worth over ₹17,900 Cr in Bhogapuram
  - He inaugurated Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport at Bhogapuram in Vizianagaram district
    - It is developed under Public-Private Partnership (PPP) mode at a cost of over ₹5,640 Cr
  - He also laid foundation stone of Andhra Semiconductor & Innovation Park Semiconductor Project at Visakhapatnam
    - Investment – ₹460 Cr (Andhra Pradesh's 1st semiconductor manufacturing facility)
- In Karnataka:
  - He inaugurated 'Swami Vivekananda Cultural Youth Centre - Viveka Smaraka' at Sri Ramakrishna Ashrama
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

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News - 18

- PM Modi launched "Nasha Mukt Yuva for Viksit Bharat Sankalp Abhiyan" in Aug 2026
- It connected over 1 Cr young citizens from more than 28,000 locations across the country

News - 19

- 4th edition of 'Tri-Services Future Warfare Course' – commenced at Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi
- It is being conducted under aegis of Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS)
  - Coordinated by – Centre for Joint Warfare Studies (CENJOWS)
- 1st edition – held in Sep 2024

News - 20

- Glaw Lake (Arunachal Pradesh's 1st Ramsar Site) – designated India's 101st Ramsar Site
- It is nestled within Kamlang Tiger Reserve & WS at an elevation of 1,168 metres in densely forested Eastern Himalayas
- Glaw Lake is a pristine freshwater lake & recognised biodiversity hotspot
- Ramsar Convention – signed in Ramsar, Iran, in 1971
- India's Ramsar network – rose to 101 Ramsar Sites in 2026 (from 26 Ramsar Sites in 2014)
- Arunachal Pradesh: Capital – Itanagar | CM – Pema Khandu | Governor – Lt. Gen. Kaiwalya Trivikram Parnaik

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News - 21

- IIT Hyderabad + CEEPL = launched "ANUGYAN", a Nuclear Technology Orientation Programme (NTOP)
  - Formally launched during a ceremony held at IIT Hyderabad campus at Kandi in Sangareddy, Telangana
- It is open to engineering graduates, working professionals, PSU executives, EPC contractors & industrial equipment manufacturers
- Director of IIT Hyderabad – Prof. Budaraju Srinivasa Murty
- HQs of CEEPL – New Delhi | CMD – Cdr. Binu Tom Jacob

News - 22

- Supreme Court of India – directed that mandatory 3rd-party insurance period for new vehicles be extended by 1 year
  - New cars must be covered for 4 years & new 2-wheelers for 6 years at time of purchase
- Present CJI of Supreme Court – Justice Surya Kant (53rd) | Established on – Jan 26, 1950
  - Retirement age: Chief Justices & Judges of HC – 62 years | CJI & judges of the SC – 65 years
  - Sanctioned strength of judges in the SC – 38 (including CJI)

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News - 23

- Telangana Police launched Next-Generation Telangana Emergency Response Support System (TG-ERSS) - Dial 112
  - It is an AI-powered integrated emergency response platform
  - Inaugurated by – DGP C.V. Anand, at Telangana Integrated Command & Control Centre (TGiCCC) in Hyderabad
- It integrates Police, Fire Services, Ambulance Services, Women Safety, Child Protection, Disaster Response & other emergency services under single national emergency number 112
- Its centre operates on a 24×7 basis with 164 trained personnel & 900 SIP-based communication channels
- Telangana's average emergency response time – 10 minutes & 30 seconds statewide
  - National average – 18 minutes
- Telangana Police plans to introduce AI-enabled drones on a pilot basis in Hyderabad, Cyberabad, Malkajgiri & Future City Commissionerates
- Telangana: Capital – Hyderabad | CM – A. Revanth Reddy | Governor – Shiv Pratap Shukla

News - 24

- MHA formally included heatwaves & lightning in list of notified natural calamities for award period 2026-31
  - Under 'Operational Guidelines for Administration of the State Disaster Response Fund (SDRF)' & 'National Disaster Response Fund (NDRF)'
- It makes states eligible for financial assistance under Disaster Management Act, 2005
- Now, list of notified natural calamities has expanded to 14 categories (from 12)
  - Cyclone, drought, earthquake, flood, tsunami, avalanche, cloudburst, landslide, hailstorm, fire, frost/cold wave, pest attack, heatwave & lightning
- Lightning is responsible for largest number of deaths due to any single disaster reported in India
- Highest number of cases recorded (heatwaves) – Telangana (915)
  - Followed by – West Bengal (733), Chhattisgarh (660) & Andhra Pradesh (540)
- Highest number of confirmed heatstroke deaths – Maharashtra
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

News - 25

- India – developed an integrated, intelligence-led & technology-driven model to combat fugitive criminals
  - Under which India has brought back 274 fugitive criminals from 36 countries between 2019 & 2026
- Govt enacted 'Fugitive Economic Offenders Act in 2018' to strengthen action against fugitives
  - Under which assets of ₹17,874 Cr belonging to fugitive criminals have been attached through enforcement of PMLA
  - Assets of ₹18,762 Cr has been returned in cases involving Fugitive Economic Offenders
- Govt also enacted NIA (Amendment) Act & UAPA (Amendment) Act in 2019 & introduced 3 new criminal laws in 2024

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- Sections 355 & 356 of BNSS provide for trial in absentia, enabling legal proceedings against accused persons who remain outside India

- 'BHARATPOL' – launched in Jan 2025 to reduce time required for international information sharing to 3-10 days

News - 26

- MoH&FW deployed a 'National Joint Outbreak Response Team (NJORT)' to Gujarat & Rajasthan
  - To strengthen response to ongoing Chandipura Virus Disease (CHPV) outbreak
- NJORT comprises experts from NCDC, ICMR & DAHD
- NCDC's Public Health Emergency Operations Centre (PHEOC) – also activated to support NJORT
- Chandipura virus – first identified in 1965 after being isolated from febrile patients in Chandipur village, Maharashtra
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat
- Rajasthan: Capital – Jaipur | CM – Bhajan Lal Sharma | Governor – Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde
- Minister of Health & Family Welfare: Jagat Prakash Nadda | Constituency – Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Health & Family Welfare: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao & Anupriya Singh Patel

News - 27

- C.P. Radhakrishnan launched 'Har Ghar Tiranga Abhiyan' in Andaman & Nicobar Islands
  - By hoisting National Flag at Flag Point, Sri Vijaya Puram
- Andaman & Nicobar Islands: Capital – Sri Vijaya Puram | Lieutenant Governor – Adm D K Joshi

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News - 28

- India crossed a landmark 300 GW of installed non-fossil fuel-based electricity generation capacity
  - Total non-fossil fuel capacity – 300.50 GW (as on Jul 31, 2026)
- Share of non-fossil fuel electricity capacity in India's total installed electricity generation capacity – 552 GW (over 54%)
- Total non-fossil fuel capacity (300.50 GW) comprises: Solar power – 164.59 GW | Wind power – 58.14 GW
  - Hydro power – 57.24 GW | Bio-power – 11.75 GW | Nuclear power – 8.78 GW
- During 2025-26, India added 55.29 GW of non-fossil fuel-based electricity generation capacity
  - Contribution: Solar – 44.6 GW | Wind – 6 GW
- Renewable electricity generation – rose to 477.79 BU in 2025-26 (from 190.96 billion units (BU) in 2014-15)

News - 29

- NeGD (MeitY) + AAERI = partnered to launch 'AAERI Verify', a digital platform integrated directly with DigiLocker
  - To enable secure, paperless & consent-based verification of academic, identity & financial documents for Indian students applying to Australian universities
- It was officially unveiled during AAERI Annual Convention in New Delhi on Aug 7, 2026
- It replaces slow, manual document verification with a secure 2-stage strategic framework:

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- Stage 1: A 'student check' is conducted seamlessly before university application process begins
- Stage 2: A 'sponsor check' initiated immediately after a student receives an admission offer to verify financial authenticity

- HQs of NeGD – New Delhi | President & CEO – Nand Kumarum | Founded in – 2009 | Works under – MeitY

News - 30

- "E-Samudra" – launched in India to strengthen seafarer welfare, security & service delivery
  - It is a digital platform integrating services for seafarers, shipping companies, ports & other maritime stakeholders into a single digital window
- Inaugurated by – Sarbananda Sonowal (MoPSW)
  - During "Seafarer Security, Safety and Welfare and Inauguration of E-Samudra" held in Mumbai on Aug 8, 2026
  - Organised by – Directorate General of Maritime Administration (DGMA)
- India's active seafarer workforce – grown to more than 3.23 lakh in 2025 (from about 1.03 lakh in 2013)
- DGMA showcased a series of initiatives to modernise maritime administration, including:
  - e-NAVIK 24x7 grievance redressal system | Seafarer Tracking Dashboard
  - Digital Seafarers Employment Agreement | Enhanced welfare measures under Seafarers Welfare Fund Society

News - 31

- Oilseed production in India – rose to 43.06 million tonnes in 2025-26 (3rd Advance Estimate) (from 39 MTs in 2022-23)
- Domestic availability of edible oils – increased to 126.30 lakh tonnes in 2024-25 (from 124.23 lakh tonnes in 2022-23)
  - Edible oil imports (over same period) – declined to 160.72 lakh tonnes (from 165.00 lakh tonnes)
- During 2025-26, GoI distributed free quality seeds covering 13.52 lakh hectares under Value Chain Clusters
- India's cumulative oil palm area – 6.40 lakh hectares (as of Mar 31, 2026)
- National Mission on Edible Oils-Oilseeds (NMEO-OS) – approved on Oct 3, 2024
  - Aim: To increase India's primary oilseed production from 39 MTs (2022-23) to 69.7 MTs by 2030-31
- National Mission on Edible Oils-Oil Palm (NMEO-OP) – launched in Aug 2021 | Total outlay – ₹11,040 Cr
  - Aim: To reduce India's heavy dependence on imported edible oils

News - 32

- MHA issued new national security guidelines banning solar, wind & hybrid renewable energy projects within 1 km of LoC, LAC & International Border (IB)
- A wider band extending up to 50 km from LoC, LAC International Border has been classified as a "sensitive area"
- Projects between 1 km & 20 km of International Border will additionally require an NOC from MoD
- MHA also imposed height restrictions on project-related civil infrastructure in these sensitive zones:
  - Up to 3 metres – within 1-8 km band | Up to 5 metres – between 8-20 km | Up to 15 metres – between 20-50 km
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

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News - 33

- HAL Airport (Bengaluru) – became 1st airport in India to operationalise Required Navigation Performance-Category H (RNP CAT H) helicopter approach
  - Developed by – AAI | Approved by – DGCA
  - Validated through flight trials conducted by – HAL test pilots
- HQs of AAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Vipin Kumar
- HQs of HAL – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CMD – Ravi Kota

News - 34

- India's honey production – increased to 1,51,690 metric tonnes (MT) in 2025-26 (from 80,530 MT in 2014-15)
- India exported around 1.07 lakh MT of natural honey worth $177.55 million in FY24
  - It makes India 2nd-largest exporter of honey globally (from 9th rank in 2020)
- Since 2021-22, Centre supported 21 beekeeping projects in West Bengal alone under NBHM | Outlay – ₹16.13 Cr
- WB – produced 24.05 thousand MT of honey in FY26 as per 2nd Advance Estimates of Horticulture Crops Statistics
- National Beekeeping & Honey Mission (NBHM) – a Central Sector Scheme approved by GoI
  - Total budget outlay – ₹500 Cr for period FY21 to FY26 | NBHM operates through 3 Mini Missions
  - It is being implemented by – Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare through National Bee Board (NBB)

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News - 35

- Gujarat approved establishment of 4 Centres of Excellence (CoEs) for natural farming in Navsari, Morbi, Bhavnagar & Chhota Udepur districts
  - It allocates ₹20 Cr for initiative in 2026-27
- In 1st phase, the Centres will be established at: Nani Bhamti village in Vansda taluka of Navsari, Halvad in Morbi district
  - Valavad village in Sihor taluka of Bhavnagar | Chudel village in Jetpur Pavi taluka of Chhota Udepur
- Implementing agency for this scheme – Gujarat Prakrutik Krishi Vikas Board
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 36

- Assam – recorded world's 1st-ever release of captive-bred Slender-billed Vultures (*Gyps tenuirostris*) fitted with GSM-GPS satellite transmitters
  - 10 captive-bred vultures (5 Slender-billed Vultures & 5 White-rumped Vultures) were soft-released
  - From Jatayu Aviary at Tewaripal in Biswanath Wildlife Division of Kaziranga National Park & Tiger Reserve
- This initiative is a joint programme of = Assam Forest Department + Kaziranga NP & TR + Bombay Natural History Society
- Slender-billed Vulture & White-rumped Vulture – both are classified as 'Critically Endangered'
- India recorded 9 species of vultures
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

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News - 37

- MHA notified 11 more international ports enabling entry of e-visa-holder foreigners into India
  - Now, total number of international ports authorised for e-visa entry – 88 (37 airports, 38 seaports & 13 land ports)
- Newly added 11 international ports include 9 land ports & 2 airports (Bhopal & Tirupati)
  - 9 land ports – Agartala, Darranga, Gede, Ghojadanga, Haridaspur, Jaigaon, Dawki, Moreh & Attari (Road)
- India process approximately 95% of e-visa applications within 72 hours
- India introduced e-Visa facility with an Electronic Travel Authorisation in 2014, initially covering nationals of 43 countries
  - It is currently available to citizens of 172 countries
- Minister of Home Affairs: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

News - 38

- TRAI expanded 1600-number series beyond BFSI sector to utilities, courier & logistics service providers
  - They will use a new '1601' series to prevent fraud & impersonation & help consumers identify legitimate calls
- Under Phase-I, 1601 series will be issued to electricity distribution companies, water utilities, city gas distribution companies, LPG distribution entities & other utility service providers, as well as courier companies
- TSPs have been directed to complete migration & onboarding of eligible entities within 90 days from date of order
- HQs of TRAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Anil Kumar Lahoti | Established in – 1997

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News - 39

- Flipkart Minutes – entered gourmet grocery segment with a range of premium & speciality food products
  - It launched its own private label brand, "Pykd", to strengthen its position | It is being piloted first in Bengaluru
- FirstClub (Bengaluru) – raised $55 million in its Series B funding round in Jun 2026
- HQs of Flipkart – Bangalore, Karnataka | Chairperson & CEO – Kalyan Krishnamurthy

News - 40

- VOC Port Authority (VOCPA) – became 1st port in India to be accredited with ISO 50001:2018 Certification
  - For its Energy Management System | Awarded by – Indian Register Quality Systems (IRQS)
- This certification is guided by – 'Harit Sagar Green Port Guidelines' of Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways
- VOCPA had earlier become India's 1st Major Port to secure both Indian Green Building Council (IGBC) Platinum Rating & Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) Shunya certification
  - It has separately been recognised as India's 1st major port to achieve Scope-2 emission-free status

Join us

News - 41

- MoPSW approved a ₹334.89 Cr internal flyover at Visakhapatnam Port Authority to improve cargo evacuation
  - Project was appraised by – Delegated Investment Board (chaired by Secretary, MoPSW) | Length – 3.584-km
  - It will connect Convent Junction with Dock Area
- Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Sarbananda Sonowal | Constituency – Dibrugarh, Assam
  MoS in Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Shantanu Thakur

News - 42

- "Poshan Tracker" digital application – rolled out by MoWCD as an ICT-based governance tool
  - For continuous monitoring & tracking of all services provided to beneficiaries registered at Anganwadi Centres
  - Under 'Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 (Mission Poshan 2.0)'
- Poshan Tracker – originally launched on Mar 1, 2021, through National e-Governance Division (NeGD)
  - It is available in 24 languages, including Hindi & English
- A Facial Recognition System (FRS) – also integrated into Poshan Tracker for distribution of Take-Home Rations
- MoWCD + MoHFW = jointly released a Protocol for Management of Malnutrition in Children
  - To prevent & treat severe acute malnutrition & reduce associated morbidity & mortality
- Poshan Tracker initiative – received National Award for e-Governance 2024 (Gold)
  - For Government Process Re-engineering & Digital Transformation
- Minister of Women & Child Development: Annpurna Devi | Constituency – Kodarma, Jharkhand
  MoS in Ministry of Women and Child Development: Savitri Thakur

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News - 43

- India's exports from Special Economic Zones (SEZs) – rose 11.8% y-o-y to ₹16,36,192 Cr in 2025-26
  - Exports from these zones – ₹14,63,669 Cr in 2024-25
- Outbound shipments from SEZs – ₹13.55 lakh Cr in 2023-24, ₹12.63 lakh Cr in 2022-23 & ₹9,90,747 Cr in 2021-22
- Highest exports were recorded by – Gujarat (₹4,05,595 Cr)
  - Followed by – Karnataka (₹2,69,004 Cr), Maharashtra (₹2,43,422.50 Cr) & Tamil Nadu (₹2,12,288 Cr)

News - 44

- Supreme Court clarified that its original interim order of Feb 14, 2024, will apply for sake of parity to notified wetland & community conservation reserves across India, not just to Asan reserve
  - It restricted mining activities within a 10-km radius of Asan Wetland Conservation Reserve in Uttarakhand
- Mining activities within a 10-km radius of any such notified reserve must obtain prior approval from Standing Committee of National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) and/or MoEFCC before proceeding
- Supreme Court also held that mining is impermissible within 1 km of every national park & wildlife sanctuary
- India currently has 101 Ramsar sites | India's 101st Ramsar site – Glaw Lake (Arunachal Pradesh)

Join us

News - 45

- Ladakh – to launch India's 1st high-altitude wildlife safari to promote sustainable eco-tourism
- 1st governing body meeting of Snow Leopard & High-Altitude Nature Conservation Society – chaired by V K Saxena (LG)
- Forest Department has been directed to introduce guided jeep safaris using specially designed open-back vehicles driven by trained local drivers & guides
- Aim: To curb illegal off-roading & minimise disturbance to wildlife & enhance visitors' experience through tourism
- Ladakh is home to India's largest snow leopard population, with 477 of country's estimated 718 snow leopards
  - It also supports over 38 mammal species, around 340 bird species & nearly 1,800 vascular plant species
- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena

News - 46

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan – launched a National Scholarship Portal-based scholarship & fellowship disbursement initiative
  - For agriculture students | At – ICAR-IARI, Pusa | Worth – ₹21.35 Cr
  - 6,000+ students received scholarship & fellowship funds directly through Direct Benefit Transfer mechanism
- Minister of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Ram Nath Thakur & Bhagirath Choudhary

News - 47

- NABL (QCI) – launched India's 1st-of-its-kind Accreditation Scheme for Mobile Food Testing Laboratories
  - Under its Integrated Assessment Programme
  - At 'Gunvatta Samanvaya - A Multilateral MoU Exchange Ceremony' – held at Hotel Ashoka, New Delhi
- HQs of QCI – New Delhi | Chairman – Jaxay Shah | Secretary General – Chakravarthy T Kannan | Established – 1997

News - 48

- Amit Shah launched "Gramin Gyan Setu" app to interconnect libraries across Gandhinagar Lok Sabha constituency
  - Aim: To establish a library in every village to encourage reading & learning among children
- ~63 village libraries – already established across Gandhinagar, Kalol & Sanand assembly constituencies
  - Each is stocked with 4,500-6,000 books
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

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News - 49

- India Optel Ltd – launched indigenous "GARUD" High Resolution Binoculars for civil market at DPSU Bhawan, New Delhi
  - Developed & manufactured at – Ordnance Factory, Dehradun
- It is based on a binocular platform that has served Indian Armed Forces & Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs)
- HQs of India Optel Ltd – Dehradun, Uttarakhand | CMD – Sharmishtha Koul Sharma

News - 50

- FSSAI – proposed quantitative thresholds to classify food products as high in added fat, added sugar or salt (HFSS)
  - Aim: To tighten norms governing food sold to children in & around schools
  - Drawing on – 'Indian Council of Medical Research's (ICMR) Dietary Guidelines for Indians-2024'
- It comes through a draft notification, 'Food Safety and Standards (Safe Food and Balanced Diets for Children in School) Amendment Regulations, 2026'
  - To amend 'Food Safety and Standards (Safe Food and Balanced Diets for Children in School) Regulations, 2020'
- A solid food item exceeding any of specified limits, calculated per 100 grams, would be classified as 'high' in that nutrient:
  - More than 4.2 grams of added fat | More than 3 grams of added sugar | More than 0.625 grams of salt
- For liquid foods, calculated per 100 millilitres, thresholds:
  - More than 1.5 grams of added fat | More than 2 grams of added sugar | More than 0.175 grams of salt
- FSSAI invited comments & objections from stakeholders & public, with suggestions to be submitted within 60 days
- HQs of FSSAI – New Delhi | Chairperson – Punya Salila Srivastava | CEO – Rajit Punhani

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News - 51

- Asia's 1st desert-themed drive-through night safari & world-class desert-themed zoological park, proposed at Juna Deesa in Banaskantha district, Gujarat – received approval from Central Zoo Authority (CZA)
- Project is being developed by – Gujarat Forest Department | Estimated cost – ₹542.14 Cr
- Aim: To strengthen wildlife conservation, promote ecotourism & create employment opportunities in North Gujarat
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 52

- Arjun Ram Meghwal – launched revamped "India Code Portal"
  - It transforms central legislative database to an interactive, technology-enabled legal information gateway
- It serves as central digital repository containing Central & State Acts, subordinate legislation, and UT laws & regulations
- A key feature is multilingual access to laws in all 22 languages listed in Eighth Schedule of Constitution
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Law & Justice: Arjun Ram Meghwal | Constituency – Bikaner, Rajasthan

Join us

News - 53

- PM Modi led India's 80th Independence Day celebrations at Red Fort, New Delhi, on Aug 15, 2026
  - Theme – "150 Years of Vande Mataram" & "Yuva Shakti for Viksit Bharat@2047"
- This marked PM Modi's 13th consecutive address from ramparts of Red Fort
  - It makes him 2nd PM to deliver 13 consecutive Independence Day speeches (1st – Jawaharlal Nehru)

News - 54

- Office of PSA to GoI + NABARD = launched 'RSVC-AMRIT' platform | Developed by – NABARD (in collab with OPSA)
  - To strengthen technology-led rural development & accelerate adoption of appropriate technologies in rural areas
  - Launched by – Prof. Ajay Kumar Sood (Principal Scientific Adviser to GoI)
- AMRIT – Accelerated Medium for Rural Innovations & Technologies
  - It serves as digital backbone of RuTAGe Smart Village Centre (RSVC) ecosystem
- HQs of NABARD – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Shaji K. V. | Founded in – 1982

News - 55

- ICID designated 140-year-old Parichha Weir in Jhansi, UP, as a World Heritage Irrigation Structure (WHIS)
  - It was originally proposed in 1855 by Captain Strachey to serve drought-prone Bundelkhand region
- Parichha Weir is a rubble-stone masonry structure featuring 318 steel falling shutters that increased its reservoir capacity from 1,700 million cubic feet to 2,400 million cubic feet
  - Length – 1,174 metres | Height – 16.8 metres
- It is linked to Betwa Canal system, which extends about 2,654 km & irrigates across 5 districts of UP & MP
- It became 2nd irrigation structure from Jhansi region to receive ICID heritage recognition
  - 1st – Sukwa-Dukwan Weir in 2022
- ICID's latest published list recognised 23 irrigation structures in 2025, including 4 from India:
  - Cheyyar Anicut | Ekrukh Medium Project | Kodiveri Anicut & Channel System | Noyyal River System Tanks
- ICID (New Delhi) – established on Jun 24, 1950, as a scientific, technical, not-for-profit international organisation
- Formal award presentation – during ICID's 26th International Congress & 77th International Executive Council meeting
  - In October 2026 in France
- HQs of ICID – New Delhi, India | President – Dr. Marco Arcieri | SG – Dr. Rakesh Gupta | Established in – 1950

News - 56

- Lucknow-New Delhi Tejas Express – became India's 1st train to run under a commercial brand name, 'Sprite Tejas Express'
  - From Aug 19 to Nov 11, 2026 | Under a new advertising tie-up between IRCTC & Sprite (Coca-Cola)
- It is officially numbered 82501/82502 & operating under North Eastern Railway (NER) zone
- Tejas Express – India's 1st privately operated corporate train, flagged off by IRCTC in Oct 2019 on same route
- HQs of IRCTC – New Delhi | CMD – Rahul Himalian
- HQs of The Coca-Cola Company – Atlanta, Georgia, USA | Executive Chairman – James Quincey | CEO – Henrique Braun

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News - 57

- 'Jal Jeevan Mission' (implemented by Ministry of Jal Shakti) – completed 7 years since Aug 15, 2019
- Under JJM, rural tap-water coverage – rose to more than 15.91 crore households (over 82%)
  - From 3.23 crore households in Aug 2019 (about 16.7%)
- More than 2 lakh villages have now been certified as "Har Ghar Jal"
  - Alongside 1,090 blocks, 188 districts & over 1 lakh Gram Panchayats
- JJM aims to provide potable tap water at 55 litres per person per day to every rural household
- 9.34 lakh schools & 9.73 lakh Anganwadi centres – also connected with drinking-water taps
- Cabinet approved its extension until Dec 2028 under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 | Enhanced outlay – ₹8.69 lakh Cr
- Minister of Jal Shakti: C R Patil | Constituency – Navsari, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Jal Shakti – V. Somanna & Raj Bhushan Choudhary

News - 58

- NIELIT (MeitY) – launched "CYBER KUSHTI 2026", a national cybersecurity & AI hackathon
  - To test & recognise human judgment in cybersecurity assessment, rather than mere vulnerability-detection speed
  - Formally launched by – Prof. (Dr.) M.M. Tripathi (Director General, NIELIT)
  - As technical track of 3rd 'National Conference on Cyber Security, Digital Forensics & Intelligence (NCCDFI 2026)'
- NCCDFI 2026 – conducted in collab with ISAC Foundation under National Security Database (NSD)
  - Knowledge Partner – Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In)
- Registration is free, open to Indian students & independent researchers aged 16 & above in teams of 3 (Aug 15 to Sep 10)
- This competition comprises 3 rounds: 'Akhada' – an online round on Sep 15 advancing 50 teams
  - 'Dangal' – an online round on Sep 24 selecting 10 finalist teams
  - 'Kesari' – final in-person round on Oct 9 at Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi
- Winning team will be awarded title "Cyber Kesari 2026"
- HQs of NIELIT – New Delhi | DG – Dr Madan Mohan Tripathi | Chairperson – Union Minister of MeitY

News - 59

- MIDHANI – became 1st Indian company to secure 'Independent and International Metallic Material Laboratory (S400)' approval from GE Aerospace
- S400 approval – a qualification granted by GE Aerospace to laboratories that demonstrate technical capabilities & quality systems required to conduct specified chemical, mechanical & metallurgical tests to GE Aerospace standards
- HQs of MIDHANI – Hyderabad, Telangana | CMD – Dr. S.V.S. Narayana Murty | Established in – 1973

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News - 60

- "National Framework for Strengthening of ITDAs and ITDPs" and the "Operational Guidelines for Strengthening of ITDAs and ITDPs" – released by Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- Aim: To improve functioning of Integrated Tribal Development Agencies & Projects (ITDAs/ITDPs)
- For 1st time, states will have access to a common institutional assessment methodology
- Minister of Tribal Affairs: Jual Oram | Constituency – Sundergarh, Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Tribal Affairs: Durgadas Uikey

News - 61

- MoI&B – removed 12-minute-per-hour advertisement duration cap for television channels
  - Aim: To enable fair competition & ensuring ease of doing business
- Advertisement cap was introduced under 'Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994'
  - It mandated that any television channel could have only 12 minutes of non-programme content per hour
  - Subdividing into 10 minutes of advertisements & 2 minutes of self-promotion
- This decision will take effect from date amendment to Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994, is notified in Gazette
- Minister of Information & Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

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News - 62

- PM Modi unveiled "Shakti ki Sapt Dhara" (7 streams of strength), a 7-point development framework
  - To guide country's growth towards goal of a Viksit Bharat by 2047
- 7 streams identified were:
  - Manufacturing | Agriculture & food processing | Technology & innovation | Gati Shakti
  - Raksha Shakti or defence capability | Green & blue economy | Soft power

News - 63

- PM Modi announced plans to establish a "vibrant Civil Defence network" & a "massive, modern Civil Defence volunteer force" trained in modern systems
  - To protect citizens from contemporary security threats rather than only conventional border warfare
- India already has a statutory Civil Defence Corps under Civil Defence Act, 1968
  - Civil Defence Rules, 1968 – cover evacuation, protection of vital installations, fire prevention, public awareness & precautions against hostile attacks
- Civil Defence is distinct from India's other citizen-participation bodies:
  - National Cadet Corps (NCC), under NCC Act, 1948 – a youth-training organisation
  - Home Guards, first raised in 1946 – function as an auxiliary to police & are a paid volunteer force
  - Territorial Army – forms part of military reserve structure

Join us

News - 64

- Central Govt delisted 18 monuments from list of protected monuments since 2021
- Sites delisted include: Bara Khamba Cemetery in Delhi, a banyan grove, Kos Minar No. 13 in Haryana
  - Gunner Burkill's Tomb in Jhansi & Telia Nala Buddhist ruins in Varanasi
- Once delisted under Section 35 of AMASR Act, a monument no longer requires protection by ASI
- There are currently 3,688 centrally protected monuments & sites under care & maintenance of ASI
- Centre retrieved 662 artefacts from abroad till Jun 2026, comprising:
  - 589 – from US | 51 – from Australia | 21 – from UK | 1 – from Netherlands
- HQs of ASI – New Delhi | Director General – Yadubir Singh Rawat | Established in – 1861

News - 65

- Office of Registrar General of India (RGI) notified a 40-question Household Schedule for 2027 Census of India
- 2nd phase – to cover caste, religion, education, employment, migration, marital status, disability status, mother tongue & household financial & identification details
- For 1st time since 1931 & for 1st time in Independent India, Census will collect comprehensive caste details from all respondents
- Question 10 in notified schedule – an open-ended entry for "Scheduled Caste (SC)/Scheduled Tribe (ST)/Caste"
- For 1st time, it will also collect personal identification & financial details, including Aadhaar number, voter ID number, passport number, driving licence status, mobile number & total number of bank accounts held
- Under Section 8(2) of Census Act, 1948, respondents are required to provide information sought & only aggregated data published
- 40-question Household Schedule follows 33-question Houselisting & Housing Census schedule notified for Phase 1
  - Phase 1 – began on Apr 1, 2026
- Census 2027 – India's 1st fully digital census, with data collected through electronic devices via a mobile application
  - Data is monitored through a central portal
  - Conducted by – Office of Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India

News - 66

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – inaugurated the RSSDI "Diabetes Rural Outreach Digital Portal"
  - also launched "VISHWAS", Diabetes Awareness Video Library
- 'RSSDI Rural Outreach Programme' currently covers around 30 villages across several states
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

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News - 67

- India launched its 1st-ever "Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems (ONEs) of India"
  - At 17th Session of Conference of Parties to UN Convention to Combat Desertification – held in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia
  - Launched under aegis of Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change (MoEFCC)
- It classifies 24 ecosystem types across India
- Organised by – Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology & Environment (ATREE)
  - In collab with IUCN, CoE-SLM, ICFRE & Space Applications Centre (ISRO)
- HQs of UN – New York City, US | Secretary General – António Guterres

News - 68

- "Suryapath Tiranga" – completed its 1st-of-its-kind global relay of National Flag
  - It connects 54 Indian missions & posts across countries & continents by following path of rising sun
- Several Indian diplomatic missions also presented certificates to top scorers of "Bharat Ko Janiye Quiz"
  - Organised by – Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)

News - 69

- Rajnath Singh – flagged off NCC All India Girls High Altitude Long Trek "Aparajita - Parang La 2026"
  - During an event in New Delhi
- Members in team of girl cadets – 28 | Average age – 19 years | Youngest girl – 16 & a half years
- It will undertake a ~250-km trek over 30 days, led by 3 women officers representing Army, Navy & Air Force
- Route traverses Parang La Pass, situated at 5,578 metres (18,300 feet), connecting Spiti Valley & Changthang region
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 70

- MeitY approved 31 additional projects under 'Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS)'
  - At an event organised in New Delhi in collab with Electronic Industries Association of India (ELCINA)
  - It involves investments of – ₹7,877 Cr
- For 1st time, approvals have been granted for filters, coils, speakers & raw materials
  - 3 projects for capital equipment manufacturing also approved
- Govt now cleared 106 applications covering around 30 product categories across 15 states under ECMS
  - Cumulative investments – ₹69,548 Cr
- Expected production from approved projects – rose to ₹5,34,101 Cr (original target - ₹4,56,500 Cr)
- India's electronics manufacturing sector – rose to ₹13.11 lakh Cr in 2025-26 & production crossed ₹13 lakh Cr
- ECMS – notified in Apr 2025 | Initial outlay – ₹22,919 Cr
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

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News - 71

- CCEA approved 5 railway & highway projects | Worth – ₹13,041 Cr
  - Aim: To increase infrastructure capacity across West Bengal, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu & Bihar
- Estimated cost of railway projects – ₹9,450 Cr
- Railway projects cover 4 multi-tracking projects that will add about 410 km to Indian Railways network:
  - A 173-km line between Kharagpur (West Bengal) & Bhadrak/Ranital (Odisha)
  - A 75-km line between Bhadrak & Haridaspur (Odisha)
  - A 90-km 3rd & 4th line between Gummidipundi (Tamil Nadu) & Gudur (Andhra Pradesh)
  - A 72-km 3rd & 4th line between Cuttack & Paradeep/Badabandha (Odisha)
- Cabinet also approved 4-laning of 82-km Muzaffarpur-Sitamarhi-Sonbarsa section of National Highway (NH)-22 in Bihar
  - At a capital cost of ₹3,590.73 Cr | To be developed under Hybrid Annuity Mode (HAM)

News - 72

- Central Information Commission – launched its upgraded "Appeal & Complaint Management System (AppCoMS 2.0)"
  - To strengthen Commission's digital infrastructure & streamline processing of Second Appeals & Complaints under Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005
- Upgraded portal was launched by – Raj Kumar Goyal (Chief Information Commissioner)
- AppCoMS was introduced by CIC in Sep 2016 as an online web application portal
- HQs of Central Information Commission – Delhi | Chief Information Commissioner – Raj Kumar Goyal

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News - 73

- As per MoC&I: Logistics Data Bank (LDB) tracked 10 crore Export-Import (EXIM) containers since its launch in 2016
- LDB – a technology-based platform providing end-to-end visibility of EXIM container movement across India's logistics chain
- LDB is operated by – NICDC Logistics Data Services Limited (NLDSL), established on Dec 30, 2015
  - As a JV between National Industrial Corridor Development & Implementation Trust (GoI) & NEC Corporation (Japan)
- NLDSL also manages Unified Logistics Interface Platform (ULIP)

News - 74

- National Commission for Women (NCW) – organised "Yashoda AI" programme at LPU, Jalandhar, Punjab
  - To promote AI literacy, digital empowerment, cyber safety & participation of women in emerging technologies
  - Led by – Vijaya Rahatkar (NCW Chairperson)
- She inaugurated "She Serves" programme at a women's college to encourage young women to explore careers in Armed Forces
- Yashoda AI (aka "Your AI SAKHI") – launched on May 22, 2025, at Mahatma Jyotiba Phule Rohilkhand University, Bareilly
  - As a collab between NCW & Future Shift Labs (FSL)

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- "Casebook on AI and Gender Empowerment" – jointly released by IndiaAI Mission (MeitY) & UN Women
  - With support from – Ministry of Women and Child Development | At India AI Impact Summit 2026
- HQs of NCW – New Delhi | Chairperson – Vijaya Kishore Rahatkar | Founded in – 1992

News - 75

- Cabinet approved establishment of a Bench of High Court of J&K and Ladakh in UT of Ladakh
- It gives Ladakh its 1st physical High Court presence since it was carved out as a separate UT in 2019
- It became High Court's 3rd bench alongside existing benches at Srinagar & Jammu
- Ladakh: Capital – Leh | Lieutenant Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena

News - 76

- As per MoRTH, NHAI extended facility of online FASTag "Local Passes" to 121 toll plazas across India
- Eligible commuters can subscribe to monthly Local Pass online through Rajmargyatra Mobile App
- 1st Digital Local Pass facility – launched in Jul 2026 at Mundka-Bakkarwala Toll Plaza on Urban Extension Road-II in Delhi
- Residents living within a 20 km radius of an eligible toll plaza can apply for pass through app
  - It permits unlimited travel through respective toll plaza during month, subject to applicable provisions
- National Highway users can check list of eligible toll plazas at rajmargyatra.nhai.gov.in/buy-fastag-local-pass
- HQs of NHAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Santosh Kumar Yadav | Founded in – 1988

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News - 77

- 'PM CARES Fund' had a closing balance of ₹8,452.06 Cr as of Mar 31, 2025 (from ₹7,173 Cr in previous year)
  - PM CARES – Prime Minister's Citizen Assistance & Relief in Emergency Situations
- Fund spent ₹87.85 lakh during FY25, almost entirely on "PM CARES for Children" Scheme
- Of closing balance, ₹7,846.65 Cr, or about 93%, was held in fixed deposits, with ₹605.41 Cr in savings-bank accounts
- During this year, Fund received ₹479.04 Cr in domestic donations & ₹92.83 lakh in foreign donations
  - Total fresh contributions – roughly ₹480 Cr
- Existing corpus generated around ₹475 Cr in interest income, nearly matching fresh donations
- It also recorded ₹324.66 Cr as a "Refund from Implementing Agencies" (from ₹84.31 Cr returned in previous FY)
- PM CARES – established on Mar 27, 2020, as a public charitable trust with Prime Minister as its ex-officio Chairman

News - 78

- Madurai Bench of Madras High Court – declared Tamirabharani river a deity, recognising it as a juristic or legal person
- Any pollution of river would breach environmental statutes & citizens' fundamental rights under Article 21 of Constitution
- Personhood conferred was limited to river's right not to be polluted & no other rights, duties or liabilities would arise from declaration

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- It banned dumping of clothes & other waste during rituals & prohibited immersion of idols & materials in river
  - It permits immersion of ashes only in unfired earthen pots
- Tamirabharani – originated at Agastyarkoodam peak of Pothigai Hills in Western Ghats
  - It is a perennial river flowing entirely within Tamil Nadu, sustaining Tirunelveli, Thoothukudi & Tenkasi districts
  - It drains into – Gulf of Mannar
- In 2017, Uttarakhand High Court recognised Ganga & Yamuna as legal persons
- New Zealand's Whanganui River – became 1st river in world to be recognised as a legal person, in 2017
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 79

- Swiggy launched "Guru" a 24x7 AI-powered business assistant for its restaurant partners
- It is available in over 20 vernacular languages, including Hindi, Kannada & Telugu
- HQs of Swiggy – Bengaluru, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Sriharsha Majety | Chairman – Anand Kripalu

News - 80

- CDSL Investor Protection Fund (IPF) – launched a multilingual investor education film, "The Garden of Prosperity"
  - In collaboration with – Amar Chitra Katha | To promote thoughtful financial planning & informed investing
- It is available in 12 languages: English, Hindi, Marathi, Bengali, Gujarati, Punjabi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Odia & Assamese
- HQs of CDSL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Nehal Vora | Chairman – Gurumoorthy Mahalingam

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News - 81

- Railway Ministry approved an increase in maximum permissible speed of trains to 100 kmph on 111-km Katra-Banihal Broad Gauge rail section
  - It is a part of Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL) project under Jammu Division of Northern Railway
- Previously, trains were permitted to run at a maximum of 85 kmph on Katra-Sangaldan stretch & 75 kmph on Sangaldan-Banihal stretch
- Now, Vande Bharat train has begun operating at nearly 100 kmph on Chenab Bridge
- Minister of Railways: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Railways: V. Somanna & Ravneet Singh

News - 82

- DoT directed telecom operators to deny new mobile connections to subscribers who have already reached permitted limit of 9 SIM cards
- Under a circular dated Aug 17, 2026, TSPs must implement technical & organisational measures to identify applicants seeking connections beyond prescribed ceiling & inform them that a new SIM cannot be issued

Join us

- For implementation-related disputes, respective Licensed Service Areas will act as competent authorities
- Permitted connection limit is lower, at 6 connections, for subscribers in J&K, Northeast & Assam

News - 83

- Maharashtra – declared snakebite a notifiable disease w.e.f. Aug 18, 2026
  - It makes it mandatory for all government & private hospitals, medical colleges & healthcare professionals to report every suspected, probable or confirmed snakebite case, to health authorities
- All States & UTs were asked to declare snakebite a notifiable disease under National Action Plan for Prevention & Control of Snakebite Envenoming by 2030 (NAPSE)
- Golden hour – critical 60 minutes following a snakebite
- Karnataka also declared snakebite a notifiable disease under 'Karnataka Epidemic Diseases Act' in 2024
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma

News - 84

- MoRD launched "National Campaign on Entrepreneurship-II" under DAY-NRLM (from Aug 21 to Nov 21, 2026)
  - DAY-NRLM – Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Rural Livelihoods Mission
  - To accelerate entrepreneurship among rural women & promote both farm & non-farm enterprises
  - Launched by – Rohit Kansal (Secretary, Department of Rural Development)
- 1st National Campaign on Entrepreneurship – launched on Jan 12, 2026
  - To train 50,000 Community Resource Persons (CRPs) & impart Entrepreneurship Development Programme (EDP) training to 50 lakh SHG members
- CRP-EPs & Business Development Service Providers (BDSPs) – to be recognised as "Udyam Sakhis"
- Rohit Kansal also released 1st edition of "Sankalp Shakti"
  - A monthly rural enterprise technical bulletin focused on empowerment & enterprise development of Lakhpati Didis
- Minister of Rural Development: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Rural Development: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani & Kamlesh Paswan

News - 85

- Territorial Army + CyberPeace = launched "Terrier Cyber Quest 2026" (TCQ 3.0), a national-level hackathon
  - To develop innovative solutions to contemporary defence, cybersecurity & information-domain challenges
- TCQ 3.0 will be conducted across 3 competition tracks: 'Bug Hunting' – a cybersecurity challenge
  - 'AI Kavach' & 'Creators Challenge'
- Registrations for competition are open till Aug 31, 2026 | Online shortlisting phase – Sep 1-10, 2026
- Grand Finale (in New Delhi) – Oct 6-8, 2026 | Award ceremony – Oct 9, 2026
- HQs of Territorial Army – New Delhi | DG – Lieutenant General Girish Kalia
- HQs of CyberPeace – New Delhi | Global President – Vineet Kumar

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News - 86

- MSH (MeitY) – launched "GENESIS Entrepreneur-in-Residence (EIR) Cohort 3"
  - It is a national-level programme supporting aspiring entrepreneurs, innovators, researchers, students & early-stage startup founders in transforming innovative ideas into technology-driven ventures
- It was launched at – 'GENESIS NextGen Startup Summit', held at Rathinam Global University, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu
  - Launched by – Dr. Panneerselvam Madanagopal (CEO of MeitY Startup Hub)
- Formal Call for Applications – opened on Aug 4, 2026
- GENESIS EIR 3.0 – a component of GENESIS (Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups) scheme
  - Total budget of GENESIS scheme – ₹490 Cr
- Eligible startups must be less than 2 years old, based in Tier-II or Tier-III cities
  - They must not have already received financial assistance exceeding ₹10 lakh under any central or state govt scheme
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

News - 87

- PNGRB – authorised nearly 1,800 km of new LPG pipeline infrastructure across 6 states | Investment – ₹7,000 Cr
- 3 strategically important projects, all to be developed by GAIL (India) Limited:
  - 556-km Cherlapally (Telangana) to Nagpur (Maharashtra) pipeline
  - 611-km Jhansi (UP) to Sitarganj (Uttarakhand) pipeline
  - 633-km Shikrapur to Goa & Hubballi (Karnataka) pipeline
- Upon completion, PNGRB-authorised common-carrier LPG pipeline network in India – increase to nearly 9,500 km
- Currently India's longest LPG pipeline – 2,757-km Kandla-Gorakhpur LPG Pipeline
- HQs of PNGRB – New Delhi | Chairman – Dr. Anil Kumar Jain

News - 88

- MoPNG + MC² Foundation = launched "MC²+ Ignite" at IIT Madras, a sector-specific accelerator for deep-tech startups developing technologies for India's energy sector
- "MC²+" – Section 8 not-for-profit energy innovation platform led by Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas
  - backed by – ONGC, Indian Oil, BPCL, HPCL, GAIL, Oil India & Petronet LNG
- MC²+ Ignite – targets startups at Technology Readiness Levels (TRL) 4-7 to bridge gap between working prototypes & industry pilots
- Programme – to select ~30 startups, each eligible for milestone-linked convertible funding up to ₹2 Cr
- Partners – IIT Madras, IIT Kanpur, IIT Kharagpur, C-CAMP & Venture Center, Pune
- Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Hardeep Singh Puri | Constituency – Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Suresh Gopi

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News - 89

- Supreme Court – formed 5-member High-Powered Enquiry Committee (HPEC) to independently probe allegations of police excesses during student-led protests in Delhi and violence against police/security personnel
- Headed by – Justice R. Subhash Reddy (former Supreme Court judge)
- Petitions – also cited similar allegations involving protesters in Bihar demonstrating in solidarity

News - 90

- NBSS&LUP (ICAR), Nagpur – developed India's 1st "Digital Soil Texture Map"
  - released by – Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan (during ICAR's 98th Foundation Day celebrations)
- Digital Soil Texture Map – provides hectare-level digitised soil classification data across India, enabling identification of soil-property variations at smaller geographical scales
- Soil texture – based on relative proportion of sand, silt & clay, influencing water-holding capacity, drainage, aeration, root penetration, nutrient retention & irrigation needs
- Map development – combines conventional soil mapping with field observations, remote sensing, satellite imagery & AI-based analysis to estimate soil properties in unsampled areas

News - 91

- NSDC (MSDE) + Cultus Education + AWS = launched nationwide Cloud & AI skilling initiative targeting youth across India, especially Tier 2 & Tier 3 cities
  - Aim: To provide foundational cloud computing & AI training to 1.5 lakh learners through AWS digital training content
- AWS re/Start – to provide intensive job-oriented training to 10,000 participants through free cohort-based workforce development programme
- HQs of NSDC – New Delhi | CEO – Arun Kumar Pillai | Chairman – A. M. Naik (works under MoSDE)
- HQs of Cultus Education – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Country Head & Director – Gaurav Arora | MD – Nalin K. Singh
- HQs of AWS – Seattle, Washington, US | CEO – Matt Garman

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News - 92

- North Eastern Railway – operated its longest-ever freight train, 'Awadh Mahashakti', to increase railway's freight-carrying capacity
- It runs from Gonda to Sitapur in UP, covering a distance of ~160 km in 3 hrs & 50 minutes at average speed of 42 kmph
- It consisted of 3 rakes of BCN empty wagons, comprising 129 wagons in total, hauled by 3 engines
  - Operated by – Lucknow division
- HQs of North Eastern Railway (NER) – Gorakhpur, UP | General Manager – Uday Borwankar | Established in – 1952

Join us

News - 93

- UP approved an amendment removing mandatory 2-year gap requirement between successive maternity leaves
  - It allows eligible women government employees to avail 180 days of maternity leave twice during service period
  - Without needing to wait 2 years between 1st & 2nd leave
- It involves an amendment to Rule 153(1) of Uttar Pradesh Financial Handbook
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

News - 94

- Karnataka – prohibited manufacture, processing, packing, storage, transportation, distribution & sale of non-dairy "analogue paneer" for 1 year
- Karnataka became 6th Indian state to take such action
  - Previous 5 – Maharashtra, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh & Himachal Pradesh
- Issued by – Food Safety Division of Department of Food Safety & Drug Administration, Karnataka
  - Under – Sections 30(2)(a), 18 & 29 of 'Food Safety & Standards Act, 2006'
- Under 'Food Safety & Standards (Food Products Standards & Food Additives) Regulations, 2011', traditional paneer is recognised as a standardised milk-based food product
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

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News - 95

- Jyotiraditya M. Scindia – launched revamped 'Dak Sewa' & 'Dak MITRA' mobile apps
  - alongside inauguration of 14 newly renovated post office buildings across India
- Dak MITRA – designed mainly for Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS) & postal staff
- Dak Sewa – a citizen-facing application available in 23 Indian languages, enables tracking, e-Money Orders, charge calculations, insurance access, complaint logging, & digital payments via UPI, internet banking and cards
- Minister of Communications & DoNER: Jyotiraditya M. Scindia | Constituency – Guna, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Communications: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani
  MoS in Ministry of DoNER: Sukanta Majumdar

News - 96

- C.P. Radhakrishnan (VP) – launched India's 1st non-GMO, high-expansion popcorn maize hybrid seed
  - At Gourmet Popcornica factory in Musunuru, Eluru, Andhra Pradesh
- It was developed through a scientific & commercial collab between ICAR-IIMR & Gourmet Popcornica
- India currently permits no genetically modified food crop for commercial cultivation
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer

Join us

News - 97

- Union revised conditions for import of duty-free raw sugar
  - It removes a fixed Oct 31 deadline to process imported sugar & sell refined product in domestic market
- Now, importers must process & sell imported raw sugar within a period not exceeding 2 months from date of filing Bill of Entry, removing fixed calendar deadline
- Govt also permitted a 1-time conversion of existing Advance Authorisations issued under Standard Input-Output Norms (SION) E-52 into TRQ scheme

News - 98

- Centre relaunched "Kanda Express", a dedicated rail rake initiative to transport onions from its buffer stock to major consumption centres, from Aug 25, 2026
- 1st Kanda Express of this cycle, carrying 453.65 tonnes of onion in 21 wagons from Nashik, Maharashtra, reached Delhi
  - The onions are being sold at a subsidised rate of ₹35 per kg in Delhi-NCR
- Govt procures onions through agencies including NAFED & NCCF
- Kanda Express initiative – originally launched in 2024-25 to improve logistical efficiency for large-scale onion movement

News - 99

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan – launched "Mission Samriddh Gaon" at Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi
  - To develop a comprehensive & integrated model for building poverty-free, employment-rich villages
- Pilot models will be developed in Budni block of Sehore & Khategaon block of Dewas, both in MP
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

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International Affairs

News - 100

- Saudi Arabia + 13 other countries = to establish a defensive naval alliance, "Multinational Maritime Defence Coalition"
  - To protect commercial vessels navigating critical chokepoints
- Founding member – Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Bahrain, Qatar, Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt, Jordan, Yemen, Bangladesh, Nigeria, Sudan, Djibouti & Somalia
- Saudi Arabia – Riyadh – Saudi Riyal | PM – Mohammed bin Salman Al Saud | King – Salman bin Abdulaziz

News - 101

- Pacific Island nation of Nauru – changed its name to 'Republic of Naoero'
- Its short-form name will now be 'Naoero' | Its international code – to change to NRO (from NRU)
  - Its citizens will be referred to as 'dei-Naoero'

Join us

- Nauruan language (dorerin Naoero) – classified by UNESCO as 'severely endangered'
- Republic of Naoero – world's 3rd-smallest country by land area (after Vatican City & Monaco)
- Republic of Naoero – Yaren – Australian Dollar | President – David Adeang

News - 102

- Venezuela – formally withdraw from 'Rome Statute', treaty that established International Criminal Court (ICC)
- Under Article 127 of Rome Statute, a country's withdrawal becomes effective 1 year after formal notification to UN
- Venezuela – Caracas – Venezuelan bolivar | President – Delcy Rodríguez

News - 103

- Donald Trump signed 2 executive orders to limit birthright citizenship
  - It marks his 2nd major attempt to challenge scope of 14th Amendment
- 1st order expands definition of people administration says are ineligible for automatic citizenship upon birth in US to include "alien enemies of US, members of foreign terrorist organizations & large categories of people who lobby & act on behalf of foreign government(s)"
- 2nd order targets what administration calls "birth tourism" in which foreign nationals travel to US specifically to give birth so their children automatically receive citizenship
- 14th Amendment states that "all persons born or naturalized in US & subject to jurisdiction thereof, are citizens of US & of state wherein they reside"
- Currently, children of foreign diplomats are already excluded from automatic citizenship
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

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News - 104

- "Typhoon Dolphin" – made landfall near Yuhuan City in Zhejiang province on Aug 9, 2026
- Maximum sustained winds – over 150 km/h
  - It triggered National Meteorological Centre's (NMC) highest-level "red alert" under China's typhoon warning system
- Its name (Dolphin) – contributed by Hong Kong, referring to Chinese white dolphin (Sousa chinensis)
  - Name is maintained on a rotating list by Typhoon Committee at World Meteorological Organization (WMO)
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

News - 105

- India donated 5 Indian peacocks (4 blue peafowl & 1 rare white-feathered male) to UN Office at Geneva (UNOG)
- Arindam Bagchi (India's Permanent Representative to UN) – handed over birds to Tatiana Valovaya (UNOG DG)
- In 1981, then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi had sent a breeding pair from Delhi Zoo
- HQs of UN – New York City, US | Secretary General – António Guterres

Join us

News - 106

- In Aug 2026, Lebanon's parliament voted to abolish death penalty, becoming 1st Arab country to do so
  - It is replacing capital punishment with life imprisonment with aggravated hard labour
- Once signed, Lebanon will become 129th country worldwide to abolish capital punishment
- Lebanon – Beirut – Lebanese Pound | PM – Nawaf Salam | President – Joseph Aoun

News - 107

- 1st India-Israel Hackathon – concluded in Jerusalem | Theme – "Restorative Healthcare"
  - To draw students & individuals to develop technology-driven solutions to challenges in healthcare & rehabilitation
  - Conceived by – Ori Kadvil (a member of Indian Jewish community in Israel)
- J.P. Singh (Ambassador of India to Israel) – felicitated winners this week
  - Thapar University – serves as nodal partner on Indian side
- Among winning solutions (in Israel) – a wheelchair-mounted limb mobilisation system
  - It harnesses natural rotation of wheelchair's front wheel to enable controlled leg movement without using electricity
- Winning solution (in India) – real-time video processing & automated movement analysis
  - To assess limb movements of injured patients to track rehabilitation progress & support personalised recovery plans
- Israel – Jerusalem – Israeli Shekel | President – Isaac Herzog | PM – Benjamin Netanyahu

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News - 108

- WHO Regional Office for Africa – confirmed closure of poliovirus type 2 outbreaks in Burundi, Ghana, Guinea-Bissau, Republic of Congo & Uganda
- Assessment – reviewed disease surveillance, laboratory & epidemiological data, population immunity and vaccination campaign performance, confirming interruption of transmission in all 5 countries
- WHO Regional Director for Africa – Dr. Mohamed Janabi
- HQs of WHO – Geneva, Switzerland | DG – Tedros Adhanom | Member Countries – 194 | Founded in – 1948

News - 109

- US State Department – formally removed Syria from its list of 'State Sponsors of Terrorism'
- Now, only 3 countries remain on US list: Iran, Cuba & North Korea
- Syria – Damascus – Syrian Pound | Interim President – Ahmad al-Sharaa

Join us

Banking, Digital/Finance, Economic & Insurance Affairs

(Note: This chapter includes Digital/Financial Awareness and RBI Circulars & Notifications too.)

News - 110

- SBI Card + Google Pay = jointly launched 'Google Pay Flex SBI Card', a co-branded credit card
- It is Google Pay's 2nd co-branded credit card in India, after its 1st partnership with Axis Bank, launched in Dec 2025
- HQs of SBI Cards & Payment Services Ltd – Gurugram, Haryana | MD & CEO – Salila Pande
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998
  India Head – Preeti Lobana

News - 111

- NCDEX – launched a new MF transaction platform, "NCDEX Nidhi", alongside unveiling a new brand identity
  - To bridge investment gap in rural & semi-urban India, expanding mutual fund penetration beyond top 100 cities
- NCDEX Nidhi already onboarded 6 AMCs, including Nippon India MF, HDFC MF, Axis MF, LIC MF, Tata MF & Invesco MF
- AMFI reduced ARN registration fee for such distributors to ₹10,000 for corporate ARN registrations (from ₹40,000)
- HQs of NCDEX – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Ashish Bahuguna | MD & CEO – Arun Raste

News - 112

- Indian & Nepalese nationals may now carry Indian currency notes of ₹200 & ₹500 denominations into & out of Nepal
  - Up to a combined limit of ₹25,000 per person
- Notes must have been issued on or after Nov 9, 2016
  - Older ₹500 & ₹1,000 notes issued before that date will continue to remain prohibited in Nepal
- Nepalese nationals and foreign visitors, including Indian travellers, can bring up to $5,000, or its equivalent in other foreign currencies, into Nepal without making a customs declaration
  - This exemption applies only if denominations do not exceed ₹100
- Nepal – Kathmandu – Nepalese Rupee | President – Ram Chandra Poudel | PM – Balendra Shah

News - 113

- RBI – deferred implementation of revised Basel III Pillar 3 disclosure norms to April 1, 2027 (from Sep 30, 2026)
  - allowing banks additional time for IT system upgrades, data reporting & internal controls
- Basel III Pillar 3 – developed by Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS)
  - to promote market discipline through disclosures on capital adequacy, risk exposures, RWAs & risk management practices
- RBI issued 10 amendment directions revising Basel Pillar 3 disclosure instructions for CBs, SFBs & PBs
- Significant feature: alignment with Expected Credit Loss (ECL) provisioning framework & revised credit-risk capital norms

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- Disclosure policy – Banks must maintain board-approved disclosure policy, include key policy elements in year-end Pillar 3 report & ensure internal review and control processes before publication
- Disclosure level – requirements apply at top consolidated level of banking groups
  - Non-top group entities must provide standalone Pillar 3 disclosures
- First revised quarterly disclosure – applicable for quarter ending June 30, 2027
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 114

- DFS (MoF) launched India's 1st sovereign-backed Protection & Indemnity (P&I) insurance product
  - Under Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP) | Designed by – New India Assurance Company Ltd
- During proceedings, Secretary handed over 1st P&I policy document issued under BMIP to SCI Ltd
- BMIP – established to ensure uninterrupted maritime war-risk insurance capacity for Indian shipping stakeholders
  - Operationalised by DFS on May 12, 2026
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka

  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

News - 115

- India + Maldives = operationalised "Favara-UPI" cross-border payment corridor
  - 'Favara' – Maldives' instant payment system
- Currently, UPI is accepted in 10 countries – Singapore, UAE, Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka, France, Mauritius, Qatar, Cambodia & Greece
- Maldives – Male – Maldivian rufiyaa | President – Mohamed Muizzu

News - 116

- K. Rajaraman – extended as Chairperson of International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) by 27 months
- HQs of IFSCA – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | Chairman – K. Rajaraman | Ex. Director – Dipesh Shah | Established – 2020

News - 117

- SEBI – extended deadline for regulated entities (REs) to complete digital accessibility audits of their digital platforms & remediate audit findings to Oct 31, 2026
- SEBI released operational framework for 'GARUDA (Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement)'
  - GARUDA – a mechanism designed to simplify & accelerate launch of schemes by Alternative Investment Funds
- Now, regular AIF schemes can commence operations 10 working days after filing their Private Placement Memorandum through SEBI's Intermediary (SI) Portal
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 118

- Monisha Chakraborty – appointed as Executive Director of RBI, w.e.f. Aug 3, 2026
  - She is currently serving as – Chief General Manager-in-Charge in Department of Supervision
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 119

- IRDAI – approved a licence for ProTec General Insurance, a JV between M. Pallonji Group & True North's Divya Sehgal
- It enables company to undertake general insurance business in accordance with applicable regulatory framework
- IRDAI approved a wide-ranging set of regulatory reforms:

  (i) It operationalised Policyholders' Education & Protection Fund (PEPF) under Section 16A of IRDA Act, 1999

  (ii) It mandated tagging of authorised salespersons to every insurance proposal, policy & certificate

  (iii) It replaced periodic renewal of intermediary licences with perpetual registration backed by an annual fee regime
- It also approved amendments to:
  - "IRDAI (Actuarial, Finance and Investment Functions of Insurers) (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026"
  - "IRDAI (Registration, Capital Structure, Transfer of Shares and Amalgamation of Insurers) (Amendment) Regulations, 2026"
- IRDAI approved 'IRDAI (Manner and Procedure for Imposition of Penalties) Regulations, 2026'
  - It establishes a framework under Insurance Act, 1938& IRDA Act, 1999
- HQs of IRDAI – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Ajay Seth | Established in – 1999

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News - 120

- SEBI clarified rules governing off-market sale of shares of unlisted companies
  - When an existing shareholder sells such shares through a private, negotiated deal to not more than 200 buyers within a single financial year, transaction will not be treated as a public issue
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 121

- HDFC Bank – launched 2 new customised savings account variants - 'Max for Seniors' & 'Max for Her'
- 'Max for Seniors' account offers: Cyber fraud protection cover – up to ₹25,000 | Hospitalisation cover – up to ₹1 lakh
  - Debit card-linked accidental death cover – up to ₹3.19 Cr
- 'Max for Her' account offers: Hospitalisation cover – up to ₹1 lakh | Accidental death insurance cover – up to ₹10 lakh
- HQs of HDFC Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sashidhar Jagdishan | Tagline – "We understand your World"

Join us

News - 122

- 3rd Bi-monthly Monetary Policy FY27 – kept policy repo rate at 5.25% & retain monetary policy stance at 'neutral'
  - Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate – 5% | Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate & Bank Rate – 5.50%
- MPC raised its GDP growth forecast for FY27 – to 6.7% (from 6.6%)
- MPC lowered its CPI inflation projection – to 5% (from 5.1%)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 123

- SEBI proposed allowing issuance of Depository Receipts (DRs) against units of REITs & publicly listed InvITs
  - To widen investment options for overseas investors & attract foreign capital into India's real estate & infrastructure sectors
- Depository Receipts – foreign currency-denominated instruments issued by a foreign depository in a permissible jurisdiction against securities deposited with a domestic custodian in India
- Units of REITs & InvITs already qualify as 'permissible securities' under 'Depository Receipts Scheme, 2014'
- 'Foreign Exchange Management (Non-debt Instruments) Rules, 2019' – permit persons residing outside India to invest in REIT & InvIT units
- This proposal would apply only to REITs & publicly listed InvITs, excluding privately listed InvITs
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 124

- India – achieved near-universal banking coverage, with 99.92% of inhabited villages, now served by a banking outlet
- There are 58.77 crore Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) accounts in India | Combined balance – ₹3,12,414 Cr

News - 125

- RBI's recent circular on bulk deposits & uniform deposit rates, w.e.f. Oct 1, 2026, aims to improve transparency & standardisation in way banks offer deposit rates
- Banks required to disclose interest rates applicable on all deposits, including bulk deposits, in advance on their websites
- For bulk deposits specifically, banks must publish applicable interest rates by 10:00 am on every business day
  - Maximum grace period – 10 minutes
- Revised directions apply to commercial banks, SFBs, RRBs, local area banks, payments banks & urban cooperative banks
- RBI reiterated that deposit rates must remain uniform across all branches of a bank & for all customers
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 126

- As per data released by NPCI, India's UPI recorded its highest-ever monthly transaction volume in Jul 2026
  - With 23.66 billion transactions worth ₹29.88 lakh Cr (On a y-o-y basis, volume surged 22% & value rose 19%)
  - Previous volume record – 23.20 billion transactions set in May 2026 (worth ₹29.90 lakh Cr)
- On a daily basis, UPI processed an average of 763 million transactions in July | Avg daily transaction value – ₹96,383 Cr
- PhonePe – dominated India's UPI ecosystem with 10.48 billion transactions | Followed by – Google Pay, Paytm
- WhatsApp (150.48 million transactions) overtook CRED (141.78 million) in monthly transaction volume
- UPI is now live in 10 overseas markets: Bhutan, Singapore, UAE, France, Mauritius, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Qatar, Cambodia & Maldives
- Greece – connected for person-to-person transfers | Singapore & Nepal – support remittance linkages
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

News - 127

- Bajaj Gen Ins Ltd + Swiss Re Corporate Solutions = an MoU to expand commercial insurance offerings in India
- HQs of Bajaj General Insurance – Pune, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Dr. Tapan Singhel
- HQs of Swiss Re Corporate Solutions – Zurich, Switzerland | CEO – Ivan Gonzalez

News - 128

- Centralized Public Grievance Redress & Monitoring System monthly report for Jun 2026 – released by DARPG
- Insurance Division of DFS – ranked 3rd in Group A category of 'Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index (GRAI)' for Jun'26
  - Banking Division of DFS – ranked 6th in same category
- Group A category covers Ministries/Departments registering 500 or more grievances
- During Jun 2026, DFS disposed of 30,000+ grievances

News - 129

- RBI deferred implementation of its revised directions on loan recovery & engagement of recovery agents to Jan 1, 2027
- Regulated Entities that were not previously covered by certification requirements have been given a 1-year window
  - To ensure their recovery agents obtain certification from IIBF or similar recognised institutions
- RBI also modified provisions relating to technology-based restrictions on financed mobile devices
  - Device-locking mechanism be certified by original equipment manufacturer or operating system platform
- Original draft directions, issued under 'Banking Regulation Act, 1949', apply to commercial banks
- It restricts recovery calls & visits to between 8 am & 7 pm unless borrower requests otherwise
  - It requires borrowers to be informed at least 1 day in advance of any recovery-related visit
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  - Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 130

- RBI identified 17 NBFCs for inclusion in Upper Layer (NBFC-UL) for FY27, expanding list from 15 entities
- NBFCs with an asset size of at least ₹1 trillion qualify for consideration in Upper Layer
- 4 state-owned companies joined Upper Layer list for 1st time: REC Ltd, PFC, IRFC & HUDCO
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 131

- SBI Life Insurance + J&K Bank = partnered to bring comprehensive life insurance solutions closer to families across India
- Aim: To strengthen financial security & expand insurance penetration in J&K and Ladakh
- HQs of SBI Life Insurance – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Amit Jhingran | Founded in – 2001
- HQs of J&K Bank – Srinagar | MD & CEO – Amitava Chatterjee | Founded in – 1938 | Tagline – "Serving to Empower"

News - 132

- Standard Chartered Plc – received in-principle approval from IFSCA for distribution of capital market products from GIFT City
- Standard Chartered – 1st foreign bank to commence operations at GIFT City in 2020
- HQs of SCB India – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – P. D. Singh

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News - 133

- IndusInd Bank + EazyDiner = launched EazyDiner IndusInd Bank Platinum RuPay Credit Card in Mumbai
  - It is a lifetime-free co-branded credit card, with no joining fee or annual fee | Issued on – RuPay network
- HQs of IndusInd Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Rajiv Anand | Tagline – "We Make You Feel Richer"
- HQs of EazyDiner – Gurugram, Haryana | CEO – Sachin Pabreja

News - 134

- RBI released results of its 101st round of "Survey of Professional Forecasters (SPF)", conducted in Jul 2026
  - It pegged India's real GDP growth for FY27 at 6.6% (from 6.5% projected in 100th SPF round conducted in May 2026)
- Its FY28 forecasts suggest economy could move closer to a "Goldilocks" phase of steady growth
- In its Aug 2026 monetary policy review, MPC raised RBI's FY27 GDP growth forecast to 6.7% (from 6.6%)
  - It also lowered its CPI inflation projection to 5%
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 135

- India's Manufacturing GVA at constant prices – 10.7% in 2025-26, taking CAGR to 10.88% during 2022-23 to 2025-26
  - Manufacturing GVA at constant prices – 10.7% in 2025-26
- Share of Manufacturing in total GVA – 14.8% in 2025-26 (from 14.7% in 2022-23)
- As per Eco. Survey 2025-26, share of medium- & high-technology industries in India's manufacturing value – 46.3%
- India's HSBC Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) – 53.5 in Jul 2026

News - 136

- RBI released draft "Reserve Bank of India (Interest Rates on Loans and Advances) Directions, 2026"
- Now, interest rates would be determined with reference to an internal or external benchmark plus a risk-based spread
  - With lenders barred from pricing a loan below applicable benchmark
  - Benchmark generally reset at intervals not exceeding 3 months for major lenders
- For commercial banks, floating-rate retail loans & floating-rate loans to MSMEs will continue to be mandatorily linked to an external benchmark
  - This requirement would not be mandatory for NBFCs, AIFIs, RRBs & cooperative banks
- Internal benchmarks will have to follow a stricter, system-generated methodology
- It also requires lenders to maintain spread between benchmark rate & loan rate for at least 3 years
- These directions are proposed to take effect from Apr 1, 2027
  - RBI fixed Sep 11, 2026 as deadline for receiving public comments via its website or email
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

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News - 137

- The Wealth Company – launched "The Wealth Company IFSC FoF", a US-Dollar-denominated, open-ended Category III Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) based at GIFT City IFSC
  - It is managed by – Wealth Company Asset Management Pvt Ltd, a Fund Management Entity registered with IFSCA
- Under this structure, eligible non-resident investors do not need to separately undertake SEBI's FPI registration process
- NRIs & other eligible overseas investors can now access India's mutual fund market through a new GIFT City route

News - 138

- As per SEBI's 'Annual Report for 2025-26':
- World's leading market for Initial Public Offerings (IPOs) by number of issues during FY26 – India
  - Globally, in terms of funds raised: India – 3rd
- SEBI restructured minimum public offer framework by linking public float requirements to issue size
- SEBI extended timeline for largest listed companies to achieve mandatory 25% Minimum Public Shareholding to 10 yrs
- SEBI also allowed founders of new-age companies to retain Employee Stock Option Plans (ESOPs) granted before an IPO

Join us

- In debt market, corporate bond mobilisation – declined by 8.4% to ₹9.1 lakh Cr
  - Public debt issuances – rose nearly 39% | Municipal bond fundraising – surged to ₹1,756 Cr through 14 issues
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 139

- SEBI – relaxed timelines for municipalities with listed debt securities to submit financial results to stock exchanges
- Listed municipalities will now have to submit half-yearly unaudited financial results within 60 days of end of 1st half-year
  - From earlier 45-day deadline
- Annual audited financial results will have to be submitted within 90 days from end of financial year (from 60 days)
- SEBI also introduced a 2-step escrow account mechanism for issuers that are pooled finance vehicles or SPVs set up under Govt's Pooled Finance Development Fund Scheme
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 140

- RBI released draft guidelines proposing 'on-tap' licensing of Urban Cooperative Banks (UCBs)
  - Eligible credit cooperative societies with a minimum deposit base of ₹10,000 Cr can apply for conversion into UCBs
- In initial phase, only Multi-State Credit Cooperative Societies registered under Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002, will be eligible to apply
- Such societies must: Be in existence for at least 10 years | Maintain minimum deposits of ₹10,000 Cr
  - Possess a minimum net worth of ₹300 Cr based on audited financial statements as on Mar 31 of previous FY
  - A Capital to Risk-weighted Assets Ratio (CRAR) – at least 12% | Net Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) – below 3%
- Eligible societies must submit a detailed 5-year business plan with applications submitted through RBI's PRAVAAH portal
- Applicants whose proposals are rejected will not be eligible to apply for another banking licence for 3 years
- Only 3 cooperative institutions currently meet ₹10,000 Cr deposit threshold: Buldana Urban Co-operative Credit Society
  - Lokmanya Multipurpose Co-operative Society
  - Repco Bank (Repatriates Cooperative Finance and Development Bank Ltd.)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 141

- Indian Bank approved close to ₹500 Cr in MSME loans in a credit outreach programme held in New Delhi
  - Sanction Tickets – handed over to 128 beneficiaries by Binod Kumar (Managing Director & CEO)
- This programme also mobilised loan proposals worth ₹1,254 Cr
- Indian bank also launched a 'Unified MSME Portal' & will roll out MSME GST within 7 days
  - Under which loan eligibility will be calculated directly from a customer's GST returns
- MSMEs contribute 30+% of India's GDP & Delhi-NCR contributes around 4.45% of Indian Bank's total MSME business
- HQs of Indian Bank – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | MD & CEO – Binod Kumar | Tagline – "Your Own Bank"

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News - 142

- Amit Shah received a dividend cheque of ₹22.90 Cr from Repco Bank, on behalf of GoI
  - It represents a 30% dividend on Centre's share capital of ₹76.32 Cr in bank for FY26
- HQs of Repco Bank – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Chairman – E. Santhanam | MD – O.M. Gokul | Established in – 1969
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 143

- EXIM Bank of India – to act as implementing agency for Interest Subvention Support Scheme on pre- & post-shipment export credit under Export Promotion Mission (EPM)
- Supplementary or additional claims from lending banks for Jan-Mar 2026 quarter – to be processed by RBI
- Export credit – to be sanctioned & disbursed by lending institutions in accordance with RBI's consolidated directions
- EXIM Bank – established by an Act of Parliament in Sep 1981 & wholly owned by GoI
- HQs of EXIM Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD – Harsha Bangari | Founded in – 1982

News - 144

- As per MoSPI, India will use output Producer Price Index (PPI) for deflation in both annual & quarterly GDP data
  - Replacing – Wholesale Price Index (WPI), wherever applicable
- PPI measures average change in prices received by producers for their goods & services before they reach consumers
- Existing WPI series, with base year 2011-12, tracks 697 items across 3 major groups:
  - Primary Articles | Fuel & Power | Manufactured Products
- A major feature of revised GDP framework is adoption of 'Double Deflation Method'
  - Output values are adjusted using Output PPI & input costs are adjusted using relevant input price indices
  - Difference between inflation-adjusted output & input provide a more accurate estimate of Real GVA
- Government already updated base year to 2022-23 (from 2011-12)
- MoSPI introduced India's 1st trial version of Index of Services Production (ISP) in Jul 2026
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 145

- MoSPI released CPI on base year 2024=100 for Jul 2026
- Y-o-y All India CPI inflation rate – 4.45% (Provisional) (from 4.38% in Jun 2026)
  - Rural inflation rate – 4.84% | Urban inflation rate – 3.96%
- Food inflation, based on CFPI – 5.52% (Provisional) | Rural food inflation – 5.79% | Urban food inflation – 5.05%
- Housing inflation – 2.22% (Provisional) | Rural – 2.80% | Urban – 2.01%
- MoSPI revised CPI base year to 2024=100 (from 2012=100), with revised series released on Feb 12, 2026
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

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News - 146

- SEBI issued a consultation paper proposing a mandatory colour-coded "Credit Risk-o-Meter" for debt securities
  - Aim: To help investors, particularly retail investors, assess credit risk more easily
- It will use a standardised, colour-coded visual scale mapping existing credit ratings, ranging from AAA to D
  - Into 6 colour-coded risk categories, ranging from "lowest credit risk" for AAA-rated securities to "high to very high risk of default" for securities rated B+, B, B-, C+, C, C- & D
- Issuers & Online Bond Platform Providers (OBPPs) would be required to display Credit Risk-o-Meter in offer documents, abridged prospectuses, private placement memorandums, advertisements & on OBPP web & mobile platforms
- OBPPs would also be required to update Credit Risk-o-Meter immediately whenever underlying credit rating changes
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 147

- CBDT operationalised "Foreign Assets of Small Taxpayers-Disclosure Scheme (FAST-DS), 2026"
  - Notified under Chapter IV (Sections 130-144) of Finance Act, 2026
  - 1-time window open time (for eligible small taxpayers) – Aug 16, 2026 to Dec 31, 2026
- It covers 4 categories of foreign holdings:
  - Undisclosed assets located outside India
  - Undisclosed foreign income chargeable to tax in India
  - Assets acquired abroad during a period of non-residence but not declared on becoming a resident
  - Assets bought from already-taxed income but omitted from relevant schedule in income tax return
- Valuation date for assets covered under this scheme – Mar 31, 2026
- Declarations must be filed electronically in Form 1 by Dec 31, 2026
  - After which Principal DG or DG of Income-tax (Systems) will pass an order determining payable amount in Form 2
  - Then, declarant can pay amount within 2 months without interest
- HQs of CBDT – New Delhi | Chairman – Ravi Agrawal | Formed in – 1944

News - 148

- As per fortnightly data released by RBI: Growth in bank deposits – 15.4% y-o-y as of Jul 31, 2026
  - Deposit growth – rose to 15.4% by Jul 31 (from 12.7% as of Jul 15)
- Aggregate deposits – increased by ₹6.61 trillion during fortnight ended Jul 31
  - Now, outstanding deposit base – ₹269.41 trillion (2.5% rise during fortnight)
- Time deposits – ₹4.21 trillion of fortnightly increase | Demand deposits – rose by ₹2.40 trillion
- RBI's special Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] swap facility – introduced in Jun 2026
  - For fresh FCNR(B) deposits with a maturity of 3 to 5 years
  - Banks mobilised $36.7 billion through FCNR(B) deposits under this facility by Jul 31
- For FY27 so far, aggregate deposits – rose by ₹7.13 trillion (from ₹7.69 trillion during corresponding period of FY26)

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- Time deposits – rose by ₹9.70 trillion | Demand deposits – declined by ₹2.58 trillion

- Credit growth: Bank credit – 19.3% y-o-y (from 17.7% as of Jul 15)
  - Bank credit – increased by ₹3.43 trillion during fortnight to ₹220.78 trillion
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 149

- Central Govt cut windfall tax (export duty) on petrol to zero, w.e.f. Aug 15, 2026 (from ₹3.5 per litre)
  - Export duty on diesel – ₹24 per litre (from ₹25.5) | Tax on Aviation Turbine Fuel – ₹19.5 per litre (from ₹22)
- Windfall tax – a levy imposed by a govt on companies that earn unusually high or "windfall" profits due to external factors beyond their control
- In petroleum sector, it is levied as a Special Additional Excise Duty on domestically produced crude oil & on export of refined petroleum products

News - 150

- IndusInd Bank – imposed with a monetary penalty of ₹59.20 lakh by RBI
  - For non-compliance with certain provisions of directions issued by RBI on 'Interest Rate on Deposits' & 'Securitisation of Standard Assets'
- Penalty was imposed under – Section 47A(1)(c) read with Section 46(4)(i) of Banking Regulation Act, 1949
- RBI also penalised 3 NBFCs for regulatory lapses identified during separate statutory inspections:
  - Fusion Finance – ₹2.7 lakh | Northern Arc Capital – ₹6.2 lakh | Muthoot MCred – ₹3.1 lakh
- HQs of IndusInd Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Rajiv Anand | Tagline – "We Make You Feel Richer"

News - 151

- SEBI proposed a comprehensive overhaul of its settlement framework through a consultation paper on review of "SEBI (Settlement Proceedings) Regulations, 2018" & draft "SEBI (Settlement of Proceedings) Regulations, 2026"
- Aim: To make settlement of enforcement proceedings simpler, faster & more predictable while retaining deterrence
- SEBI suggested a simpler formula for calculating settlement amounts
  - Scrapping additional 20% settlement charge currently levied in certain multiple-proceeding cases
- A key proposal is a fast-track settlement route for cases involving amounts of up to ₹10 lakh
  - Under which such cases would move directly from Internal Committee to a panel of Whole Time Members
- During FY26, SEBI received 439 settlement applications & disposed of 170
  - 199 – rejected, withdrawn or returned | 499 – pending at end of year
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

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News - 152

- As per IMF's April 2026 World Economic Outlook, Japan has world's highest government debt-to-GDP ratio in 2026
  - Projected at 204.4% of GDP
- 2nd – Singapore (171.9%) | 3rd – Sudan (169.1%) | 4th – Bahrain (152.4%) | 5th – Italy (138.4%) | 6th – Greece (136.9%)
- US – ranks 9th (125.8%) | France – 118.4% | Canada – 110.7% | Belgium – 109.2%
- India is projected to have $3.46 trillion in government debt in 2026 in absolute terms
  - World's 8th most indebted country by this measure
- HQs of IMF – Washington, D.C., USA | MD & Chairperson – Kristalina Georgieva | Member countries – 191

News - 153

- SEBI launched a revamped 'Incident Reporting Portal' and a new 'Cyber Suraksha Portal'
  - To strengthen cybersecurity, incident reporting & information sharing across securities market ecosystem
- Revamped Incident Reporting Portal – aligned with FSB's Format for Incident Reporting Exchange (FIRE)
- Cyber Suraksha Portal – to serve as a central hub for sharing cybersecurity-related information among stakeholders
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 154

- YES BANK – launched "YES Essence" Credit Card, designed specifically for salaried women
- HQs of Yes Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Vinay Muralidhar Tonse | Tagline – "Experience our Expertise"

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News - 155

- Qatar Post + India Post = unveiled "PosTransfer powered by UPI" a cross-border remittance service
  - It enables customers in Qatar to send money directly to UPI-enabled bank accounts in India
- Developed through collab between = Qatar Post + India Post + UPU's Interconnection Platform + NIPL
- Transactions can be initiated for amounts between QAR 10 & QAR 4,000
  - Subject to a per-transaction cap of ~$1,048 with a flat service charge of QAR 15 per transaction
- Qatar – Doha – Riyal | PM – Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman bin Jassim Al Thani

News - 156

- 16th edition (in monthly series) of Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) Monthly Bulletin for July 2026 – released by NSO
- India's Unemployment Rate (UR) among persons aged 15 years & above – declined to 5.1% (from 5.5% in Jun 2026)
  - Rural UR – fell to 4.5% (from 5% in Jun 2026) | Urban UR – remained steady at 6.7% (from 6.6% in Jun 2026)
  - Male UR – declined to 5% (from 5.3% in Jun 2026)| Female UR – fell to 5.4% (from 5.9% in Jun 2026)
- Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) for persons aged 15 years & above – rose to 55.4% (from 54.4% in Jun 2026)
  - Rural LFPR – rose to 58% (from 56.6% in Jun 2026)

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- Under Current Weekly Status (CWS) approach, a person is considered unemployed if they did not work even for 1 hour on any day during reference week but sought or were available for work for at least 1 hour during that period
- HQs of NSO – New Delhi | Chairperson – Dr Saibal Chattopadhyay

News - 157

- Razorpay – launched "Vulcan", India's 1st transformer-based AI foundation model built specifically for payments
  - Aim: To make digital transactions more reliable, secure & predictable at scale
- India's digital commerce market – projected to reach $350 billion by 2030
- HQs of Razorpay – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Harshil Mathur | Co-founders – Harshil Mathur & Shashank Kumar

News - 158

- PMFPL – launched its Loan Against Silver product from Chandigarh
  - It became India's 1st NBFC to set up exclusive Silver Loan branches
- RBI introduced 'Reserve Bank of India (Lending Against Gold and Silver Collateral) Directions, 2025'
  - It formally enabled eligible regulated lenders to accept silver as collateral for loans
- Customers can avail loans ranging from ₹2,000 to ₹15 lakh against eligible silver jewellery, ornaments & approved silver coins
- HQs of PMFPL – Chandigarh | MD – Sat Paul Bansal | Established in – 2010

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News - 159

- Anand Gopal Mahindra (Chairman of Mahindra Group) – re-appointed as a part-time, non-official director on Central Board of RBI for 4 years
- S. Somanath (former ISRO Chairman) – appointed as a part-time, non-official director on Central Board of RBI for 4 yrs
- Now, RBI Central Board comprises 11 members, including: Governor – Sanjay Malhotra
- RBI Central Board – established under Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934
  - It includes Governor & up to 4 Deputy Governors & non-official directors nominated by GoI from various sectors
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 160

- Prudential HCL Health Insurance Ltd – entered India's health insurance market
  - Valued at ~$16 billion in gross written premiums in FY 2026
- It received its Certificate of Registration from IRDAI, becoming India's 8th standalone health insurer & IRDAI's 3rd new registration granted in 2026
- Prudential Health India is structured as a 70:30 JV between Prudential plc (UK) & HCL Group (India)
- It will offer customers access to a network of more than 12,000 hospitals

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- Prudential already holds 22% in ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- It also agreed to acquire a 75% stake in Bharti Life Insurance for an initial ₹3,500 Cr
- HQs of Prudential HCL Health Ins. Ltd. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Amit Dave | Established in – 2025

News - 161

- Policybazaar – launched a dedicated "Student Term Plan", in partnership with leading insurance companies
  - It offers young Indians an early & affordable route to financial protection
- It is designed for students aged 18 to 25 years & provides life cover options starting from ₹25 lakh
- Premiums can start at ₹388 per month for ₹50 lakh life cover for an 18-year-old purchasing a 30-year term plan
- Students can opt for coverage periods of 30 to 40 years & choose from annual, semi-annual, quarterly or monthly premium payment options
- Insurer partners participating in offering include ICICI Prudential Life Insurance & Axis Max Life Insurance
- HQs of Policybazaar – Gurugram, Haryana | CEO – Sarbvir Singh

News - 162

- Wizzmoni Financial Services Ltd (Kerala) + Oman Air = to launch co-branded "Wizz Voyager" Multi-Currency Card
  - It is an AI-powered travel card supporting multiple global currencies
- Wizzmoni – an NBFC & Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) licensed financial services provider
- HQs of Wizzmoni Financial Services Ltd – Kerala | CEO – Krishnan R.

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News - 163

- IDFC FIRST Bank – priced its inaugural US$500 million 3-year fixed-rate senior notes
  - It marks bank's 1st international bond issuance & its entry into global debt capital markets
- Notes, due 2029, carry a fixed coupon of 5.625% & were placed with investors outside US in Regulation S format
  - Allotment is scheduled for – Aug 25, 2026 | Interest paid twice a year on Aug 25 & Feb 25
  - 1st interest payment due on – Feb 25, 2027
- Notes are unsecured & will be repaid on maturity date of Aug 25, 2029, unless redeemed earlier
- HQs of IDFC First Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – V. Vaidyanathan | Established in – 2018

News - 164

- Bajaj Gen Ins – launched "ProShield", a packaged motor insurance solution for defence personnel, alongside "VPAY 2.0"
  - VPAY 2.0 – next-generation motor insurance offering for connected & electric vehicles
- HQs of Bajaj General Insurance – Pune, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Dr. Tapan Singhel

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News - 165

- Razorpay + RBL Bank = launched "Multi-Currency Exchange Earners' Foreign Currency (EEFC) Account"
- Merchants can receive settlements in USD, Euro, British Pound, AED & Singapore Dollar directly into their EEFC accounts
- EEFC account – a foreign currency account held with an RBI-authorised bank, allowing businesses that earn foreign exchange to credit 100% of their foreign currency receipts directly into account without converting to INR
- Eligible credits include – inward remittances, export proceeds & professional service fees
- HQs of Razorpay – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Harshil Mathur | Co-founders – Harshil Mathur & Shashank Kumar

News - 166

- As per RBI, forex inflows mobilised under its special USD-INR forex swap facility – $72.85 billion
- FCNR(B) deposits accounted for majority of inflows – $65.397 billion (~90% of total)
  - Followed by – Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings ($4.860 billion) & ECBs ($2.591 billion)
- RBI introduced special USD-INR forex swap facility on Jun 8, 2026
- Foreign exchange reserves – rose by $9.905 billion to $716.90 billion during week ended Aug 14, 2026
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 167

- Total 29 FDI proposals worth ₹4,895.65 Cr have been reported as of Aug 20, 2026
- Government approval remains required if an LBC company holds a controlling stake in investment firm & proposals from entities directly based in a land-bordering country remain subject to government approval
- This rule applies to investors based in China, Bangladesh, Pakistan, Bhutan, Nepal, Myanmar & Afghanistan

News - 168

- PNB + Indian Army – an MoU to offer "PNB LUXURA Metal" Credit Card for Army officers & "PNB Parakram" Credit Card for JCOs and Other Ranks (OR) personnel
- PNB Parakram Credit Card – features biodegradable card design as an environmentally conscious alternative
- HQs of PNB – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Ashok Chandra | Tagline – "The Name You Can Bank Upon"
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain

News - 169

- VinFast India + Federal Bank – an MoU to provide inventory financing solutions for VinFast's authorised dealer network
- Federal Bank will offer customised inventory financing to help dealers optimise working capital, maintain vehicle inventory & meet customer demand
- VinFast – opened 60th 3S dealership in India | It targets 75 dealerships nationwide by year-end
- HQs of VinFast India – Gurgaon, Haryana | CEO – Tapan Kumar Ghosh
- HQs of Federal Bank – Aluva, Kerala | MD & CEO – Krishnan Venkat Subramanian | Tagline – "Your Perfect Banking Partner"

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News - 170

- Janmejaya Kumar Sinha, Syed Akbaruddin & Annie George Mathew – appointed as part-time, Non-Official Directors on Central Board of RBI for 4 years, w.e.f. Aug 24, 2026
  - Under Section 8(1)(c) of Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934
- Now, RBI Central Board's strength – 14 members (from 11)
- Annie George Mathew – also a full-time member of Sixteenth Finance Commission
- Anand Mahindra – reappointed as a part-time, Non-Official Director for 4 years, w.e.f. Aug 20, 2026
- S. Somanath Sreedhara Panicker – appointed as a part-time, Non-Official Director for 4 years
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 171

- India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) completed 10 years of operation on Aug 25, 2026
- UPI – launched in 2016 by NPCI under regulatory oversight of RBI
- Over past 10 years: Annual transaction volume – expanded to over 24,162 crore transactions in FY26
  - With a Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) of – 188%
  - Total transaction value – rose to ~₹314 lakh Cr in FY26 (from ₹0.07 lakh Cr in FY17)
- Network of live banks on UPI – expanded to 703 banks by FY26 (from 21 at launch)
- UPI now commands an 84% share of India's overall digital payments landscape
- In FY26, split between transaction volume & value:
  - Person-to-Merchant (P2M) transactions – 63% of overall volume & 29% of overall value
    - Small-ticket payments below ₹500 – 86% of total P2M volume
  - Person-to-Person (P2P) transactions – 71%
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

News - 172

- SBI is planning to raise threshold for AI-led cheque processing to ₹1 lakh (from ₹10,000)
- In FY26, SBI used AI-led underwriting to assess nearly ₹1 lakh Cr in MSME loans
  - Covering loans of up to ₹5 Cr each for both new-to-bank & existing customers
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 173

- Citigroup + Axis Bank = partnered to finance NRIs investing in foreign-currency deposits with Indian lender
- Axis Bank will provide standby letters of credit allowing NRIs to leverage amount they invest in Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits held with Axis Bank

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- USD-INR forex swap facility – introduced in Jun 2026 to encourage banks to mobilise FCNR(B) deposits, ECBs & OFCBs
- As of Aug 21, 2026, banks mobilised $72.85 billion in total forex inflows under swap facility
  - Including $65.4 billion through FCNR(B) deposits alone
- HQs of Citigroup – New York, US | CEO – Jane Fraser
- HQs of Axis Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Amitabh Chaudhry | Tagline – "Badhti ka Naam Zindagi"

Defence Affairs

News - 174

- Indian Navy – launched 'Machilipatnam' (BY 529) at a ceremony held at Cochin Shipyard
  - It is 7th of 8 Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC) being built by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)
- Indian Navy commissioned 'Malvan', another vessel in same series, in Jul 2026
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 175

- 'Nipun' – delivered by Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL) to Indian Navy at Visakhapatnam
  - It is 2nd indigenously designed & built Diving Support Vessel (DSV) constructed for Indian Navy
- It will also serve as Mother Ship for Deep Submergence Rescue Vessel (DSRV)
- 1st vessel in this series – 'Nistar', delivered & formally commissioned in July 2025 at Visakhapatnam
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar
- HQs of Hindustan Shipyard Ltd – Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh | CMD – Chandrasekharan Raghuram

News - 176

- SDAL demonstrated its indigenous "Bhargavastra" vehicle-mounted, multi-layered Counter-Swarm Drone System to a visiting Indian Army team, at company's facility in Nagpur, Maharashtra
  - As part of a status review under a Project Sanction Order (PSO) of MoD's Make-II initiative
- It can detect larger unmanned aerial vehicles at ranges of up to 10 km & smaller drones at up to 6 km
  - With an interception range of 2.5 km
- HQs of SDAL – Nagpur, Maharashtra | CEO – Manish Satyanarayan Nuwal

News - 177

- Rajnath Singh – unveiled 2 major policy reforms for ICG at an event held at Kartavya Bhavan-2, New Delhi
- 1st reform introduces a gender-neutral framework for induction of officers into ICG
  - It allows women candidates to be inducted into both Short Service Appointments & Permanent Appointments
  - Existing women officers on Permanent Appointments will be eligible for promotion to senior ranks

Join us

- Serving women officers on Short Service Appointments will have option to convert to Permanent Appointments
- 2nd reform streamlines administrative procedures for granting ex-gratia compensation to families of personnel reported missing at sea while on duty
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 178

- General Dhiraj Seth – launched indigenously developed Xtreme Weather Grade (XWG) Diesel
  - It is a specialised fuel jointly developed by – Indian Army & Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs)
- XWG Diesel remains fully functional at temperatures as low as minus 42°C
- It is compliant with BS-VI standards & IS 1460:2025 specifications
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain

News - 179

- Indian Navy – launched "DSC A24 (Yard 329)", 5th & final vessel of Diving Support Craft (DSC) Project, at Titagarh, Kolkata
  - It was launched at Hooghly River
- All 5 vessels under DSC Project were constructed by Titagarh Naval Systems Limited (TNSL)
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

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News - 180

- IAF conducted Exercise "ROTOR CLAP-III" at Pokhran Field Firing Range in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan
  - Theme – 'Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems (Counter-UAS)'
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 181

- 8th Indian Navy-US Navy Explosive Ordnance Disposal Exercise 2026 – commenced at Southern Naval Command, Kochi
- 'Explosive Ordnance Disposal' refers to detection, identification, rendering safe, recovery & disposal of explosive devices
- Southern Naval Command, Kochi – functions as one of 3 principal commands of Indian Navy
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 182

- 'Shruti', Indian Navy's 2nd Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel – launched by GRSE, Kolkata, designated Yard 3037
  - 'Sanghmitra', 1st NGOPV from shipyard – launched in May 2026
  - Length – 113 metres | Width – 14.6 metres | Displacement – 3,000 tonnes | Top speed – up to 23 knots
- GRSE – constructing 4 NGOPVs as part of Indian Navy's wider 11-ship NGOPV programme

Join us

- It is being executed concurrently by – GRSE Kolkata & Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)

- HQs of GRSE – Kolkata, West Bengal | Chairman & MD – P. R. Hari | Founded in – 1884

News - 183

- Exercise Talisman Sabre 2027, Australia's largest bilateral military exercise – to will be held from Aug 9-22, 2027
- 2nd edition of India-Australia Defence Ministers' Dialogue – held on June 1, 2026
  - Co-chaired by – Rajnath Singh (Defence Minister) & Richard Marles (Australia's Deputy PM & Minister for Defence)
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

News - 184

- "Udara Shakti 2026" (bilateral Exercise) – commenced at Subang Air Base, Malaysia, by IAF & RMAF (Aug 10-14, 2026)
- Opening ceremony was held at Air Warfare Centre Auditorium, Subang Air Base
  - Officiated jointly by – Colonel Shamsul Shahreen Isa (RMAF) Parijat Jha (Group Captain of IAF)
- It involves 4 Indian Rafale fighters from 101 Squadron & 2 C-17 Globemaster III transport aircraft from 81 Squadron
- Malaysia deployed 2 Su-30MKM fighters from No. 12 Squadron, 2 F/A-18D Hornets from No. 18 Squadron & 1 Airbus A400M transport aircraft from No. 8 Squadron
- Malaysia – Kuala Lumpur – Ringgit | PM – Anwar Ibrahim | King – Sultan Ibrahim Iskandar

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News - 185

- CSL delivered "MS Maria" to HS Schiffahrts UG (haftungsbeschränkt) & Co. KG (Germany) at Kochi
  - It is 2nd of 8-vessel HS EcoFreighter series of Multi-Purpose Vessels (MPVs)
  - 1st vessel in series – "MS Heinz" (on Jan 12, 2026)
- Designed by – Groot Ship Design (Netherlands) | Constructed at – CSL
- In this 8-vessel order, each vessel is valued at approximately ₹110 Cr
- HQs of Cochin Shipyard – Kochi, Kerala | Chairman & MD – Jose V J | Incorporated in – 1972

News - 186

- INS Sudarshini – entered port of Ponta Delgada, Azores, Portugal, as part of ongoing 'Lokayan 2026' voyage
  - marking successful completion of a 19-day trans-Atlantic passage from Boston, USA
- INS Sudarshini – concluded her port call at Ponta Delgada having travelled 15,000+ nautical miles during Lokayan 2026
- INS Sudarshini + NRP Sagres = to undertake a joint Passing Exercise (PASSEX) at sea

News - 187

- MoD + TASL + NIBE Ltd = signed contracts for Indian Army's acquisition of loiter munition systems | Worth – ₹1,577 Cr
  - It covers 84 loiter munition systems, 840 loiter munitions & associated equipment, with a strike range of 100+ km
- Procurement was processed under 'Buy (Indian)' category through Fast Track Procedure

Join us

- Following tender floated by Army in Jul 2026, in which 3 vendors, TASL, NIBE & A-Vision, cleared technical evaluation

- Overall indigenous content (mandatory) – 60%
- DAC – accorded Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) for procurement of loiter munition systems for Army's artillery regiments
  - As part of ₹79,000 Cr worth of defence proposals cleared in Dec 2025
- HQs of NIBE Ltd – Pune, Maharashtra | CMD & CEO – Ganesh Ramesh Nibe
- HQs of TASL – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Banmali Agrawala | MD & CEO – Sukaran Singh
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 188

- Kawa UAV Pvt Ltd (brand name: HoverIt; Lucknow, UP) – conducted maiden flight of "Divyastra Mk3"
  - India's 1st indigenous jet-powered loitering munition
- Loitering munition – an unmanned weapon system to remain airborne over or near a potential target area before identifying & striking a target
- DRDO + BDL + Adani Defence Systems & Technologies = partnered for development & production of this missile
  - System was integrated on UAVs developed by Newspace Research & Technologies (Bengaluru)

News - 189

- 15th edition of India-Thailand Joint Military Exercise "MAITREE-XV" – to be held at Vibhavadi Rangsit Camp in Surat Thani, Thailand (from Aug 18-31, 2026)
  - An 85-member Indian Army contingent departed for Thailand to participate in MAITREE-XV
- Indian contingent – represented by troops from 9 Gorkha Rifles
- Royal Thai Army contingent – comprises personnel from 3rd Battalion, 25th Infantry Brigade, 5th Division
- Exercise MAITREE – instituted in 2006
- MAITREE-XIV – conducted at Foreign Training Node, Umroi, Meghalaya, in Sep 2025
- Thailand – Bangkok – Thai Baht | King – Maha Vajiralongkorn | PM – Anutin Charnvirakul

News - 190

- MoD + General Atomics Aeronautical Systems (US) = a ₹1,943 Cr contract to lease 2 additional "MQ-9B" SeaGuardian High-Altitude Long-Endurance (HALE) Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS) for Indian Navy
- MQ-9B Sea Guardian – remain airborne for over 30-40 hours depending on configuration
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

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News - 191

- HAL + BEML + ADSTL = to manufacture fuselage structures for indigenously designed & developed "Prachand" Light Combat Helicopter (LCH)
  - It marks 1st time private industry integrated into production of Prachand helicopter fuselage structures
- BEML will manufacture 48 fuselage structures & Adani Defence will produce 42
  - HAL will manufacture remaining fuselages as part of ongoing series-production programme
- HAL is currently executing orders worth ₹62,700 Cr for 156 Prachand helicopters, comprising 90 for Indian Army & 66 for IAF
- HQs of HAL – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CMD – Ravi K
- HQs of BEML Limited – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CMD – Shantanu Roy
- HQs of ADSTL – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | CEO – Ashish Rajvanshi | Established in – 2015

News - 192

- CSL (Kochi) delivered "Mangrol" to Indian Navy, under "Aatmanirbhar Bharat" initiative
  - It is 3rd of 8 indigenously designed & constructed Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)
  - It is powered by – a Diesel Engine-Waterjet Propulsion system
- Designed & constructed in accordance with classification rules of Det Norske Veritas (DNV)
- This delivery forms part of an 8-vessel ASW-SWC programme being executed by Cochin Shipyard for Navy
- HQs of Cochin Shipyard – Kochi, Kerala | Chairman & MD – Jose V J | Incorporated in – 1972

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News - 193

- D-Propulse (incubated at IIT Madras) – successfully demonstrated India's 1st indigenous 5 kN air-breathing Rotating Detonation Engine (RDE) integrated with an aerospike nozzle
  - Conducted at – a DRDO government test facility
- It is also 1st successful demonstration of an indigenous Rotating Detonation Engine at this thrust class in India

News - 194

- IAF successfully concluded its participation in 2 pivotal international flight engagements:
  - "Exercise Pitch Black 2026" – in Australia | "Exercise Udara Shakti 2026" – in Malaysia
- 'Exercise Pitch Black 2026' – hosted by Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)
- 'Exercise Udara Shakti 2026' – hosted by Royal Malaysian Air Force (RMAF)
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 195

- NSTL (DRDO), Visakhapatnam – signed 2 LAToT to strengthen indigenous defence manufacturing
- Submarine Fired Decoy (SFD) "Mohini" – technology transferred to Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)

Join us

- LM2500 Gas Turbine – fabrication, installation & commissioning technology transferred to Vertex Engineering Systems Pvt. Ltd., Hyderabad
- LAToT – enables DRDO-developed technologies to be transferred to Indian industries for manufacturing, fabrication, installation & commissioning under Make in India & Atmanirbhar Bharat
- In April 2026, NSTL + BHEL = LAToT for LM2500 Gas Turbine Infrared Suppression System (GT-IRSS) used on naval vessels
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 196

- India's 1st fully indigenised AK-203 assault rifle, "Sher" – manufactured & test-fired at Korwa facility of Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited (IRRPL) in Amethi, UP
- IRRPL – incorporated in 2019 under an inter-governmental agreement
  - OFB – represented India | Kalashnikov Concern & Rosoboronexport – represented Russia
- Indian shareholding passed to defence PSUs Advanced Weapons & Equipment India Ltd and Munitions India Ltd
- IRRPL already signed a contract to deliver 6,01,427 'AK-203' rifles to Indian armed forces by deadline of Oct 2032

Sports & Games

News - 197

- "World Junior Squash Championships" – held at Niagara-on-the-Lake, Canada
- Anahat Singh – became 1st Indian to win Girls' Singles final | Defeated – Ruqayya Salem (Egypt)
- In boys' singles event – Aryaveer Dewan was India's best performer, reaching last 16
- Anahat is currently ranked – World No. 20 on senior PSA Tour

News - 198

- "Commonwealth Games 2026" – held in Glasgow
- Dilip Mahadu Gavit (India) – won gold in men's 100m T47 final | Silver – Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath (India)
  - Bronze – Kevin Santos (England)
- Gavit clocked a Games record & season-best time of 10.71 seconds
  - He also became 1st Indian male athlete to win a Commonwealth Games gold medal in para athletics
- Murali Sreeshankar (India) – won silver in men's long jump
  - He became 1st Indian men's long jumper to win 2 Commonwealth Games medals
- Mirabai Chanu (India) – won gold in women's 48kg weightlifting
- Sharmila Dhankar (India) – won gold in women's shot put F57 para event
- India – 8th globally with overall 15 medals (3 gold, 9 silver & 3 bronze)

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News - 199

- 2026 ISSF World Cup Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun – held in Hangzhou, China
- Top country – China | India – finished 3rd overall with 4 medals (1 gold, 1 silver & 2 bronze)
- India's gold medal winner: In women's 25m pistol – Esha Singh | Bronze – Manu Bhaker
- India's silver medal winner: In women's 10m air pistol – Sainyam Vij | Gold – Yao Qianxun (China)
  - Bronze – Hanieh Rostamian (Iran)
- India's bronze medal winners: In 10m Air Rifle Mixed Team event – Sonam Uttam Maskar & Himanshu Dhillon
- Zhang Changhong (China) – new world record of 363.0 points to win men's 50m rifle 3 positions title
  - Previous record – 362.0 set by India's Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar
- Bu Shuaihang (China) – won men's 10m air pistol event
- Wang Zifei & Sheng Lihao (China) – won gold in 10m Air Rifle Mixed Team final
- Carole Cormenier (France) – won women's trap event
- William Hinton (US) – won men's trap title | Qi Ying (China) – won bronze
- HQs of ISSF – Munich, Germany | President – Luciano Rossi

News - 200

- Ajinkya Rahane – announced his retirement from international cricket & all formats of game
- He played 85 Tests, 90 ODIs & 20 T20 Internationals for India, across a total of 195 international matches
- His last international appearance – during India's tour of West Indies in July 2023
- He was also top scorer for India in 2023 World Test Championship final

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News - 201

- 2026 Fields Medals – announced at opening ceremony of International Congress of Mathematicians in Philadelphia
- International Mathematical Union (IMU) named 4 recipients:
  - Yu Deng (University of Chicago) | John Pardon (Stony Brook University, New York)
  - Jacob Tsimerman (University of Toronto) | Hong Wang (New York University & IHES)
- Each winner receives 15,000 Canadian dollars & a gold medal bearing image of Greek mathematician Archimedes
- Prize is funded by – a trust established by J.C. Fields at University of Toronto
- They were recognised for:
  - Yu Deng – for work in partial differential equations
  - Hong Wang – for her contributions to harmonic analysis & geometric measure theory
  - John Pardon – for his achievements in symplectic geometry
- Hong Wang (China) – became 3rd woman to win a Fields Medal
  - Previous winners – Maryam Mirzakhani in 2014 & Maryna Viazovska in 2022
- Deng & Wang – 2nd & 3rd Chinese-born recipients of Fields Medal
- ICM 2026 – supported by American Mathematical Society & Simons Foundation

Join us

News - 202

- Cabinet approved an expanded Khelo India Scheme & enhanced Assistance to National Sports Federations (ANSFs)
  - Combined financial outlay – ₹36,441 Cr (for 2026-27 to 2030-31)
- Of total: ₹29,054 Cr – allocated to revamped Khelo India Scheme
  - ₹7,387 Cr – allocated to enhanced ANSF Scheme (against existing ANSF allocation of ₹425 Cr for 2026-27)
- To expand athlete pool nearly 10-fold, a new 'Emerging Khelo India Athletes (E-KIAs)' category will be created
- Two new school-level initiatives will integrate sports with mainstream education & enable early identification & systematic nurturing of young talent
  - Khelo India Feeder Schools (KIFS) & Khelo India Utkrishta Vidyalayas (KIUV)
- National Coach Accreditation Board – to be set up to standardise coaching quality & professionalise coaching ecosystem across India

News - 203

- "2026 Commonwealth Games" (23rd edition) – held in Glasgow, Scotland (Jul 23 to Aug 2, 2026)
- Top country – Australia with 171 medals (70 gold, 45 silver & 56 bronze)
  - 2nd – England with 110 medals (29 gold, 45 silver & 36 bronze) | 3rd – Canada with 62 medals
  - 4th – India with 39 medals (13 gold, 17 silver & 9 bronze) | 5th – Scotland with 39 medals
- India's biggest contributor – Boxing with 10 medals (7 golds)
- Lovlina Borgohain – silver in women's 75 kg category
- Of India's overall medal tally, athletes won: Men – 5 gold, 13 silver & 5 bronze | Women – 8 gold, 4 silver & 4 bronze
- India's best-ever Commonwealth Games showing – New Delhi 2010 with 101 medals (38 gold, 27 silver & 36 bronze)

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News - 204

- "Bonn Open 2026" ATP Challenger tennis tournament – held in Germany
- Ramkumar Ramanathan & Vijay Sundar Prashanth (India) – won doubles title
  - Defeated – Scott Duncan (England) & Adam Heinonen (Sweden)
- For Ramkumar, it was his 2nd ATP Challenger doubles trophy of 2026 & 13th ATP Challenger title of his career

News - 205

- "Taipei Open 2026" Super 300 badminton tournament – held in Taipei City
- Tanvi Sharma (Punjab) – won her maiden 'BWF World Tour' title in women's singles final
  - Defeated – Nguyen Thuy Linh (Vietnam) | Tanvi's coach – Park Tae-sang
- She finished runner-up to Beiwen Zhang at '2025 US Open Super 300'
- Tanvi became youngest-ever champion in Taipei Open's history at 17 years & 222 days (Previous record – Tai Tzu Ying)
  - She also became tournament's youngest-ever finalist (Previous record – Lee Yong Dae (South Korea))
- She became 1st Indian woman to win Taipei Open women's singles title since Saina Nehwal in 2008

Join us

- She is also 4th Indian woman overall to win a BWF World Tour Super 300-or-higher title
- It made Tanvi 3rd Indian shuttler to claim a singles BWF title in 2026
  - Previous – PV Sindhu at Japan Open & Devika Sihag at Thailand Masters

News - 206

- Harshita Jakhar (Cyclist from Rajasthan) – became 1st Indian woman to feature at Tour de France Femmes
  - She is leading a group of riders during ceremonial start of Stage 2 in Aigle, Switzerland
- She was among 8 cyclists selected for Union Cycliste Internationale's (UCI) World Cycling Talent Programme
- Group completed a 4.5 km neutralised ride ahead of professional peloton before Stage 2 of race
- Tour de France Femmes 2026 – began on Aug 1 in Lausanne & concluded on Aug 9 in Nice
- She won 3 gold medals at 2025 Khelo India Youth Games

News - 207

- "Brazil Para Badminton International 2026", a BWF Para World Circuit tournament – held in Sao Paulo (Jul 27 to Aug 1)
- Biri Takar (Arunachal Pradesh) won two medals:
  - Gold – in Men's Doubles SL4 (alongside Alisson (Brazil) in SL3-SU5/SL4 classification)
  - Bronze – in Men's Singles SL4
- India – finished with 22 medals (9 gold, 6 silver & 7 bronze)
- Athletes from National Centre of Excellence (SAI) contributed 9 medals to India's tally

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News - 208

- India's women's team – confirmed as top seed heading into 46th "FIDE Chess Olympiad"
  - To be held in Samarkand, Uzbekistan, from Sep 16-27, 2026
- Indian men's team – seeded 2nd, behind US
- In Women's section, India leads seedings ahead of Georgia, China, Kazakhstan & US
- In Open section, US heads seedings | Followed by – India, Uzbekistan, China & Germany

News - 209

- "Aerobic Gymnastics Asian Championships" – held in Tagaytay City, Philippines (Aug 4 to 7, 2026)
  - Organised by – Gymnastics Association of Philippines (under aegis of Asian Gymnastics Union)
- Ariha Pangambam (Manipur) – became 1st Indian to win a gold medal in Senior Women's Individual event
  - Silver – Kanokpit Mali (Thailand) | 3rd – Mahiro Kishibe (Japan)
- It marked 1st-ever Senior Gold won by an Indian at continental championships
- India's overall campaign also included a bronze medal in Senior Aero Step category
- Ariha's coach – Yumnam Ranjan Singh | She previously won gold at National Games in 2023 & 2025

Join us

News - 210

- Ashmita Chaliha (India) – won maiden BWF World Tour title at "Korea Masters 2026" (Super 300) in Asan, South Korea,
  - defeating – China's Han Qianxi in Women's Singles final
- Ashmita Chaliha – became 1st Indian to win Korea Masters | She trains under – coach Park Tae-Sang
- BWF World Tour 2026 – Ashmita became 4th Indian woman to win Women's Singles title
  - after PV Sindhu (Japan Open), Devika Sihag (Thailand Masters) & Tanvi Sharma (Taipei Open)
- Men's Singles final: China's Zhu Xuanchen (World No. 68) won maiden BWF World Tour title
  - by defeating – South Korea's Yoo Taebin

News - 211

- FIH Hockey Men's & Women's World Cup 2026 – jointly hosted by Belgium & Netherlands (Aug 15-30, 2026)
- Both competitions will feature 16 teams divided into 4 pools (A, B, C, D) of 4 teams each in opening phase (Phase 1)
  - Top 2 teams from each pool advance to Phase 2
  - 3rd & 4th placed teams continue in separate classification pools
- India's Men's Team – drawn in Pool D alongside England, Pakistan & Wales
- Indian Women's Team – to compete in Pool D against China, England & South Africa
- Women's World Cup 2026 – to conclude in Netherlands with bronze medal match & final
- Men's World Cup 2026 – to conclude in Belgium
- Indian Men's Team Head Coach – Craig Fulton | Indian Women's Team Chief Coach – Sjoerd Marijne

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News - 212

- "Commonwealth Fencing Championship 2026" – held at Rugby School Lagos, Eko Atlantic, in Lagos, Nigeria (Aug 9-14)
  - On Day 3, India – won 3 gold, 1 silver & 1 bronze medal across senior individual events
- In senior women's foil: Kanaglakshmi – won gold | Joys Ashitha – won silver
- In senior men's epee: Rajendran Shanthimol Sherjin – won gold | Defeated – Pieter Kruger (South Africa)
- In senior men's sabre: Karan Singh – won gold | Defeated – Yoongi Shim (Australia)
  - Kumaresan Padma Gisho Nidhi (India) – shared bronze with Oluwafolayemi Akinyosoye (Nigeria)
- India's overall combined medal count – 29 medals (8 gold, 7 silver & 14 bronze)

News - 213

- 2nd round of "Sinquefield Cup 2026" – held at Saint Louis Chess Club (Aug 10-19, 2026)
- R. Praggnanandhaa – defeated Javokhir Sindarov (Uzbekistan)
- 3 other decisive results were recorded in this round: Levon Aronian – defeated Vincent Keymer
  - Maxime Vachier-Lagrave (MVL) – defeated Sevian | Wesley So – defeated Jorden van Foreest
- 10-player field comprises 8 full-tour competitors: Fabiano Caruana, Sindarov, Keymer, So, Anish Giri, Praggnanandhaa, van Foreest & MVL
  - Wildcards – Aronian & Sevian

Join us

News - 214

- MoYA&S suspended its recognition of Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI) with immediate effect on Aug 12, 2026
  - To establish a temporary administrative arrangement to run sport
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 215

- Canadian Open (National Bank Open) women's singles final – held in Toronto (Aug 13, 2026)
- Iga Swiatek (Poland) – won her 1st title of 2026 season & 26th career WTA title | Defeated – Elena Rybakina (Kazakhstan)
- Swiatek – became only 3rd player to complete a career sweep of all 5 significant North American WTA titles
  - She previously won – Indian Wells (2022, 2024), Miami (2022), US Open (2022) & Cincinnati (2025)
- Canadian Open title is her 12th at WTA 1000 level | Behind only – Serena Williams (13)

News - 216

- "Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026" – held in Paris, France
- Magnus Carlsen (Team Liquid & of Norway) – won Chess title | Defeated – Denis Lazavik (AG.AL & of Belarus)
- Carlsen became 1st player to win chess title back-to-back after also winning its inaugural edition in 2025
- He won $250,000 & 1,000 Club Championship points for Team Liquid | Chess prize fund – $1.5 million

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News - 217

- Commonwealth Fencing Championships 2026 – held in Lagos, Nigeria
- India – concluded with 35 medals (13 gold, 8 silver & 14 bronze) across U23 & Senior categories
- On Day 4, India won 5 of 6 Senior Team gold medals on offer
  - Men's Sabre, Women's Sabre, Men's Epee, Women's Epee & Women's Foil | Also a silver in Men's Foil
- India (for 1st time since its inception in 1982) – won 'Wilkinson Sword Trophy'
- On Day 1, India won 17 medals in U23 individual events (4 gold, 4 silver & 9 bronze)
  - Gold winners: Nikhil Wagh (men's sabre), Joys Ashita (women's foil), Prachi Lohan (women's epee) & Jeferlin (women's sabre)

News - 218

- "Asian Junior Chess Championship 2026" – held at ITC Maratha Sheraton, Mumbai
  - Formally inaugurated by – Jayraj Pathak (former Municipal Commissioner of BMC)
- Vignesh Vermula (seeded 23rd) – won Open Blitz title | 4th – Akshay Borganokar | 5th – Madhavendra Pratap Sharma
- Saranya Devi (seeded 9th) – won Girls' Blitz title | 2nd – Prishita Gupta | 3rd – Shanmathi Sree | 4th – Shohradova Lala
- Among foreign players: 6th – Akhilbay Imangali (Kazakhstan), highest-ranked non-Indian in Open Championship
  - 9th – Shageldi Kurbandurdyyev (Turkmenistan)

Join us

News - 219

- MYAS announced "National Sports Awards 2025", naming 17 sportspersons for Arjuna Award
- Awardees were finalised on recommendations of a Selection Committee
  - Chaired by – Justice (Retd.) Arun Kumar Mishra (former SC judge)
- Arjuna Award list includes:
  - Divya Deshmukh & Vidit Gujrathi (chess players) | Muhammed Ajmal V (sprinter)
  - Tejaswin Shankar (high jumper & decathlete) | Narender (Commonwealth Games 2026 silver medallist boxer)
  - Gayatri Gopichand & Treesa Jolly (badminton players) | Priyanka Goswami (race walker)
  - Rudransh Khandelwal (para-shooter) | Ekta Bhyan (para-athlete) | Arvind Singh (rower)
  - Surjeet & Pooja (kabaddi players) | Dhanush Srikanth (deaf rifle shooter) | Lalremsiami (hockey player)
  - Rajkumar Pal (hockey player) | Akhil Sheoran (shooter)
  - Arjuna Award for Lifetime Achievement – I. Arumainayagam (former footballer)
- Arjuna Award recognises outstanding performance over previous 4 years
- Army Paralympic Node, Pune – Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 220

- Rishabh Pant – became fastest batter to reach 100 sixes in Test cricket & 1st Indian batter to achieve this milestone
  - During Day 4 of 1st Test against Sri Lanka at Galle International Stadium on Aug 18, 2026
- Pant became only 4th batter in Test history to reach 100 sixes
  - Top 3 – Ben Stokes (138), Brendon McCullum (107) & Adam Gilchrist (100)
- Pant reached this milestone in just 4,918 balls | Previous record – 6,578 balls set by Gilchrist

News - 221

- Tingong Wangpan (Arunachal Pradesh) – selected for National Coaching Camp in preparation for "Aichi-Nagoya 2026 Asian Para Games", Japan, competing in Men's 400m T37 category
  - He is beneficiary of state's Chief Minister's Athletes Coaching & Empowerment Scheme (CM-ACES)
- Sports Authority of India (SAI) announced a list of 51 men & 20 women athletes for camp
  - To be conducted across SAI Centres in Bengaluru, Delhi & Sonipat
- In 2026, he became 1st para-athlete from Arunachal Pradesh to secure admission into SAI NCOE, Gandhinagar
- His recent competitive record includes:
  - Gold medal in 100m & a bronze in 400m (T35 category) at 24th National Para Athletics Championships in Mar 2026
  - Silver in Men's T37 Sprint category at 8th Indian Open International Para Athletics Championships in Bengaluru
  - Selection by Paralympic Committee of India to represent India at World Para Athletics Grand Prix 2026 in Mexico

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News - 222

- MYAS will establish a National Coach Accreditation Board (NCAB)
  - To standardise coaching qualifications, improve professional standards & capacity of coaches & support staff
- Recommended by – Task Force on Unified Framework for Development of Coaching Ecosystem in India
  - Led by – Pullela Gopichand (Indian badminton national head coach)
- Task Force also recommended a dedicated "TOPS for Coaches" model
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 223

- "Kanizsa Open 2026" – held in Nagykanizsa, Hungary
- Pranesh M – secured Group A title with a rating of 2673, ranking 44th in latest FIDE World Rankings for Aug 2026
  - Defeated – Vadim Petrovskiy (Germany)
- He shared top spot with 3 other players: Or Bronstein (Israel), Andrei Volokitin (Ukraine) & Karthik Venkataraman (India)
- Among other Indians in tournament: Neelash Saha – finished 10th with 6.5 points

News - 224

- "2026 BWF World Championships" – held at Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi
- Alex Lanier (France) – won men's singles title | Defeated – Kodai Naraoka (Japan)
  - Alex became 1st French player to win men's singles world title
- An Se-young (South Korea) – won women's singles final | Defeated – Akane Yamaguchi (Japan)
  - An Se-young secured her 2nd world title & her 1st since 2023
- Thom Gicquel & Delphine Delrue (France) – mixed doubles title | Defeated – Feng Yanzhe & Huang Dongping (China)
- Liang Weikeng & Wang Chang (China) – won men's doubles title | Defeated – Aaron Chia & Soh Wooi Yik (Malaysia)

News - 225

- East Bengal FC – won 135th IndianOil Durand Cup at Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan, Kolkata
  - Defeated – Mohun Bagan Super Giant | East Bengal FC – lifted trophy for 17th time
- Edmund Lalrindika – became only 2nd player in East Bengal history to score 3 goals in this fixture
  - After – Baichung Bhutia's hat-trick in 1997 Federation Cup semi-final
- Durand Cup – founded in 1888 by Sir Henry Mortimer Durand (Foreign Secretary to British India)
  - It is the oldest club football tournament in Asia and the 3rd oldest surviving football competition in the world
  - jointly organised by = Durand Football Tournament Society (DFTS) + All India Football Federation (AIFF)

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News - 226

- "BWF World Championships 2026" – held at Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi
- Treesa Jolly & Gayatri Gopichand (India) – won bronze medal in women's doubles
- It became 2nd Indian women's doubles pair to win a medal at tournament
  - After – Jwala Gutta & Ashwini Ponnappa (bronze at 2011 London edition)
- India's all-time medal tally at tournament – 16 (1 gold, 4 silver & 11 bronze)
- For Treesa Jolly (Kerala), it was her 1st Malayali badminton player to win a World Championships medal since H.S. Prannoy's bronze in 2023
- Winners at the BWF World Championships 2026:
  - Men's singles – Alex Lanier (France)
  - Women's singles – An Se-young (South Korea)
  - Men's doubles – Liang Weikeng & Wang Chang (China)
  - Women's doubles – Baek Ha-na & Lee So-hee (South Korea)
  - Mixed doubles – Thom Gicquel-Delphine Delrue (France)

Persons in News

News - 227

- Squadron Leader Bhawana Kanth – became 1st woman officer in IAF to complete Fighter Combat Leader (FCL) course
  - At Tactics & Air Combat Development Establishment (TACDE) in Gwalior
- TACDE – founded in 1971 as Tactics & Combat Development & Training Squadron (renamed in 1972)
- In 2019, she became 1st woman fighter pilot to qualify for day combat missions, completing all operational requirements
- In 2021, she became 1st woman fighter pilot to be part of IAF contingent at Republic Day parade

News - 228

- Ankit Kumar Pal (Delhi), Manish Kumar Mandal (Bengaluru) & Susmita Sain (Guwahati) – selected as part of 3rd cohort of Generation Connect Youth Envoys (GCYE) of International Telecommunication Union (ITU) for period 2026-2030
- International Youth Day 2026 – observed under theme "Different Contexts, Common Aspirations"
  - Through a virtual event titled "Passing the Torch: Connecting Generations of Digital Leaders"

News - 229

- 4th Criminal Court in Damascus sentenced ousted Syrian President Bashar al-Assad to death in absentia in Aug 2026
  - Convicting him of murder, torture & crimes against humanity committed during Syria's 14-year conflict
- Court also sentenced his younger brother, Maher al-Assad, to death in absentia for premeditated murder & torture
  - Having led 4th Armoured Division, a Syrian Army unit accused of killing dissidents during 2011 protests

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- Death sentences in absentia were extended to 6 other former officials
- Syria – Damascus – Syrian Pound | Interim President – Ahmad al-Sharaa

News - 230

- Jamsheer Thanalot (Kerala), Abhishek Rawat (UP) & Isha Raj (Bihar) – took part in a Guinness World Record skydive over Benghazi, Libya
  - Guinness World Records – officially confirmed achievement on Aug 14
- Jump involved 65 skydivers representing around 38 nationalities, who exited a single military Ilyushin Il-76TD aircraft at an altitude of 13,000 feet, each carrying their respective national flag
  - This feat set a new record for most skydivers jumping together with national flags from a single aircraft

News - 231

- Guinness World Records – recognised Lakshmanan Meyyappan as world's youngest male Chartered Accountant
  - He completed his Association of Chartered Certified Accountants qualification in Dubai at 16 years & 170 days
- He qualified on Jun 30, 2021, clearing all 13 ACCA papers on his 1st attempt while continuing his high-school education
  - Previous record – Dishaan Shah (India) at 17 years & 152 days
- HQs of Guinness World Records – London, England, UK | Global President – Alistair Richards | Established in – 1955

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News - 232

- Sophie Adenot (ESA astronaut) – became 1st French woman to conduct a spacewalk
  - She completed a roughly 6.5-hour Extravehicular Activity (EVA) outside ISS in Aug 2026
  - Alongside Anil Menon (American astronaut)
- US Spacewalk 97 began at 8:29 am EDT & ended at 2:52 pm EDT, lasting approximately 6 hours & 23 minutes
  - It was 282nd spacewalk conducted in support of ISS
- Sophie Adenot – became 2nd Frenchwoman in history to fly to space (after Claudie Haignere)
  - She was launched to ISS aboard SpaceX Crew-12 in Feb 2026 for her 1st long-duration mission, named "epsilon"
  - She is also 2nd European woman to conduct a spacewalk (after Italian astronaut Samantha Cristoforetti)

Science & Technology

News - 233

- NVIDIA – launched "Open Secure AI Alliance", to strengthen AI security & help organisations respond to emerging AI-powered cyber threats
- Founding members of the alliance include – Microsoft, IBM, Cisco, Adobe, Cloudflare, CrowdStrike, Dell Technologies, HPE, Hugging Face, Red Hat, Salesforce, SAP, ServiceNow, Snowflake, Siemens, NetApp, Databricks, Capital One, Palantir, SpaceX & Linux Foundation
- HQs of Nvidia – California, US | CEO – Jensen Huang

Join us

News - 234

- IIT Gandhinagar + IAIRO = MoU to strengthen collaboration in AI research, education, innovation & talent development
- Director of IIT Gandhinagar – Prof. Rajat Moona
- HQs of IAIRO – GIFT City, Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Founding Director & CEO – Amit Sheth

News - 235

- IN-SPACe issued India's 1st mandatory framework governing planned re-entry of space objects into Earth's atmosphere
- Any Indian entity planning re-entry of a space object must obtain prior authorisation from IN-SPACe
- Foreign organisations cannot apply directly & must route their request through an Indian-incorporated entity
- A separate re-entry authorisation is required for objects designed to survive re-entry or specifically planned for re-entry
  - Objects that re-enter naturally through orbital decay & are expected to burn up, fragment or disintegrate without significant risk are exempt
- Applicants must submit a detailed risk assessment & must file a Notice to Airmen (NOTAM) & maritime danger-zone notification at least 45 days in advance
- HQs of IN-SPACe – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Dr. Pawan Goenka | Works under – Department of Space

News - 236

- "Legal Research Analysis Assistant (LegRAA)" – designed to assist judges in conducting legal research more efficiently
  - It is an AI-based tool developed by NIC's AI Division & NIC's CoE for eCourts (Pune)
- Digital Courts 2.1 – developed by CoEE at NIC Pune as an integrated digital case management platform
- Both tools have been developed under 'eCourts Mission Mode Project, Phase-III'
  - Led by – Department of Justice in collab with e-Committee of Supreme Court of India
  - ₹53.57 Cr – earmarked specifically for AI advancements to boost judicial efficiency

News - 237

- ICAR-NIHSAD (Bhopal) – developed India's 1st indigenous "MA-104 Cell Line-based Live Attenuated African Swine Fever (ASF) Vaccine" for pigs
  - It was launched during 98th Foundation Day celebrations of ICAR at National Agricultural Science Centre (New Delhi)
- It was developed using a novel attenuated 'ASF Virus (ASFV) Genotype II' strain with unique gene deletions
- ASF – characterised by high fever, haemorrhages & mortality rates that may approach 100%
  - Its 1st detection in India – in 2020
- India – became 2nd country in Asia to develop its own ASF vaccine (1st – Vietnam)

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News - 238

- ICAR – developed India's 1st fully annotated telomere-to-telomere (T2T) reference genome of pigeonpea (Cajanus cajan L. Millsp.) for variety 'Asha'
- T2T sequencing – an advanced DNA sequencing & assembly method that produces complete, gap-free genomic sequences from one end of a chromosome to other
- Newly assembled genome (NIPB_CcT2T_4) – uploaded to global NCBI (National Center for Biotechnology Information) database
- It has also been approved as global reference genome for crop, India's 1st fully annotated T2T reference genome for pigeonpea
- ICAR's National Institute for Plant Biotechnology (New Delhi) – published world's 1st draft genome of a pulse crop using same 'Asha' variety in 2011
- HQs of ICAR – New Delhi | DG – Mangi Lal Jat | Established in – 1929

News - 239

- India successfully test-fired medium-range, nuclear-capable ballistic missile "Agni-4", under aegis of SFC & DRDO
  - From – Integrated Test Range (ITR) at Chandipur in Balasore, Odisha
- India issued a 'Notice to Airmen (NOTAM)' covering a corridor initially spanning around 2,530 km over Bay of Bengal for August 6-7, later extended to ~3,760 km
- Agni-4 – a 2-stage, road-mobile, surface-to-surface ballistic missile propelled by a solid-fuel rocket motor
  - Launched from an open Transporter Erector Launcher (TEL)

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News - 240

- Scientists at INST (Mohali) & BARC (Mumbai) – developed advanced light-activated multifunctional nanobots
  - That could enable targeted breast cancer therapy
- Research was led by – Dr. Jiban Jyoti Panda (INST) & Dr. Santosh K. Gupta (BARC)
  - It has been published in journal – ACS Applied Materials & Interfaces
- Nanobots – microscopic experimental machines designed to perform specific tasks at nanoscale

News - 241

- I4C (MHA) – issued an advisory cautioning corporates, finance professionals & businesspersons
  - Against a sophisticated cyber fraud campaign involving takeover of WhatsApp accounts through malicious files disguised as account statements & regulatory communications
- Commonly referred to as the 'Boss Scam', fraudsters use the genuine WhatsApp account of a senior executive to instruct accounts and finance employees to make urgent transfers of funds to mule bank accounts
- It begins with victims receiving compressed .zip files via WhatsApp, SMS or email bearing different names

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- Once a victim's WhatsApp account is compromised, it is misused to automatically circulate same malicious file to all of victim's contacts & groups
- HQs of I4C – New Delhi | CEO – Rajesh Kumar | Founded in – 2018

News - 242

- Chinese astronauts aboard Tiangong space station successfully harvested 1st batch of rice samples grown in orbit
  - As part of ongoing Shenzhou-23 rice cultivation experiment
- Aim: To achieve world's 1st-ever continuous cultivation of 2 consecutive generations of rice in orbit
- Shenzhou-23 crew comprises – Zhu Yangzhu, Zhang Zhiyuan & Lai Ka-ying (Hong Kong's 1st payload specialist)
- This experiment used varieties of japonica rice developed in China & involved 2 types of seeds:
  - Ordinary seeds that had never left Earth's surface
  - "Space lineage" seeds descended from rice grown aboard Tiangong in 2022
- Across 4 cultivation units, scientists are testing 2 parallel reproduction methods:
  - Conventional seed-to-seed sexual reproduction
  - Ratooning (new shoots grow from remaining roots after 1st harvest)
- In 2022, Chinese astronauts aboard Wentian lab module completed world's 1st full life-cycle "seed to seed" rice cultivation in space
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

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News - 243

- PM Modi inaugurated 'Param Pragya', an AI-powered high-performance supercomputing facility
  - At Sonipat campus of IIT Delhi on Aug 8, 2026
- It aligns with 'National Supercomputing Mission' – a joint initiative of MeitY & DST
  - To strengthen India's capabilities in high-performance computing, advanced scientific research & technological self-reliance
- Director of IIT Delhi – Prof. Rangan Banerjee

News - 244

- Astrobase Space Technologies – unveiled "EVEREST", India's 1st privately developed 800 kN Full-Flow Staged Combustion (FFSC) LOX-Methane (Liquid Oxygen-Methane) rocket engine
- Full-Flow Staged Combustion – a liquid rocket engine cycle in which both propellants pass through preburners before entering main combustion chamber
- Astrobase became 4th commercial company globally to successfully develop a high-thrust FFSC engine
- HQs of Astrobase – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Neeraj Khandelwal

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News - 245

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – dedicated to the nation the CSIR-National Botanical Research Institute's (CSIR-NBRI) 1st-of-its-kind 'Eco-Educational Hub', named "Prakriti Gyan Dham"
  - at Maharishi Parashar Bioresource Centre (MPBC), Banthra, Lucknow, UP
- The Hub integrates scientific research, environmental education & botanical heritage
- Its defining feature is 'PAaVan Path (**P**lants **a**nd **A**ssociated **V**egetations for **A**ppreciating **N**ature)', an interpretive heritage trail forming the central experiential component of the campus
- At the heart of the Hub lies the 'Indian Heritage Garden', bringing together heritage trees propagated from historically significant locations across the country
- The facility also includes a 'Bamboosteum' housing 43 bamboo species

News - 246

- IBM + MIT (Bengaluru) + CHRIST (Deemed to be University) = partnered to establish 2 AI-focused centres in Bengaluru
  - Aim: To expand access to advanced computing, enterprise AI technologies, research & skilling
- MIT Bengaluru inaugurated "IBM-MIT AI Lab - MAHE Intelligence GPU (MIG)" at its Bengaluru campus
  - In collaboration with IBM & IBM SkillsBuild
- CHRIST (Deemed to be University) + IBM = established "IBM Innovation Center for Artificial Intelligence" in Bengaluru
- MAHE – awarded Institution of Eminence status by Ministry of Education in 2020
  - It is ranked 3rd in National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) 2025
- HQs of IBM – Armonk, New York, US | CEO – Arvind Krishna | Founded in – 1911

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News - 247

- Skyroot Aerospace + HEX20 (Kerala) = signed a Multi-Launch Agreement (MLA) for 3 dedicated launches
  - Aboard Skyroot's Vikram series of launch vehicles
  - To support HEX20's Earth-observation constellation & in-orbit payload demonstration missions
- 1st mission – scheduled for Q4 2027
- Skyroot's Vikram-1 – became India's 1st privately developed orbital-class rocket to reach orbit on its maiden flight
  - Launched from – Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota
- HEX20 built India's 1st privately developed rideshare satellite
  - It also launched its 2nd satellite, 'KOYO (Kinetic Optical Yaw Observer)'
    - For Taiwan's National Central University aboard SpaceX's Transporter-17 mission
- HQs of Skyroot Aerospace – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Pawan Kumar Chandana
- HQs of HEX20 – Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala | CEO – Amal Chandran | Established in – 2020

Join us

News - 248

- VinSpace Joint Stock Company (Vietnam) + SpaceX (US) = a launch contract securing a berth on a Transporter rideshare mission scheduled for 2nd quarter of 2027
- Under this agreement, VinSpace's satellites will launch as part of SpaceX's rideshare programme
- VinSpace – established in Nov 2025 as part of conglomerate founded by Pham Nhat Vuong
- HQs of SpaceX – Texas, U.S. | Founder & CEO – Elon Musk | Founded in – 2002

News - 249

- NVIDIA introduced "Nemotron 3.5 Lightning", a 30-billion-parameter open model for high-volume agentic AI workloads
- NVIDIA released "NeMo Switchyard", an open-source routing library
  - To allow complex planning to be routed to larger model while routine execution is handled by this model
- HQs of Nvidia – California, US | CEO – Jensen Huang

News - 250

- Meta opened weights of "Muse Glimmer", a 30-billion-parameter open-weight AI model built for local, always-on agentic workflows
  - By – Meta Superintelligence Labs
- It is optimised to run entirely on a single consumer GPU & with or without an internet connection
- HQs of Meta – California, US | CEO – Mark Zuckerberg | Founded in – 2004

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News - 251

- NASA invited ISRO to join its "Moon Base" programme, building on partnership under Artemis Accords
  - India joined Artemis Accords in 2023
- 9th meeting of India-US Civil Space Joint Working Group (CSJWG) – held in Bengaluru, India
- NASA's 'Moon Base' is part of 'Artemis' programme
  - To establish a sustained human presence near lunar South Pole through a mix of crewed & uncrewed missions
  - Phase One (2026-2029) – focuses on robotic missions to South Pole & technology demonstration
  - Phase Two (2029-2032) – to begin deploying infrastructure
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 252

- IN-SPACe + Allied Orbits Pvt Ltd = agreement to design, build, own & operate India's 1st fully indigenous commercial Earth Observation (EO) satellite constellation
  - Allied Orbits Pvt Ltd – a consortium led by PixxelSpace India, Dhruva Space, PierSight Space & SatSure Analytics India
  - Under Earth Observation Public-Private Partnership (EO-PPP) framework

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- Allied Orbits consortium – to invest more than ₹1,200 Cr over a 5-year period | Govt support offer – up to ₹350 Cr
- It will comprise 12 satellites equipped with panchromatic, multispectral, hyperspectral & microwave SAR sensors
- It will deliver Analysis Ready Data (ARD) & value-added geospatial services for applications
- Cumulative private investment in India's space sector – $618.5 million as of Mar 2026 (from $100.5 million in 2021-22)
- HQs of IN-SPACe – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Dr. Pawan Goenka | Works under – Department of Space

News - 253

- Vyoma.AI – secured an order from Together AI (US) to build India's largest single-cluster AI infrastructure
  - An Nvidia B300 AI Factory at Vyoma's Chennai data centre campus | Worth – ₹10,000-15,000 Cr
- Phase 1 – designed for 250 MW capacity & power infrastructure readiness of 150 MVA
- Together AI + IBM = a $240 million multi-year deal to build a large-scale AI cluster on IBM Cloud using Nvidia systems
- HQs of Vyoma.AI Limited – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Parent Company – L&T (Larsen & Toubro) | Established in – 2026
- HQs of Together AI – San Francisco, California, USA | Founder & CEO – Vipul Ved Prakash | Established in – June 2022
- HQs of IBM – Armonk, New York, US | CEO – Arvind Krishna | Founded in – 1911

News - 254

- IISc Bengaluru – released "SraVaani", an open-source multilingual speech-recognition model
  - To convert spoken words into text across 65 Indian languages & dialects
- Developed by – IISc's SPIRE (Speech Processing, Interpreting, and Recognition Engineering) Lab
  - In collaboration with – ARTPARK | With support from – Google
- It covers 20 scheduled Indian languages & 45 additional regional languages & dialects
- It has been made publicly & freely available on Hugging Face platform under an MIT licence
- Director of IISc Bengaluru – Prof. Govindan Rangarajan

News - 255

- SUPARCO (Pakistan) – named Pakistan's 1st lunar rover "Jinnah-1" at a ceremony in Islamabad
- Jinnah-1 will be launched to Moon's south pole in 2029 as part of China's Chang'e-8 mission
  - Under an MoU signed between SUPARCO & CNSA on Feb 5, 2025
- China will provide lander for this mission, while Pakistani specialists are expected to control rover remotely from Earth
- Pakistan – Islamabad – Pakistani Rupee | PM – Shehbaz Sharif | President – Asif Ali Zardari

News - 256

- SpaceX – launched two 'Falcon 9' rockets from opposite US coasts on Aug 15, 2026
- It set a new company record for shortest interval between orbital launches (38 minutes)
  - Previous record – 65 minutes set on Aug 31, 2024, during 2 back-to-back Starlink missions
- 1st Falcon 9 lifted off from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station, Florida, at 9:12 pm EDT

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- It carried 8 satellites into Low Earth Orbit (LEO) for Louisiana-based telecommunications company Globalstar
- 1st-stage booster returned to Cape Canaveral around 8 minutes after launch, completing its 14th flight

- 2nd Falcon 9 lifted off, at 9:50 pm EDT, from Vandenberg Space Force Base, California
  - It carried a classified payload for US Space Force on a mission designated USSF-366
- These 2 launches were SpaceX's 95th & 96th Falcon 9 missions of 2026, taking year's total to 96
- HQs of SpaceX – Texas, U.S. | Founder & CEO – Elon Musk | Founded in – 2002

News - 257

- Aheesa Digital Innovations (Chennai) – achieved first-pass silicon success with 'VIHAAN'
  - VIHAAN – an indigenous broadband networking System-on-Chip (SoC) built using the VEGA microprocessor
- Aheesa Digital Innovations – a fabless semiconductor startup supported under Design Linked Incentive (DLI) Scheme
- DLI Scheme – approved with an outlay of ₹1,000 Cr | Managed by – MeitY
  - It supports Indian startups, companies & MSMEs in designing chips for strategic & commercial applications
- DLI Scheme offers design infrastructure support along with financial incentives of:
  - Up to 50% of eligible costs for design & prototyping (capped at ₹15 Cr per application)
  - 4-6% of net sales turnover over 5 years for deployment & commercialization (capped at ₹30 Cr per application)
- Companies supported under DLI Scheme cumulatively achieved 30+ chip design tape-outs across various foundries
  - They raised over $100 million in venture capital funding

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News - 258

- AkinAnalytics (Hyderabad) – launched its indigenous "NIKA2 Kisan Medium Drone"
  - Unveiled by – Shivraj Singh Chouhan in New Delhi
- NIKA2 – a multi-payload agricultural drone featuring a 16-litre spraying payload & a 12-litre spreading payload
- AkinAnalytics – led by Janaki Pulaparthi (Founder & CEO)
  - Supported by – NIDHI PRAYAS, Startup India Seed Fund Scheme & MeitY SAMRIDH
- It also operates a DGCA-authorised Remote Pilot Training Organisation in Amalapuram, Andhra Pradesh
- HQs of AkinAnalytics – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Janaki Pulaparthi

News - 259

- FWDA – released a video preview of FWD Supreme Lite, its flight technology demonstrator for FWD Supreme
  - India's 1st AI-piloted fighter jet concept
- FWD Supreme is designed as an autonomous combat platform flown entirely by AI
- FWD Supreme Lite – initial technology demonstrator & 1st flying testbed for wider FWD Supreme family
  - Its 1st flight is targeted for – Q3 2026
- FWD Supreme family is envisioned in 2 variants, with larger FWD Supreme Heavy planned at an ~1-tonne class
- It is developed entirely at FWDA's Bengaluru facility, led by Girish Dixit (former Secretary of ADA), along with others
- HQs of FWDA – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder & CEO – Suhas Tejaskanda | Established in – 2022

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News - 260

- Astronomers discovered & characterised "GJ 523b", an unusually dense exoplanet, a confirmed example of 'mega-Earth'
  - It is ~170 million years old & weighs about 23.5 times Earth's mass while being only around 2.55 times Earth's radius
  - It is located roughly 87 light-years from Earth
- Mega-Earth – a term used informally by astronomers without a planet that concretely defined category
- GJ 523b orbits Gliese 523, a mid-K dwarf star, completing 1 orbit every 17.75 days
  - It was initially flagged by NASA's Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite (TESS)
  - Density – ~126.82 grams per cubic inch
  - Minimum orbital obliquity – ~71.4 degrees relative to its star's axis of rotation
- Study was led by – Max Kroft (University of Wisconsin-Madison)
- GJ 523b – 1st exoplanet discovered & catalogued by researchers with Wisconsin Center for Origins Research (WiCOR)

News - 261

- Heart Aerospace – completed 1st flight of X1 demonstrator aircraft at Plattsburgh International Airport, New York
  - becoming the largest battery-electric aircraft ever flown
- X1 demonstrator – spanned 106 feet (32 metres), weighed 25,000+ pounds (11,300 kg) at takeoff & completed 27-minute piloted test flight reaching 1,100 feet altitude
- X1 flight test – fully electric propulsion system delivered 1+ MW power using approx $5 electricity for entire flight
- ES-30 aircraft – to use hybrid-electric propulsion system with targeted all-electric range of 200 km, hybrid range up to 800 km & charging time of ~30 minutes
- Heart Aerospace – expects 1st pre-production ES-30 flight testing in 2028, with certification & commercial service targeted for 2031
- HQs of Heart Aerospace – Torrance, California, USA | Co-Founder & CEO – Anders Forslund | Established in – 2018

News - 262

- IN-SPACe – proposed third-party liability insurance requirement up to ₹500 Cr (~$60 million) for private space launch operators to protect government liability & provide financial framework
- Insurance framework covers damages to individuals, land & assets caused by space missions across launch & re-entry
- Under international space treaties, India holds absolute liability for damage caused by space objects on Earth & fault-based liability for damage elsewhere
- Private space operators – required to maintain third-party liability insurance or equivalent financial assurance
  - Regulators can name Republic of India as co-insured to protect State interests
- INSAT-4C (2006) mission cost ₹256 crore and was uninsured when launch vehicle failed over Bay of Bengal
- Private space sector proposed ₹500 Cr insurance ceiling – aims to improve predictability as commercial launch activities expand
- Private investment in India's space sector increased nearly 6x from $100.5 million (FY2021-22) to $618.5 million (Mar'26)

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- ~440 space technology startups registered in India
  - Private companies planning 8+ commercial rocket launches during FY2026-27 & FY2027-28
- HQs of IN-SPACe – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Dr. Pawan Goenka | Works under – Department of Space

News - 263

- Astronomers discovered "S301", fastest known star in Milky Way, orbiting Sagittarius A*, at speeds of up to 25,000 kmps
- Sagittarius A* – a supermassive black hole at centre of our galaxy, or roughly 8% speed of light
- Detected using European Southern Observatory's (ESO) Very Large Telescope Interferometer (VLTI)
  - Its GRAVITY & GRAVITY+ instruments at Paranal Observatory in northern Chile, published in journal Nature
- It follows a highly elliptical orbit, completing 1 full circuit around Sagittarius A* every 8.7 years

News - 264

- 1st module of Bharatiya Antariksha Station, "BAS-1", received approval, during 3rd National Space Day celebrations in Ahmedabad
  - Bharatiya Antariksha Station (BAS) – to be established by 2035
  - Weight – ~10 tonnes | Scheduled for launch aboard ISRO's LVM-3 rocket by 2028
  - It will orbit Earth at an altitude of – ~450 km
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

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Appointments & Resignations

News - 265

- Satya Pal Kumar – appointed as Director (Joint Secretary level) of Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) for 5 years
  - Succeeding – Pankaj Kumar Mishra
- HQs of FIU-IND – New Delhi | Director – Satya Pal Kumar

News - 266

- Shailesh Jejurikar (President & CEO) – appointed as Chairman of Procter & Gamble Company, w.e.f. Aug 1, 2026
  - Succeeding – Jon R. Moeller
- Joseph Jimenez – reappointed as independent Lead Director of Procter & Gamble Company
- HQs of P&G – Ohio, US | President & CEO – Shailesh Jejurikar

News - 267

- Varsha Ashok Aglawe – took charge as 54th DG of Geological Survey of India (succeeding - Asit Saha)
  - She became 1st woman to head GSI
- HQs of GSI – Kolkata, West Bengal | Director General – Varsha Ashok Aglawe

Join us

News - 268

- Alka Nangia Arora – assumed charge as Controller General of Defence Accounts (CGDA)
  - succeeding – Anugraha Narayana Das

News - 269

- VAdm A N Pramod – assumed charge as Deputy Chief of Naval Staff (DCNS) on Aug 1, 2026
  - Succeeding – VAdm Tarun Sobti
- He was awarded with – Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2024 & Yudh Seva Medal in 2025
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 270

- Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja (DG Medical Services (Air)) – appointed as DGAFMS, w.e.f. Aug 31, 2026
  - Succeeding – Vice Admiral Arti Sarin

News - 271

- Air Marshal Tejpal Singh – appointed as Deputy Chief of Air Staff (succeeding - Air Marshal Awadhesh Kumar Bharti)
- He is currently serving as – Assistant Chief of Air Staff (Plans) at Air Headquarters
- He has been awarded with: Vayu Sena Medal (VM) in Jan 2011 & Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM) in Jan 2021

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News - 272

- Vigilance Commissioner A.S. Rajeev – assumed charge as acting Central Vigilance Commissioner (CVC) in Aug 2026
  - Succeeding – Praveen Kumar Srivastava
- HQs of CVC – New Delhi | Central Vigilance Commissioner – A.S. Rajeev | Vigilance Commissioner – Praveen Vashista

News - 273

- VAdm Manish Chadha – assumed charge as Director General Naval Operations (DGNO) (succeeds - VAdm A.N. Pramod)
- He was awarded Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM) in 2025 & Vishisht Seva Medal (VSM) in 2017

News - 274

- Prasanta Mahapatra – took charge as Executive Director of SEBI
  - He will handle Corporation Finance Investigation Department and Recovery & Refund Department
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 275

- Dr. T.V. Somanathan – got extension of 1 year as Cabinet Secretary
- Govind Mohan – got extension of 1 year as Home Secretary

Join us

News - 276

- ACC approved 10 fresh overseas appointments & 1 tenure extension:
  - Baldeo Purushartha – appointed as Senior Adviser to Executive Director at ADB for 3 yrs
  - Ponnuraj V. Rahul Jain – appointed as Senior Adviser to Executive Director (India) at IMF for 3 yrs
  - Kapil Patidar (Director in DEA) – appointed as Adviser to Executive Director (India) at IMF for 3 yrs
  - Subhash Kumar (Director in MoD) – appointed as Director at SAARC Secretariat for 3 years
  - Brij Mohan Mishra – appointed as Minister (Economic & Commercial) at Embassy of India, Tokyo
  - Balamurugan D. – appointed as Minister (Agriculture) at Embassy of India, Rome
  - Satyajit Mohanty – appointed as India's Representative to Council of International Civil Aviation Organization, Montreal, Canada
- Hemang Jani (Senior Adviser to Executive Director at World Bank) – extended on foreign deputation for 2 years

News - 277

- Tewolde Gebremariam – appointed as MD & CEO of Air India (succeeding - Campbell Wilson)
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Tewolde Gebremariam (subsidiary of Tata Group)

News - 278

- Todd Blanche – appointed as 88th Attorney General of US (succeeding - Pam Bondi)
- He became 2nd confirmed Attorney General since President Trump returned to White House in Jan 2025
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

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News - 279

- Abelardo de la Espriella – sworn in as President of Colombia
- He succeeds – leftist President Gustavo Petro (Colombia's 1st & to date, only leftist President)
- Colombia – Bogota – Colombian Peso | President – Abelardo de la Espriella

News - 280

- Rahul Navin – tenure extended as ED Director for 1 year, until Aug 13, 2027
- Currently, an officer can be appointed ED Director for an initial 2 yr tenure followed by up to 3 one-yr extensions
- HQs of ED – New Delhi | Director – Rahul Navin | Founded in – 1956

News - 281

- András Baka – elected as Hungary's next President (replacing – Tamas Sulyok)
- Hungary – Budapest – Hungarian Forint | President – András Baka | PM – Peter Magyar

Join us

News - 282

- Ashish Singh – appointed as MD & CEO of Manappuram Finance for 5 years, w.e.f. Jan 1, 2027
- Bain Capital proposed to invest ₹4,385 Cr to acquire an 18% stake & become a joint promoter of Manappuram Finance
- V.P. Nandakumar – tenure extended as MD & CEO of Manappuram Finance, up to Dec 31, 2026
- HQs of Manappuram Finance – Thrissur, Kerala | MD & CEO – V.P. Nandakumar (from Jan 1, 2027 - Ashish Singh)

News - 283

- Dr. Bhooma V.G. – selected as Vice-Chancellor of Atal Bihari Vajpayee Institute of Public Service & Innovation (AIPSI)
  - Located at Reduit (Minissy), Moka, Mauritius
- AIPSI – jointly inaugurated by PM Modi & Prime Minister of Mauritius in Mar 2025

News - 284

- D.Y. Chandrachud (former CJI) – appointed as Russia's arbitrator in a new investment treaty arbitration
  - Brought by – Oschadbank (Ukraine)
- Arbitration has been initiated under 1998 bilateral investment treaty between Ukraine & Russia
- Stavros Brekoulakis (Greek arbitrator) – 3rd member, appointed by Oschadbank
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

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News - 285

- N. Chandrasekaran – step down as Chairman of Tata Sons, w.e.f. Feb 20, 2027
- HQs of Tata Sons – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Natarajan Chandrasekaran

News - 286

- Hakainde Hichilema (United Party for National Development) – re-elected, for 2nd term, as President of Zambia for 5 yrs
- Zambia – Lusaka – Zambian Kwacha | President – Hakainde Hichilema

News - 287

- Shabnam Sinha – appointed as next Chairperson of Airtel Payments Bank for 3 yrs (w.e.f. Oct 1, 2026)
  - Succeeding – Sunil Bharti Mittal
- Shabnam Sinha currently serves as – an Independent Director on Airtel Payments Bank Board
  - She chairs Special Committee for Monitoring Frauds & is a member of Risk Management & IT Committees
- HQs of Airtel Payments Bank – Gurugram, Haryana | MD & CEO – Anubrata Biswas | Chairperson – Sunil Bharti Mittal (From Oct 1 - Shabnam Sinha)

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News - 288

- Dr. Eluri Sreedhar – appointed Honorary Advisor to BRICS Chamber of Commerce & Industry (BRICS CCI)
- BRICS CCI earlier inducted its newly elected Governing Body for term Apr 2026-Mar 2029
  - At its 14th Annual General Meeting – held in New Delhi (May 18, 2026)

News - 289

- Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir (Bangladesh Nationalist Party) – elected as Bangladesh's 23rd President
  - Defeated – Oli Ahmed (Bangladesh Jamaat-e-Islami)
- Bangladesh – Dhaka – Taka | President – Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir | PM – Tarique Rahman

Awards, Rewards, Recognition & Prizes

News - 290

- Prof Annapurni Subramaniam (Director of IIA, Bengaluru) – awarded "COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal for 2026"
  - She became 1st Indian woman scientist & 4th Indian overall to receive this prestigious international honour
  - She also became 3rd woman globally to receive this award
- She received medal at 46th COSPAR Scientific Assembly in Florence, Italy
- COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal – instituted in 1990 & is among highest international honours in space science
  - It is jointly awarded every 2 years by Committee on Space Research (COSPAR)
- Previous 3 Indian winners of this award: Former ISRO Chairman U.R. Rao (1996)
  - Space plasma & space weather physicist Gurbax Singh Lakhina (2014)
  - Anil Bhardwaj, Director of Physical Research Laboratory (2024)
- She also serves as Director of Centre for Nano & Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS)

News - 291

- R. Praggnanandhaa – clinched Grand Chess Tour (GCT) St. Louis Rapid & Blitz title at 'Saint Louis Chess Club'
  - 2nd – Sindarov | 3rd – Wesley So
- '2026 Saint Louis Rapid & Blitz' – 4th tournament overall on '2026 Grand Chess Tour' calendar & 3rd rapid-and-blitz leg of season (after Poland & Croatia)
- Total prize fund – $200,000 ($50,000 – awarded to winner)
- Praggnanandhaa earned $50,000 & 13 Grand Chess Tour points, moving him into 2nd place in overall GCT standings
  - 1st – Fabiano Caruana

News - 292

- Prof Karthikeyan Lanka (IIT Bombay) – selected for "National Academy of Sciences, India Young Scientist Award 2026"
- He currently serves as – an Associate Professor at Centre of Studies in Resources Engineering (CSRE), IIT Bombay

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News - 293

- President Droupadi Murmu presented Sant Kabir Handloom Awards & National Handloom Awards 2025
  - At Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre (RBCC) in New Delhi on Aug 7, 2026
- Total awards given – 22 awards (3 Sant Kabir Handloom Awards & 19 National Handloom Awards)
- Instituted under – 'Handloom Marketing Assistance component of National Handloom Development Programme'
- Sant Kabir Handloom Award – country's highest honour for handloom weavers
- Swadeshi Movement – formally launched on Aug 7, 1905
- She also released 4 commemorative postage stamps celebrating India's rich & diverse handloom weaving traditions

News - 294

- Deepak Dhar – awarded 2026 Dirac Medal by International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP)
  - Instituted in – 1985 | Awarded annually on Aug 8th
- He shares 2026 medal with 3 other physicists:
  - Bernard Derrida (College de France) | Marc Mezard (Bocconi University, Italy) | Haim Sompolinsky (Harvard University)
- Dhar's other honours include: Padma Bhushan (2023); Boltzmann Medal (2022); & Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Prize (1991)

News - 295

- Nitin Gadkari – conferred "Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak" on 12 rat miners
  - In recognition of their exceptional courage & selfless service during 'Silkyara Tunnel' rescue operation
  - It led to successful rescue of 41 workers trapped after tunnel's collapse in Uttarakhand in Nov 2023
- Investiture ceremony was held in New Delhi on Aug 5, 2026
- He presented each awardee with: a decoration medallion, a miniature medal & a certificate
  - A lump-sum monetary allowance of ₹2,00,000 was disbursed online
- Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak (India's highest civilian award for lifesaving) – instituted in 1961
- Minister of Road Transport & Highways: Nitin Gadkari | Constituency – Nagpur, Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: Ajay Tamta & Harsh Malhotra

News - 296

- Rotary Club of Madras East (RI District 3234) + CavinKare Pvt Ltd + MSSRF = presented "Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection 2026" in Chennai
  - Honouring 2 grassroots women changemakers for their community-led environmental work
- Awardees: P. Pechiyammal – for pioneering community-led conservation of Gulf of Mannar
  - Govindhammal – for transforming lives of thousands of smallholder farmers by championing sustainable agriculture
- This award is instituted by – Rotary Club of Madras East with CavinKare's support

Join us

News - 297

- GeM marked its 10th Foundation Day at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- Among state-level awardees: UP received – 'GeM Overall Excellence Award'
  - 'Highest GMV Since Inception Award' | 'Best Outreach Initiatives for Capacity Building Award'
- HQs of GeM – New Delhi | CEO – Mihir Kumar | Established in – 2016

News - 298

- National celebrations of 'World Elephant Day' 2026 – held at Visakhapatnam
- MoS for EF&CC – conferred "Gaj Gaurav Awards 2026"
- This year's awards recognised 7 mahouts from Jaldapara National Park, West Bengal
  - Bikash Kharia | Rajiv Oraon | Ajibul Haque | Ajit Gabur | Mumtaz Alam | Amasur Kheriya | Dilip Munda
  - 2 caregivers from Namdapha National Park & Tiger Reserve (Arunachal Pradesh) – Ganesh Tamang & Sumit Gogoi
- Project Elephant – launched in 1992 as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme, to conserve Asian elephant
- Asian elephant – listed as Endangered on IUCN Red List & is under Schedule I of Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972
- India holds about 60% of world's wild Asian elephant population across 33 Elephant Reserves
  - Elephant was declared India's National Heritage Animal in 2010
- Gaj Yatra – awareness campaign supporting corridor protection

News - 299

- Dr. Padma Gurmet (Director of NISR, Leh) – conferred "UT Ladakh State Award" for 2025
  - For his contribution to preservation, promotion & development of Sowa-Rigpa system of medicine in Ladakh, Leh
- Conferred by – Vinai Kumar Saxena (LG of Ladakh) | During – UT State Awards ceremony
- He was earlier conferred Padma Shri in 2026

News - 300

- President Droupadi Murmu presented "Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowships (Akademi Ratna)" & "Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards (Akademi Puraskar)" for years 2024 & 2025 – to 115 artists
  - At a special investiture ceremony held at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
- 7 artists were conferred 'Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship': Ramlal Bareth, A.V. Anand, Rita Ganguly, Puru Dadheech, Chittaranjan Jyotishi, Pasumarthi Rattaiah Sarma & Sudharani Raghupathy
- 2025 'Overall & Others' category included Shiv Narayan Jha (Kunal), Maneesha Sathe, Rakesh Sinha, Manjari Sinha & T.S. Nandakumar
- Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards – conferred since 1952
- Fellowship carries – a cash award of ₹3 lakh | Award carries – ₹1 lakh, a Tamrapatra & Angavastram

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News - 301

- 1,057 personnel from Police, Fire, Home Guard & Civil Defence & Correctional Services – awarded 'Gallantry & Service Medals'
  - Comprising: 301 Medals – for Gallantry | 92 President's Medals – for Distinguished Service (PSM)
  - 664 Medals – for Meritorious Service (MSM)
- Of 301 Gallantry Medals: 272 – to Police personnel | 29 – to Fire Service personnel
- Gallantry awardees served in areas facing security challenges, with: 197 – from Left Wing Extremism-affected areas
  - 51 – from J&K | 12 – from North-East | 41 – from other parts of the country
- Of 92 PSM awards: 83 – to Police Service | 4 – to Fire Service | 3 – to Civil Defence & Home Guard Service
  - 2 – to Correctional Service
- Of 664 MSM awards: 606 – to Police Service | 28 – to Fire Service | 18 – to Civil Defence & Home Guard Service
  - 12 – to Correctional Service
- Police Service – accounts for largest share of medals across all 3 categories this year

News - 302

- 9th National Anubhav Awards Ceremony, 2026 & 60th Pre-Retirement Counselling (PRC) Workshop – held at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
  - Organised by – Department of Pension and Pensioners' Welfare (MoPPG&P)
- Dr. Jitendra Singh – conferred 'National Anubhav Awards 2026' on 5 awardees & presented Jury Awards to 10 more
- 'Anubhav' platform – launched by DoPPW in Mar 2015
- Handbook on Pension Mitra & Guidelines for Nation-wide Digital Life Certificate Campaign-5 – released

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News - 303

- MoCA – organised "PMIS Industry Awards" in New Delhi, to recognise leading partner companies
  - For their contribution to successful implementation of pilot phase of Prime Minister Internship Scheme (PMIS)
- 'Overall Industry Champion' – Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd
- Sectoral Champions honoured included:
  - ONGC – in Oil, Gas & Energy | Dr. Lal PathLabs Ltd – in Healthcare
  - Tech Mahindra Ltd – in IT & Software Development | Larsen & Toubro Ltd – in Infrastructure & Construction
  - Central Coalfields Ltd – in Metals & Mining | DCM Shriram Ltd – in Agriculture & Allied | ITC Ltd – in FMCG
  - Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Ltd & Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd – in Pharmaceutical sector
- Among Top PSU Partners recognised: ONGC, NTPC Ltd & Western Coalfields Ltd
- Top Private Partner awards: Reliance Industries Ltd, Infosys Ltd & Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Ltd
- Pre-Internship Excellence Award – HDFC Bank | Internship Management Excellence Award – Shriram Finance Ltd
- Innovation in Program Implementation Award – IBM India Pvt Ltd | Innovation in Exit Pathways Award – PGCIL
- Minister of Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

Join us

News - 304

- Gen Dhiraj Seth – conferred 'Honorary Rank of General of Nepali Army' by Ramchandra Paudel (Nepal President)
  - During an investiture ceremony at Sheetal Niwas (Shital Niwas), Kathmandu
- Since 1950, India & Nepal reciprocally confer honorary rank of General on Chiefs of each other's Armies
  - General K.M. Cariappa – became 1st Indian Army chief to receive this honour
- General Dhiraj Seth – also received a ceremonial Guard of Honour at Nepali Army Headquarters
- Nepal – Kathmandu – Nepalese Rupee | President – Ram Chandra Poudel | PM – Balendra Shah

News - 305

- Total 210 Indian peacekeepers (including 6 women & 7 staff officers) – awarded UN Medal in Juba, South Sudan
  - For their exceptional service with United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS)
- India – 2nd-largest contributor of uniformed personnel to UN peacekeeping
  - India currently deployed more than 4,200 military & police personnel, including around 155 women
  - As of Apr 2026, India was top troop contributor to UNMISS, with 1,775 Indian military personnel deployed
- In 2007, India became 1st country to deploy an all-women contingent to a UN peacekeeping mission
  - An all-women Formed Police Unit sent to Liberia
- UNMISS – established in 2011
- HQs of UN – New York City, US | Secretary General – António Guterres

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News - 306

- Pakistan nominated 2 Mumbai-based Parsi doctors for Nishan-e-Imtiaz, posthumously
  - For maintaining confidentiality over founder Muhammad Ali Jinnah's terminal illness during Partition in 1947
  - Doctors – Dr. Jal Ratanji Patel (physician) & Dr. Jal Dhaybho-Koo (radiologist)
- Pakistan's Awards Committee is chaired by – Ahsan Iqbal (Pakistan's Federal Minister for Planning, Development & Special Initiatives)
- It will formally be conferred at a ceremony in Mar 2027
- Pakistan previously conferred Nishan-e-Imtiaz on Indian actor Dilip Kumar in 1998
- Pakistan – Islamabad – Pakistani Rupee | PM – Shehbaz Sharif | President – Asif Ali Zardari

News - 307

- Dr. Ashutosh Parida – selected for 47th "Sarala Puraskar" for his 2024 poetry collection "Bishwas De Pruthwi"
  - Published by – Prabha Publication | Instituted in 1980 by Indian Metals Public Charitable Trust (IMPaCT)
- Final shortlisted collections (7): "Aparna Mohanty ka Payeen Kabita" – by Aparna Mohanty
  - "Dahana Pada Bama Pada" – by Padmaja Pal | "Sita" – by Archana Nayak | "Mayabarta" – by Bijay Nayak
  - "Mokhya Mudra" – by Prakash Mahapatra | "Kabi ka Naam Bedbyash" – by Ramesh Prasad Panigrahi
- Dr. Parida – to receive a citation, a copper plaque & a cash prize of ₹7 lakh at a ceremony in Bhubaneswar in Oct'26

Join us

- Guru Durga Charan Ranbir (Odissi maestro) & Damodar Behera (sculptor) – conferred with Ila-Bansidhar Panda Kala Samman 2026
  - Announced by – IMPaCT | Each will receive – a citation, a copper plaque & a cash prize of ₹2.5 lakh

News - 308

- Kaziah Liz Mejo (Kerala) – crowned "Miss Universe India 2026" at grand finale held at Zee Studios, Jaipur
  - She was crowned by – Manika Vishwakarma (previous Miss Universe pageant)
  - She will also represent India at 75th Miss Universe pageant, to be held in Puerto Rico in Nov 2026
- Jury for finale included Sushmita Sen, Urvashi Rautela, Celina Jaitly, Rhea Singha & Pragya Kapoor
- Runner-ups: 1st – Vaishnavi Ganesh (Tamil Nadu) | 2nd – Anushri Satavlekar (Gujarat)
  - 3rd – Tejaswini Shrivastava (Maharashtra) | 4th – Anubha Vashisth Chaudhary (Uttarakhand)

News - 309

- DSEL (Ministry of Education) – selected 48 school teachers for "National Teachers' Awards 2026"
  - To be conferred by President Droupadi Murmu at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, on Sep 5, 2026
- 48 selected teachers (26 male & 22 female) represent – 27 states, 7 UTs & 6 Central Govt Org.
- Highest awardees – UP (3) | Maharashtra & Rajasthan – also feature multiple recipients each

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Schemes & Initiatives

News - 310

- Chhattisgarh launched "DWEEPTI Yojana", a framework placing women's SHGs at centre of rural rooftop solar expansion
  - DWEEPTI – Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion
- Jointly developed by – state's Panchayat & Rural Development Department and Transform Rural India
  - Under – Green Economy Transition Mission
- Chhattisgarh – 1st state in India to adopt a women-led distributed renewable energy policy
- Chhattisgarh: Capital – Raipur | CM – Vishnu Deo Sai | Governor – Ramen Deka

News - 311

- Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY) – launched on Jul 1, 2015
  - To ensure water security & sustainable irrigation for Indian farmers
- GoI approved its continuation for period 2021-26 | Outlay – ₹93,068.56 Cr
  - Union Budget 2026-27 allocated ₹6,587 Cr to this scheme
- Under its Per Drop More Crop (PDMC) component, 110.92 lakh hectares have been brought under micro-irrigation
- Under its Accelerated Irrigation Benefits Programme (PMKSY-AIBP), 71 of 123 projects had been completed

Join us

- Cabinet approved Modernization of Command Area Development & Water Management, as a sub-scheme of PMKSY
  - For period 2025-26 | Initial outlay – ₹1,600 Cr | Aim: To modernise irrigation water supply networks

News - 312

- Cabinet approved 'Samudra Manthan', a Central Sector Scheme of MoP&NG
  - Phase-I outlay – ₹84,084 Cr for implementation through FY31
- India – world's 3rd-largest consumer of crude oil | Annual import bill – $144 billion
- It comprises 3 major components:

  (i) Offshore data acquisition | Outlay – ₹28,534 Cr

  (ii) Offshore exploration & infrastructure-led production | Outlay – ₹55,200 Cr

  (iii) Monitoring & support activities | Outlay – ₹350 Cr
- Samudra Manthan aims to increase India's domestic oil & gas production to 80 MMTOE annually
  - From – 62 MMTOE (Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent)
- It aims to expand country's hydrocarbon resource base to 2.2 billion TOE (from 1.6 billion TOE (Tonnes of Oil Equivalent))

News - 313

- Cabinet approved "Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY)"
- It is a Central Sector Scheme for development of Floating Solar PV projects integrated with Energy Storage Systems (ESS)
  - Total financial outlay – ₹5,070 Cr
  - Projects under this scheme will be sanctioned between FY27 & FY31
- India currently has only around 700 MW of installed floating solar capacity
- India's floating solar potential – 102.18 GWp (Gigawatt-peak) across reservoirs & other suitable inland water bodies
- Eligible floating solar projects will receive Central Financial Assistance of ₹1 Cr per MW after successful commissioning
  - Developers can additionally avail up to ₹50 lakh per project to conduct feasibility studies

News - 314

- Cabinet approved continuation of "Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN)" Scheme for 5 years, until FY31
  - Total financial outlay – ₹3,15,614 Cr
- PM-KISAN – launched in Feb 2019
  - Eligible landholding farmer families will receive annual financial assistance of ₹6,000 (in 3 equal instalments)
- Women farmers have received more than ₹1.06 lakh Cr under PM-KISAN

News - 315

- 47,328 villages – selected under "Adarsh Gram Component of Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyuday Yojana"
- PM-AJAY – being implemented by GoI to promote socio-economic development of SC communities
  - Specifically, it focuses on achieving saturation of 50 monitorable socio-economic indicators across 10 sectors

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News - 316

- "Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rojgar Yojana (PM-VBRY)" – completed 1 year of implementation as of Aug 1, 2026
  - Total financial outlay – ₹99,446 Cr
- Nearly 30% of beneficiaries are women & 15 lakh+ beneficiaries have already received employment-linked incentives
- PM-VBRY operates under a 2-part incentive framework:
  - 1st-time employees earning up to ₹1 lakh per month are eligible for a one-time incentive equal to 1 month's EPF wage, capped at ₹15,000
  - Employers receive up to ₹3,000 per month for 2 years for each eligible additional employee retained for at least 6 months
- It is implemented through a fully digital platform integrated with EPFO

News - 317

- Every ₹1 invested under "Kisan Credit Card-Modified Interest Subvention Scheme (KCC-MISS)" generates ₹2.30 in net value addition in agriculture & allied sector
- Assessment was conducted by – Institute for Social & Economic Change (ISEC), Bengaluru
  - Commissioned by – Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- Estimated subsidy outlay – ₹1.87 lakh Cr provided since inception up to 2024-25
- Number of operative KCC accounts – increased to 7.28 crore in 2025-26 (from 7.15 crore in 2021-22)
  - Outstanding loan amount in same duration – rose to ₹10.08 lakh Cr (from ₹8.15 lakh Cr)
- Outstanding KCC loans for animal husbandry – rose to ₹60,997 Cr in 2025-26 (from ₹15,216 Cr in 2021-22)
- Collateral-free loan limit under KCC – rose to ₹2 lakh (from ₹1.6 lakh)
- KCC-MISS – a Central Sector Scheme to make farm credit affordable through Kisan Credit Card (KCC)
  - It provides short-term crop & allied sector loans up to ₹3 lakh at a subsidized 7% interest rate
  - Promptly repaying farmers get an extra 3% incentive

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News - 318

- PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana – crossed milestone of 50.06 lakh households benefiting from rooftop solar installations
- It was launched in Feb 2024 with a total outlay of ₹75,021 Cr
- ₹28,024 Cr in subsidy has been released directly to beneficiaries through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)

News - 319

- Cabinet approved "GOBARdhan (Galvanizing Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan), National Circular Bioenergy Scheme"
  - Total outlay – ₹23,731 Cr | It will be implemented over a 10-year period, from FY27 to FY36
  - Administered by – Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas
- It creates one integrated platform across entire CBG value chain, structured around 6 "growth engines":
  - Assured CBG offtake | A stable CBG pricing framework | Capital assistance

Join us

- Development of pipeline infrastructure | Credit guarantee support | A CBG ecosystem challenge fund

- It also introduces a stable administered CBG price of ₹2,110 per Metric Million British Thermal Unit (MMBtu)
  - Backed by a government pricing framework with a minimum 10-year horizon

News - 320

- MoIB – approved a Central Sector Scheme titled 'Broadcasting Infrastructure and Network Development' (BIND)
  - For development, modernisation & upgradation of Prasar Bharati's broadcasting infrastructure across India
- Minister of Information & Broadcasting: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha

  MoS in Ministry of Information & Broadcasting: Dr. L. Murugan

News - 321

- As of Aug 6, 2026, total expenditure incurred under 'National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM)' – ₹292 Cr
- NGHM – approved by Cabinet in Jan 2023 with an initial outlay of ₹19,744 Cr
  - Aim: To establish green hydrogen production capacity of 5 Million Metric Tonnes (MMT) per annum by 2030
- Its outlay comprises: ₹17,490 Cr – for Strategic Interventions for Green Hydrogen Transition (SIGHT) programme
  - ₹1,466 Cr – for pilot projects | ₹400 Cr – for R&D | ₹388 Cr – for other Mission components
- Under SIGHT programme, 3,000 MW per annum of electrolyser manufacturing capacity is awarded to 15 companies
  - 756,100 tonnes of green hydrogen production capacity – allocated to eligible firms
  - 4 pilot projects – sanctioned for use of hydrogen in steel sector
  - VOC Port Authority – awarded a project to develop a bunkering & refuelling facility for green methanol
  - Shipping Corporation of India – awarded a project to acquire a dual-fuel ship capable of running on green methanol
  - 12 pilot projects – sanctioned for deployment of 70 hydrogen-fuelled vehicles & 16 hydrogen-refuelling stations
  - 4 projects – awarded as Hydrogen Valley Innovation Clusters (HVICs), spanning Jodhpur, Odisha, Pune & Kerala

News - 322

- MoWCD is providing creche services through Anganwadi cum Crèches (AWCCs) under 'Palna Scheme'
  - With 3,130 AWCCs operational across India as on Mar 31, 2026 (from 1,761 operational AWCCs on Apr 2025)
- Palna Scheme – introduced by MoWCD under 'Samarthya Vertical of Umbrella Mission Shakti' w.e.f. Apr 1, 2022
  - To provide day-care crèche facilities & protection to children
- It operates through 2 delivery modes:
  - Standalone Crèches – run independently, each staffed by 1 crèche worker & 1 helper catering to up to 25 children
  - Anganwadi cum Crèches (AWCCs)
- Palna is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme implemented with funding ratio:
  - In all states/UTs – 60 (centre) : 40 (states/UTs)
  - In North-Eastern & Special Category States – 90 (centre) : 10 (states/UTs)
  - In Union Territories without a legislature – 100% (Centre)

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- Minister of Women & Child Development: Annpurna Devi | Constituency – Kodarma, Jharkhand
  MoS in Ministry of Women and Child Development: Savitri Thakur

News - 323

- MoSJE is strengthening rehabilitation framework for persons engaged in begging
  - Under – Support for Marginalized Individuals for Livelihood & Enterprise (SMILE) Scheme
  - Aim: To realise Government's vision of a "Bhiksha Vritti Mukt Bharat" (Begging-Free India)
- SMILE-Beggary sub-scheme – currently operational in 216 cities across India & target to expand to 295 cities up to FY31
- To strengthen implementation, MoSJE enhanced digital monitoring through SMILE-Beggary National Portal
- Minister of Social Justice & Empowerment: Dr. Virendra Kumar | Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment: Ramdas Athawale & B. L. Verma

News - 324

- Centre disbursed ₹19,216.46 Cr during last 3 FYs towards various scholarship schemes for SC students
  - Administered by – Department of Social Justice & Empowerment
- Total amount disbursed under such schemes – increased to ₹6,921.39 Cr in 2025-26 (from ₹6,094.48 Cr in 2023-24)
- Scholarship schemes covered include: Post Matric Scholarship for SC Students
  - Pre-Matric Scholarship Scheme for SCs & Others | Top Class Education Scheme (TCS)
  - National Overseas Scholarship (NOS) Scheme for SC & other eligible candidates
- During last 3 FYs, amount disbursed under various schemes:
  - ₹17,224.63 Cr – under Post Matric Scholarship for SC Students
  - ₹1,469.92 Cr – under Pre-Matric Scholarship Scheme for SCs & Others
  - ₹304.29 Cr – under Top Class Education Scheme
  - ₹217.62 Cr – under National Overseas Scholarship Scheme
- Under Post Matric Scholarship Scheme for SC students, amount received by different states (in 2025-26):
  - Tamil Nadu – ₹1,034.94 Cr | Maharashtra – ₹1,095.80 Cr | Uttar Pradesh – ₹617.64 Cr
- Under Pre-Matric Scholarship Scheme for SCs & Others, amount received by Tamil Nadu (in 2025-26) – ₹121.49 Cr
- Post Matric Scholarship for SCs and Pre-Matric Scholarship for SCs & Others – Centrally Sponsored Schemes
- National Overseas Scholarship and Top Class Education Scheme for SCs – Central Sector Schemes

News - 325

- MHI – amended "PM Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-DRIVE)" scheme
  - It extended demand incentives for electric two-wheelers (e-2Ws) until Mar 31, 2028
- Centre sanctioned an additional ₹1,000 Cr specifically for e-2Ws after MoF's approval for extended funding
  - Allocation earmarked for this segment – rose to ₹2,767 Cr (from ₹1,772 Cr)
- Under revised structure, incentive for e-2Ws – reduced to ₹2,500 per kWh, capped at ₹5,000 per vehicle

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- From incentive of ₹5,000 per kWh, capped at ₹10,000 per vehicle, applicable during FY25
- Electric scooters and motorcycles with an ex-showroom price of up to ₹1.50 lakh remain eligible for incentive
  - Capped at 15% of vehicle's ex-factory price, whichever is lower
- Overall outlay of PM E-DRIVE scheme – raised to ₹11,900 Cr (from ₹10,900 Cr)
- Last date for submitting e-2W claims to MHI or implementing agency – Dec 31, 2027
  - No payments will be made after – Mar 31, 2028
- In Jun 2026, MHI also expanded PM E-DRIVE to cover electric ambulances, allocating ₹500 Cr across FY27 & FY28
- PM E-DRIVE – replaced earlier FAME-I, FAME-II & Electric Mobility Promotion Scheme (EMPS) 2024 programmes
  - Aim: To accelerate EV adoption, expand charging infrastructure & strengthen India's EV manufacturing ecosystem
- Minister of Heavy Industries: H. D. Kumaraswamy | Constituency – Mandaya, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Heavy Industries: Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa Varma

News - 326

- 100 beneficiaries of "PM Vishwakarma Scheme" from Delhi-NCR region were invited as "Special Guests"
  - To witness 80th Independence Day Ceremony at Red Fort, Delhi, on Aug 15, 2026
- Invited beneficiaries are associated with 18 traditional trades covered under PM Vishwakarma scheme
- PM Vishwakarma Scheme – launched on Sep 17, 2023
  - It offers end-to-end aid including skill training, toolkits, collateral-free credit & incentives for 18 traditional trades

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News - 327

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan – approved financial assistance totalling ₹605.71 Cr for Rajasthan & Telangana
  - Under 'Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (PM-RKVY)' & 'Krishonnati Yojana (KY)'
- Rajasthan – allocated ₹340.59 Cr, comprising: ₹216.12 Cr – under RKVY | ₹124.47 Cr – under KY
- Telangana – allocated ₹265.12 Cr, comprising: ₹157.66 Cr – under RKVY | ₹107.46 Cr – under KY
- Rajasthan: Capital – Jaipur | CM – Bhajan Lal Sharma | Governor – Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde
- Telangana: Capital – Hyderabad | CM – A. Revanth Reddy | Governor – Shiv Pratap Shukla

News - 328

- Karnataka Cabinet – approved "Sandhya Kiran" contributory cashless healthcare scheme
  - For State Government pensioners below 70 years, family pensioners & their eligible dependent family members
  - It has been formulated under regulations of Ayushman Bharat-Arogya Karnataka (AB-ArK) scheme
- It provides cashless access to secondary, tertiary & emergency medical treatment of up to ₹5 lakh per eligible family per year on a floater basis, at hospitals empanelled under scheme
- Contribution of pensioners (of their basic pension): Service pensioners – 1.25% | Family pensioners – 0.75%
- As per AB-ArK policy, treatment cost to be met: 70% – from beneficiaries' contributions | 30% – from state gov's share
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

Join us

News - 329

- GoI launched Central Bank Digital Currency-based Direct Benefit Transfer in Chandigarh and Dadra & Nagar Haveli
  - Under – Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY)
- Eligible PMGKAY beneficiaries will receive their food subsidy directly into their CBDC wallets
- With this launch, Chandigarh and Dadra & Nagar Haveli have become the 1st UTs in the country to achieve complete digital adoption of CBDC-based food subsidy transfers for all eligible PMGKAY beneficiaries

News - 330

- AB-PMJAY health insurance scheme – launched in West Bengal, making it 36th State/UT to implement this scheme
  - Suvendu Adhikari (WB CM) – launched this scheme at Netaji Indoor Stadium, Kolkata
  - August 16 – to be observed as Ayushman Bharat Day (Ayushman Diwas)
- Under this scheme, eligible families will receive cashless health coverage of up to ₹5 lakh per year
  - It covers treatment for around 1,950 types of diseases
  - Coverage extended from 3 days before hospitalisation to 15 days after discharge
- All citizens aged 70 & above qualify automatically regardless of income
- Beneficiaries will have access to nearly 14,000 empanelled hospitals across India
- AB-PMJAY – launched nationally by PM Modi, in Sep 2018, as world's largest public health insurance scheme
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

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News - 331

- D.K. Shivakumar (Karnataka CM) – announced a new initiative called "Vidyarthi Sahayahasta"
  - Aim: To expand access to professional education for students from rural government schools
- Students who have studied in rural government schools from Class I to X will be provided 7.5% reservation within existing 15% rural reservation for admission to professional higher education courses, including medicine & engineering
- He announced 2 major education initiatives under theme "Your era: A new era": AI Akshara Abhiyana & Coding Gurukul
  - Under which AI education will be introduced from Class VI onwards in all schools across state
- State's 1st public AI University – to be established in Bengaluru | AI Certificate Courses – to commence by Jan 2027
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 332

- GoI approved "Incentive Scheme for Promotion of Domestic PNG Connections", w.e.f. Sep 1, 2026
  - Aim: To accelerate expansion of domestic PNG connections & making clean, safe & affordable cooking fuel accessible to more households
- Resulting savings could reduce payback period for investments in domestic PNG connections to ~3 yrs (from 10 yrs)
- India is world's 2nd-largest LPG importer, meeting about 60% of its LPG requirement through imports
- Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Hardeep Singh Puri | Constituency – Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Suresh Gopi

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News - 333

- C. Joseph Vijay (TN) – announced a fivefold increase in annual coverage under CMCHIS to ₹25 lakh per beneficiary family
  - From – ₹5 lakh | CMCHIS – Chief Minister's Comprehensive Health Insurance Scheme
- CMCHIS – introduced by Tamil Nadu government on Jul 23, 2009
  - It provides cashless treatment for eligible families in empanelled hospitals
- Broader set of healthcare & welfare measures include:
  - Coverage will be expanded to include specialised medical & surgical services for transgender persons at 7 govt medical college hospitals, spanning Chennai, Tirunelveli, Thoothukudi, Chengalpattu, Tiruvarur, Dharmapuri & Kanniyakumari
  - ₹300 Cr – approved for 400-bed multi-super-speciality hospital of international standards in Perambur, North Chennai
  - Paid maternity leave – extended to 365 days for female government employees having a 3rd child
  - A full waiver of cooperative farm loans of up to ₹75,000 was announced for more than 1.38 lakh farmers
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 334

- MeitY – notified "Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS)" with ₹62,500 Cr outlay
  - to boost global competitiveness, Domestic Value Addition (DVA) & development of Indian mobile phone brands
- MPMS (5-year scheme from FY2026-27 to FY2030-31) – succeeds PLI-LSEM, which ended on March 31, 2026
- TS1 – for India-registered mobile manufacturers/EMS firms with minimum ₹10,000 Cr turnover in FY2025-26
  - incentives 2.25%-5% of eligible sales
  - TS1 eligibility: Existing brands must achieve annual sales ≥₹5,000 Cr above FY2025-26 baseline
    - New brands eligible after reaching ₹10,000 Cr annual India sales
- TS2 – reserved for Indian brands with minimum ₹1,000 Cr turnover in FY2025-26
  - 5% incentive + additional 3% for design & R&D in India | Up to 1-year gestation period
- Indian brand criteria – trademark & IP retained in India, >51% Indian citizen control, and domestic design & research
- Both segments can earn up to 1.5% for domestic sourcing of key components/sub-assemblies
- Scheme targets – cumulative mobile phone production of ~₹39 lakh Cr and ~60,000 direct jobs during tenure
- India – world's 2nd-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume
  - 99.2% of domestically used mobile phones manufactured in India

News - 335

- Odisha – launched "Bidesh Sikhyabruti" scholarship scheme (in Nov 2025)
  - To provide financial assistance to SC & ST students pursuing postgraduate & PhD studies at top-ranked foreign universities
  - Under Mukhyamantri Medhabi Chhatra Protsahan Yojana (MMCPY)

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- Formally inaugurated by Suryabanshi Suraj (Higher Education Minister) & implemented from 2025-26 academic year

- Applications are invited twice a year, in July-August & December-January
  - For the current cycle, applications were open from August 18 to 31, 2026
- Under this scheme, 50 meritorious SC & ST students are selected annually for admission to academic programmes at institutions ranked among Top 200 in QS World University Rankings at time of application
  - Eligible students – from families with an annual income of up to ₹12 lakh
- Of 50 annual scholarships: 10 (4 PG & 6 PhD) – for engineering & technical education
  - 10 (4 PG & 6 PhD) – for medical, agriculture, architecture & other technical streams
  - 30 (10 PG & 20 PhD) – for higher education more broadly
- A student may avail scholarship only once, either for a postgraduate or a PhD course
- Each beneficiary receives financial assistance of up to ₹25 lakh per annum
- Odisha – became 1st state in India to implement a universal free education policy from KG to PG
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

Meetings, Conferences and Summits

News - 336

- BRICS Tourism Ministers' Meeting – concluded in Jaipur, Rajasthan
  - It concluded with adoption by consensus of 'BRICS Tourism Ministers' Communique 2026', aka "Jaipur Declaration"
  - Aim: To strengthen tourism cooperation among member countries
  - Theme – "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"
- It sets out 4 priority areas for cooperation: AI & Tourism | Sustainability & Responsible Tourism
  - Tourism Skilling & Capacity Building | Tourism Exchanges & Seamless Travel Facilitation
- BRICS Members (11): Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia & Indonesia
  BRICS Chairmanship 2026 – India

Ranks, Reports & Surveys

News - 337

- "BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026" – jointly prepared by BIMCO + ICS
- India – world's 2nd-largest supplier of seafarers, contributing 311,936 maritime professionals to global shipping industry
  - 1st – Philippines
- India's share of global seafaring workforce – rose to 12.16% in 2026 (from 5.2% in 2015)
- Of India's total contribution: 140,718 are officers – accounting for 13.41% of world's officer workforce

Join us

News - 338

- As per a report released by Competere Foundation: India – ranked 57th in global rankings (from 82nd in 2010)
  - Report title – 'India's Next Growth Frontier: Reducing Anti-Competitive Market Distortions to Build on India's 2010-2023 Reform Progress'
- It evaluates market distortions across 3 pillars; property rights protection, domestic competition & international competition
- 'India's Reform Trajectory, Market Distortions and the Next Frontier for Growth and Competitiveness' – held at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi
  - Organised by = Centre for Trade & Investment Law + Competere Foundation for Trade & Competition Policy

News - 339

- "2026 Candere Hurun India Women Leaders List" (2nd edition) – unveiled by Candere by Kalyan Jewellers + Hurun India
  - recognising 117 women across 12 categories
- 5 Pillars – Wealth creation, Value creation, Impact, Culture & Startups
- Categories – Business, Sports, Journalism, Literature, Fashion, Social Impact, Startup Leadership & Digital Media
- Category leaders: Priya Nair (Professional CEOs), Roshni Nadar Malhotra (Wealth Multipliers), Avani Lekhara (Olympic & Paralympic Medallists), Sudha Murty (Authors), Preetha Reddy & Suneeta Reddy (Veterans), Meena Bindra (Indian Fashion & Lifestyle)
- Rajni Bector (Bectors Food Specialities) – oldest honouree at 86 | Sheetal Devi (para-archer) – youngest at 19
- Self-made leaders – 98 of 117 honourees (84%)

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News - 340

- "Environmental Performance Index (EPI) 2026" – released biennially by researchers from Yale & Columbia universities
- Estonia – ranked 1st globally with a score of 74.79 | Followed by – Luxembourg, UK, Finland & Netherlands
- India – ranked 176th with a score of 22.46 (2nd-lowest-ranked country) | Last – Laos with a score of 21.78
- It assessed countries on 47 environmental indicators spanning 12 issue categories across 3 broad policy objectives:
  - Environmental Health (25%) | Ecosystem Vitality (45%) | Climate Change mitigation (30%)
- India's performance in 3 policy objectives:
  - Environmental Health – ranked 174th in both Air Quality & Biodiversity
  - Climate Change – 130th | Waste Management & Sanitation – 141st in both

News - 341

- ZSI completed India's 1st comprehensive Catalogue of Lepidoptera (Butterflies and Moths) | Prepared under – MoEFCC
- It documented 13,703 species of butterflies & moths found across India
  - Spanning 3,705 genera, 240 subfamilies, 102 families & 31 superfamilies
- India's 13,703 recorded Lepidoptera species account for ~8.25% of all known Lepidoptera species worldwide

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- Most species-rich moth subfamily – Geometroidea with 2,205 species across 479 genera, 13 subfamilies & 4 families in India
  - It represents about 8.8% of world's known Geometroidea species
  - Followed by – Ennominae (895 species), Larentiinae (565 species) & Geometrinae (309 species)
- HQs of ZSI – Kolkata, West Bengal | Director – Dr. Dhriti Banerjee | Established in – 1916

News - 342

- "Reimagining Care: Strategies for Empowering Caregivers in Viksit Bharat@2047" report – released by NITI Aayog
- Key recommendations:
  - To establish a 'National Caregiver Council' to regulate & accredit caregivers, standardise training & certification
  - To develop a 'National Caregiving Qualification Framework' to standardise education, training, accreditation & certification
  - It calls for a National Caregiver Registry & a digital platform for workforce planning & service delivery
  - It proposes to establish a National Digital Caregiving Portal to connect caregivers with care seekers
  - To expand social security & welfare measures & enable Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) for informal caregivers
- As per 'India Ageing Report 2023', India's elderly population – 149 million in July 2022 (10.5% of population)
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 343

- Shah Rukh Khan – topped Kroll India's "Celebrity Brand Valuation 2025" rankings with a brand value of $177.9 million
  - 2nd – Ranveer Singh ($162.9 million) | 3rd – Virat Kohli ($158.4 million) | 4th – Sachin Tendulkar ($125.9 million)
  - 5th – M S Dhoni ($115.3 million) | 6th – Alia Bhatt ($93.9 million) | 7th – Deepika Padukone ($89.2 million)
  - 8th – Hrithik Roshan ($88.9 million) | 9th – Amitabh Bachchan ($80.8 million) | 10th – Akshay Kumar ($80 million)
- Combined brand value of India's top 25 celebrity brands – $2 billion in 2025 (down 3.7% from 2024)

News - 344

- "2026 Barclays Private Clients Hurun India Most Valuable Family Businesses" list – released on Aug 11, 2026
- Mukesh Ambani family – India's richest business family for 3rd consecutive year, with a wealth of ₹25.8 lakh Cr
  - 2nd – Gautam Adani family (₹19.6 lakh Cr) | 3rd – Sunil Bharti Mittal (₹12.1 lakh Cr)
  - 4th – Kumar Mangalam Birla (₹8.14 lakh Cr)
- Among first-generation entrepreneurs: 1st – Gautam Adani family | 2nd – Sunil Bharti Mittal
- Collective worth of India's top 300 family businesses – ₹138 lakh Cr (up 27.5% since 2024)

News - 345

- 16th edition in India of "Randstad Employer Brand Research (REBR) 2026" – launched by Randstad India
- India's most attractive employer brand – Google | 2nd – Tata Group | 3rd – Amazon | 4th – Samsung India

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- 5th – Infosys | 6th – Reliance Industries | 7th – ITC Group | 8th – Hindustan Unilever
- 9th – Mahindra & Mahindra | 10th – Dell Technologies

- Top 5 core Employee Value Proposition (EVP) drivers for Indian workforce: Work-life balance – 60%
  - Equal opportunities – 59% | Career progression – 55% | Salary & benefits – 55% | Good reputation – 53%
- Workforce mobility for Indians: 46% – planning to change jobs within next 6 months
  - 32% – already changed employers in preceding 6 months
- Leading reason to leave an employer – Work-life balance (49%)
  - Followed by – lack of career growth (42%) & low compensation (41%)
- Most valued secondary benefit category overall – Career growth & development opportunities (90%)
  - Followed by – workplace comfort, flexible work arrangements, health & wellbeing, and retirement & financial security

News - 346

- "Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) Quarterly Bulletin for April-June 2026" – released by MoSPI
  - It is 5th quarterly bulletin in expanded series covering both rural & urban India since survey's redesigning
  - Prepared by – National Statistical Office (NSO)
- Overall Unemployment Rate (UR) for persons aged 15 years & above – 5.4%
- Overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) – 54.6% | Rural LFPR – 56.9% | Urban LFPR – 50.2%
- Worker Population Ratio (WPR) – 51.7%
- PLFS uses Current Weekly Status (CWS) approach, under which:
  - A person who worked for at least 1 hour during this last 7 days is counted as employed
  - A person who did not work but sought or was available for work for last 7 days is counted as unemployed
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

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News - 347

- "Key Sectors to Position India as a Global Manufacturing Hub" report – released by NITI Aayog
- 4 high-potential sectors that can fuel India's ambition to become a global manufacturing powerhouse:
  - Chemicals | Textiles | Telecom & networking equipment | Solar photovoltaic (PV) manufacturing
- Assessment was carried out in 4 phases:
  - Shortlisting sectors based on domestic & global growth potential
  - Detailed assessment of market potential & competitiveness
  - Benchmarking international best practices adopted by top-performing countries
  - Formulating sector-specific, actionable recommendations
- On chemicals sector, domestic industry is broadly led by 3 key consumption segments:
  - Petrochemicals & organic chemicals | Specialty chemicals | Inorganic chemicals
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

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News - 348

- 3rd "India's Services Sector: Insights on Regulatory Regime in Professional Services" report – released by NITI Aayog
- Professional services account for nearly 1/4th of India's total services exports
- Professional & management consulting services – accounts for nearly 20% of total services exports in 2024-25
- India – world's 7th-largest services exporter in 2024 (with 4.3% share of global services exports)
- India's revealed comparative advantage in professional & management consulting services – rose to 3.0 in 2024
- India lacks a uniform regulatory regime across professions: medicine, law, accounting & auditing operate under detailed legal & institutional frameworks
- Engineering, landscape architecture & urban planning – remain lightly regulated or lack formal professional oversight
- It outlines a 4-pronged strategy to strengthen this sector: Harnessing emerging trends & technologies
  - Elevating professional services within wider services value chain
  - Adopting global best practices | Promoting continuous professional development
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 349

- White House report, "The Great Transshipment Scam" – prepared under direction of Peter Navarro (US trade adviser)
- It named India among more than 40 countries identified as part of a "shadow transshipment network"
  - It allows Chinese goods facing high US tariffs to enter American market through 3rd countries with lower tariff rates
- In 2018, 1st Trump administration imposed Section 301 tariffs on a range of Chinese products to address US trade deficit with China
- It estimates potentially illegal transshipment at – ~$60 billion
- Recently, US Senate voted to pass Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026
  - It authorises tariffs of up to 100% on world's 5 largest importers of Russian crude oil or natural gas
  - This category that includes both China & India
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 350

- "National Report on Deep-Sea and Distant-Water Fishery Resources of the Indian EEZ" – released by CMLRE in Kochi
- It consolidates nearly 4 decades of oceanographic research & 3 decades of systematic surveys
- The report examines species in mesopelagic, or "twilight zone," located between 200-1,000 metres below ocean surface
- It identifies several marine biodiversity hotspots & ecologically important areas & waters around Lakshadweep & A&N Islands
- Location of CMLRE – Kochi, Kerala | Head – Dr. R.S. Maheskumar

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News - 351

- "Brand Footprint India 2026" report – released by Worldpanel by Numerator
- Parle Products – India's most chosen in-home Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG) brand for 14th consecutive year
  - 2nd – Britannia | 3rd – Amul | 4th – Clinic Plus | 5th – Surf Excel
- Britannia – topped out-of-home (OOH) rankings | 2nd – Balaji | 3rd – Haldiram | 4th – Cadbury | 5th – Amul
- This report ranks 427 FMCG brands across food, home care, health & beauty, beverages, snacking & dairy
- Amul – topped in OOH beverage rankings | 2nd – Thums Up | 3rd – Frooti | 4th – Sprite | 5th – Maaza
- In in-home category: Balaji – entered top 10 for 1st time | Rin – returned to top 25 after 2 years
  - Campa (from Reliance Consumer Products) – recorded one of steepest gains in penetration

News - 352

- "Reimagining Skilling for Viksit Bharat@2047" report – released by NITI Aayog
- ~8.7 crore Indians aged 15 to 29 are classified as "NEET", Not in Education, Employment or Training
  - This means around 11% of India's 15-29 age group falls into the NEET category
- It classifies India's youth workforce & learners into 5 segments: Those attending school
  - Those pursuing tertiary education | Those engaged in formal & informal work | Women | NEET youth
- At national level, 65.4 Cr Indians are within labour force, while 79.6 crore remain outside it
- It recommended introducing 'Universal General Employability and Entrepreneurship Skills' from Class 6 to Class 12
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Kumar Lahiri

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Amount & Agreements

News - 353

- ADB – approved $850 million loan to support reforms under 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana'
- PMSGMBY aims to install rooftop solar systems for 10 million low- & middle-income households
- World Bank – earlier approved $890 million for PMSGMBY scheme
- PMSGMBY scheme – approved by Cabinet & launched by PM Modi on Feb 13, 2024 | Total outlay – ₹75,021 Cr
  - It provides households subsidy of ₹30,000 for installing 1 kW of solar capacity, ₹60,000 for 2 kW & ₹78,000 for 3 kW
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

News - 354

- ADB – approved $1 billion loan to support India's urban reform agenda under "Urban Transformation and Investment Program" for transforming cities into economic growth, innovation & livability hubs
- Programme supports implementation of Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) with MoHUA
  - includes additional $3 million technical assistance for effective UCF implementation

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- Programme focus – promotes resilient urban regeneration with safer & more inclusive environments for women & girls
- India's cities – generate nearly 70% of new jobs and contribute ~63% of GDP, projected to rise to 75% by 2030
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

News - 355

- REC Ltd & PFC Ltd – signed a Common Loan Agreement with Meja Urja Nigam Pvt Ltd (MUNPL)
  - For a total loan amount of ₹26,850 Cr to finance establishment of 2,400 MW Meja Thermal Power Project Stage-II
  - REC Ltd – serves as lead financer for venture
- MUNPL – a 50:50 JV between NTPC Ltd & Uttar Pradesh Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd (UPRVUNL)
- It comprises 3 Ultra-Super Critical units of 800 MW each (3×800 MW) equipped with an Air Cooled Condenser system
  - To be established at Meja Tehsil in Prayagraj, UP
  - Overall estimated project completion cost – ₹38,357.81 Cr
- HQs of REC Ltd – New Delhi | Chairman & MD – Jitendra Srivastava | Founded in – 1969
- HQs of PFC Ltd – New Delhi | CMD – Parminder Chopra

News - 356

- IBM + Together AI = signed a multi-year, $240 million agreement to build a large-scale AI inference cluster on IBM Cloud
- IBM will deploy a large cluster of 'Nvidia HGX B300' systems inside IBM Cloud
- HQs of Together AI – San Francisco, California, USA | Co-Founder & CEO – Vipul Ved Prakash | Established in – 2022
- HQs of IBM – Armonk, New York, US | CEO – Arvind Krishna | Founded in – 1911

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News - 357

- ADB approved a $230 million loan to modernise & expand water supply & sanitation infrastructure in Chennai
  - Under 'Chennai Climate-Resilient Water Security and Sewerage Project'
- Chennai will become 1st Indian city to implement a comprehensive ring-main water distribution system
  - It is a closed-loop network to maintain balanced water pressure & improve efficient water delivery
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

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Ordinance, Bills & Acts

News - 358

- Parliament – passed "Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026"
  - extending statutory protection to National Song "Vande Mataram" under 'Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971'
  - Introduced by – Nityanand Rai (Minister of State for Home Affairs)
- Amendment brings intentional insult or obstruction during rendition of Vande Mataram under criminal offence provisions, similar to protection for National Flag, Constitution & National Anthem
- Penalty – intentional prevention of Vande Mataram singing or disturbance during its rendition attracts imprisonment up to 3 years, fine or both | repeat convictions carry minimum 1-year imprisonment
- Vande Mataram – composed by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay in 1875 in Sanskritised Bengali
  - First published in 1882 in novel 'Anandamath' | accorded status of 'National Song' after Independence
- 'National Honour Act, 1971' – earlier covered disrespect to National Flag, Constitution & National Anthem but excluded Vande Mataram

News - 359

- Assam Legislative Assembly – passed "Assam Land and Revenue Regulation (Amendment) Bill, 2026"
- It amends 'Assam Land and Revenue Regulation, 1886' & builds on a 2nd Amendment Bill passed in 2024
- Under 2026 amendment, land sales & purchases within a 5 km radius of religious & cultural institutions older than 250 years are restricted exclusively to eligible categories
- Original inhabitant – a person whose family has continuously resided in protected area for at least 3 generations as of Jan 1, 2006
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

News - 360

- Droupadi Murmu gave her assent to "Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026"
- It mandates establishment of fast-track courts in every state & UT for expeditious trial of accused persons
  - Investigations into paper leak cases required to be completed within 2 months
  - Trials to conclude within 3 months of chargesheet being filed
- Individuals involved in paper leaks or unfair means in examinations – to face jail terms of 5 yrs (min.) & 10 yrs (max.)
  - Along with a fine of up to – ₹50 lakh | For organised crimes – min. sentence of 7 years & a fine of up to ₹10 Cr

News - 361

- Indian Parliament passed "Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026"
  - For stricter legal scrutiny of delayed birth & death registrations to curb fraudulent entries in official records

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- It amends 'Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969'

- Registrations sought between 1-2 years after a birth or death will require approval from DM, SDM or an EM with jurisdiction over that area
- Registration of births & deaths remains mandatory under this Act

News - 362

- MoRTH issued a draft notification proposing amendments to "Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989"
  - It introduces phased mandatory implementation of 'Vehicle-to-Vehicle' communication systems in new vehicles
- All newly manufactured L, M & N category vehicles produced on or after Oct 1, 2028, will be required to be fitted with V2V communication systems conforming to AIS-230 standard
- Category includes: 'L' category – 2-wheelers & 3-wheelers
  - 'M' category – passenger vehicles such as cars, SUVs & buses
  - 'N' category – goods vehicles & light commercial vehicles
- Standard is built around factory-installed On-Board Units (OBUs)
  - Using 'Cellular Vehicle-to-Everything (C-V2X)' technology operating in 5.875 GHz to 5.925 GHz frequency band
- Minister of Road Transport & Highways: Nitin Gadkari | Constituency – Nagpur, Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: Ajay Tamta & Harsh Malhotra

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News - 363

- MeitY amended Information Technology (IT) Rules, 2021, reducing deadline for social media intermediaries
  - To remove unlawful content from 36 hours to 3 hours
- It also introduces a formal legal definition of AI-generated material & mandate that intermediaries ensure clear labelling & traceable metadata for permissible AI-generated content
- Grievance response timelines have also been tightened:
  - Deadline for handling sensitive complaints – reduced to 2 hours (from 24 hours)
  - Timeline for other, general grievances relating to unlawful content – reduced to 36 hours (from 72 hours)
- Users dissatisfied with a platform's decision retain right to appeal through Grievance Appellate Committee (GAC) portal
- Failure to comply with these obligations may result in intermediaries losing their legal protection under Section 79 of Information Technology Act
- Under IndiaAI Mission, govt approved 13 projects linked to responsible AI
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

Join us

News - 364

- Parliament passed the "Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026"
  - It now awaits President's assent before becoming law
  - It amends Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (MSMED) Act, 2006
- Classification of MSMEs based on twin criteria of "Investment in plant/machinery" & "Turnover" has been incorporated into Act
- It introduces Online Dispute Resolution to help MSEs resolve disputes in a timely & cost-effective manner
  - It mandates that mediation in such disputes be completed within 90 days
- It also makes it mandatory for CPSEs to settle all procurement invoices through TReDS to improve MSME cash flows
- Number of MSMEs registered on Udyam portal – increased to 9.16 crore currently (from 1.65 crore as on Apr 1, 2023)

News - 365

- President Droupadi Murmu gave her assent to "Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026"
  - It grants National Song "Vande Mataram" same statutory protection as National Anthem "Jana Gana Mana"
- It amends 'Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971', bringing National Song within ambit of Section 3 of Act
- Offences are punishable with imprisonment of up to 3 years, a fine, or both
  - 2nd & every subsequent conviction attracts a minimum of 1 year's imprisonment
- Vande Mataram was written in Sanskritised Bengali in 1870s & 1st published in 1882 as part of Anandamath (novel)
  - Composed by – Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
- Vande Mataram will be sung from ramparts of Red Fort for 1st time during Independence Day function this year

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News - 366

- Parliament passed "National Co-operative Development Corporation (NCDC) (Amendment) Bill, 2026"
  - To amend 'National Co-operative Development Corporation Act, 1962'
- NCDC – a statutory organisation under Ministry of Cooperation established in 1963
- HQs of NCDC – New Delhi | MD – Pankaj Kumar Bansal

News - 367

- Parliament passed "Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026" | It replaces 'Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021'
- It establishes a 'National Tribunals Commission'
  - To be chaired by – a former Judge of Supreme Court or a former Chief Justice of a High Court
- It sets a fixed term of five years or up to a specified age limit for chairpersons & members

News - 368

- GoI announced a regulated electronic exchange for trading major minerals, to be operational from next financial year
  - Coal & mineral exchanges are expected to become operational within next 8-9 months

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- Ministry of Mines – published 'Mineral Exchange Rules, 2026', designating IBM as primary supervisor
  - Responsible for registering exchange platforms & auditing trading ecosystem
- 1st phase of trading will cover iron ore, limestone, manganese & bauxite
- Centre will regulate major minerals, such as coal, limestone, iron ore, copper, manganese & bauxite
  - State governments will continue to oversee 49 minor minerals, including building stones, ordinary clay & sand
- Bill also removes existing 50% ceiling on sale of minerals produced from captive mines after end-use requirements met
  - It proposes a 1-time extension of leased area for deep-seated minerals occurring 200m+ below surface
  - By up to 30% under a composite licence & up to 10% under a mining lease
- Principal law governing mineral development in India – 'Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957'

News - 369

- Lok Sabha passed the "Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026" by voice vote
  - It empowers Centre to permit banks & payment service providers to levy charges on UPI & other notified electronic payment modes
- Amendment reworks Section 10A of 'Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007'
  - It will now allow charges on "one or more electronic modes of payment as Central Government may" notify
  - It removes existing legal restriction on Merchant Discount Rate (MDR)
- Bill also amends 'Income Tax Act, 2025' & 'Finance Act, 2026'
- UPI recorded 23.66 billion transactions in Jul 2026 | Worth – ₹29.88 lakh Cr

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News - 370

- DGFT – amended "Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023" with immediate effect
  - To allow exporters to receive overseas payments in Indian rupees while retaining eligibility for FTP benefits
  - As an additional payment mechanism alongside existing system based on freely convertible currencies
- Exports to any country other than Nepal, Bhutan & members of Asian Clearing Union (ACU), for which proceeds are realised in rupees through approved banking channels, will qualify for FTP benefits & count towards fulfilment of export obligations on par with exports realised in foreign currency
- For exports to ACU member countries, contracts must use currencies determined by ACU
  - Nepal & Bhutan are treated separately – with export contracts generally required to be denominated & settled in Indian rupees or in accordance with RBI directions
  - ACU member countries – Bangladesh, Iran, Maldives, Myanmar, Pakistan & Sri Lanka
- Exports financed through EXIM Bank or GoI lines of credit can also be invoiced in Indian rupees
- HQs of DGFT – New Delhi | Director General – Lav Aggarwal | Established in – 1991

Join us

News - 371

- MCA notified "Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Amendment Rules, 2026", in exercise of powers granted under Section 133 read with Section 469 of Companies Act, 2013
  - It introduced amendments to 'Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015'
- Amendment rules update 5 Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS):
  - Ind AS 101 (First-time Adoption of Indian Accounting Standards)
  - Ind AS 107 (Financial Instruments: Disclosures) | Ind AS 109 (Financial Instruments)
  - Ind AS 110 (Consolidated Financial Statements) | Ind AS 7 (Statement of Cash Flows)
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships

News - 372

- Central University of Kerala (Kasaragod) + Indian Navy = an MoU to promote academic collaboration, interdisciplinary research & knowledge exchange between two institutions
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar
- Kerala: Capital – Thiruvananthapuram | CM – V D Satheesan | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

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News - 373

- FSID + C-DOT = an agreement to establish a new Centre of Excellence (CoE) at Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru
  - To accelerate research, innovation, capacity building & commercialisation of advanced communication technologies
- It is C-DOT's 5th Centre of Excellence in India
  - Earlier centres established at – IIT Kanpur, IIT Gandhinagar, IIT Roorkee & IIT Hyderabad
- HQs of C-DoT – New Delhi | CEO – Rajkumar Upadhyay | C-DoT works under – DoT (Ministry of Communications)
- HQs of FSID – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Prof. B. Gurumoorthy | Established in – 2020

News - 374

- DoT + MP = an MoU to establish India's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ), Phase-I, at Gwalior, MP
- It will be implemented through a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) | Stake sharing between MP & DoT – 51% : 49%
  - Master Developer – Madhya Pradesh Industrial Development Corporation (MPIDC)
- Centre is providing 100% funding support for Phase-I, with an allocation of ₹493 Cr for developing core infrastructure
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

Join us

News - 375

- MoTA + CSIR-NBRI = a 3-year MoU to drive tribal welfare, foster sustainable livelihoods & preserve traditional knowledge
- All field assessments & research activities will require Prior Informed Consent of local Gram Sabhas & tribal communities
  - In full compliance with Biological Diversity Act, 2002
- Minister of Tribal Affairs: Jual Oram | Constituency – Sundergarh, Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Tribal Affairs: Durgadas Uikey

News - 376

- DAY-NRLM (MoRD) + PCI India = an MoU to strengthen women-led enterprises through public procurement & market-linked enterprise development
  - DAY-NRLM – Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Rural Livelihoods Mission
- A National Resource Cell – to be established under DAY-NRLM | With technical support from – PCI India
  - Aim: To strengthen procurement-linked enterprise ecosystems across State Rural Livelihood Missions
  - This cell is also referred to as a Public Procurement & Business Model Support Cell
- Minister of Rural Development: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Rural Development: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani & Kamlesh Paswan

News - 377

- NSDC + AVPL International = to establish 350 Advanced Skill Centres for Drone Technology across India in next 3 years
- The rollout will begin with 75 Advanced Skill Centres in the 1st year
- HQs of NSDC – New Delhi | CEO – Arun Kumar Pillai | Chairman – A. M. Naik (works under MoSDE)
- HQs of AVPL International – Gurugram, Haryana | Co-Founder & Chairman – Deep Sihag Sisai | CEO – Himanshu Sharma

News - 378

- Odisha + DBN + DoT + BSNL = signed tripartite agreement for rollout of amended 'BharatNet Phase-III' programme in Odisha with investment of ₹3,384.82 Cr
- BharatNet Phase-III – aims to connect all 6,799 gram panchayats in Odisha through fibre-based broadband network, covering 50,000+ villages with digital connectivity
- Programme focus – strengthen access to digital education, healthcare, e-governance & rural economic activities under Digital India Mission
- BSNL – designated as Single Project Management Agency (SPMA)
  - Creative Newtech Pvt Ltd – appointed as Project Implementing Agency (PIA)
- Odisha Govt + C-DAC = an MoU for collaboration in emerging technologies, AI, cybersecurity, research & digital governance for secure delivery of government services
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati
- HQs of BSNL – New Delhi | CMD – Robert Jerard Ravi

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News - 379

- Tamil Nadu Govt – signed 4 MoUs expected to generate 2,920+ direct & indirect jobs across the state
- Chubb Group (Switzerland) – to establish its 1st Global Capability Centre (GCC) in Tamil Nadu at Chennai
- Nordex Group (Germany) – to establish 1st R&D centre in Tamil Nadu at Chennai for renewable energy technology engineering & research
- MotiveLink (South Korea) – to establish auto-components manufacturing facility at SIPCOT Industrial Park, Pillaipakkam, Kancheepuram district with investment of ₹300 Cr
- University of Western Australia (UWA) – to establish 1st India campus at Velachery, Chennai (investment - ₹125 Cr)
- UWA campus – 1st international university campus in Tamil Nadu under UGC's 'Foreign Higher Educational Institutions in India Regulations, 2023'
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 380

- Ministry of AYUSH + IndiaAI = an MoU to accelerate AI-driven innovation across the sector
  - To harness emerging technologies to strengthen research, digital health, capacity building & innovation
- MoS (I/C) in AYUSH: Jadhav Prataprao Ganpatrao | Constituency – Mehkar, Maharashtra
- CEO of IndiaAI Mission – Saurabh Vijay

News - 381

- 56th Foundation Day of Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) Ltd at Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, Maharashtra
- Giriraj Singh launched 'Kapas Darshan' Bulletin to provide cotton farmers with timely advisories
- 4 MoUs were signed during this programme:
  - CCI + ICAR-CIRCOT = an MoU for capacity building & quality improvement in ginning & pressing sector
  - CCI + GIZ (Germany) = an MoU to enhance market access for cotton farmers
  - ICAC + CITI + MERAGO/Geoclara = an MoU to promote carbon credit generation
  - TEXPROCIL + Manjeet Cotton Pvt Ltd = an MoU to collaborate under Kasturi Cotton Bharat programme
- CCI undertook one of the largest MSP procurement operations, procuring over 522 lakh quintals of seed cotton (kapas)
  - Nearly 24 lakh farmer transactions while directly transferring ₹41,530 Cr into farmers' Aadhaar-linked bank accounts
- MSP for seed cotton – increased by about 7% for Cotton Season 2026-27
- 'Cotton Productivity Mission - Kapas Kanti' – approved recently with an outlay of ₹5,659 Cr over 5 years
- HQs of CCI – Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra | CMD – Lalit Kumar Gupta | Established in – 1970
- Minister of Textiles: Giriraj Singh | Constituency – Begusarai, Bihar
  MoS in Ministry of Textiles: Pabitra Margherita

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News - 382

- Andhra Pradesh + Australia = 4 MoUs to strengthen bilateral cooperation across clean energy, advanced manufacturing, inclusive education, student mental health & skill development
- CoEET (IIT Tirupati) + University of New South Wales (Sydney) = an MoU to establish a Centre of Excellence for Solar Manufacturing at IIT Tirupati
- UNSW + Sri Padmavati Mahila Visvavidyalayam (SPMVV) + Samagra Shiksha Andhra Pradesh = an MoU to strengthen inclusive education by improving teachers' capacity to support children with autism & other neurodiverse learning needs
- APSCHE (Andhra) + Rebound (Australia) = an MoU to implement a technology-enabled pilot programme to support student mental health & well-being in selected higher educational institutions
- APSSDC (Andhra) + DLS (Australia) = an MoU to focus on vocational education, workforce development & industry-oriented training
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- Australia – Canberra – Australian Dollar | PM – Anthony Albanese

News - 383

- BEL + Esri India Technologies Pvt Ltd = MoU to collaborate on defence projects to strengthen India's defence capabilities
- HQs of BEL – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CMD – Manoj Jain
- HQs of Esri India Technologies Pvt Ltd – Noida, UP | MD – Agendra Kumar | Established in – 1996

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News - 384

- ASSOCHAM + Business France = an MoU to facilitate trade & investment opportunities between India & France
- ASSOCHAM + IACCIA = an MoU to focus on promoting bilateral trade & investment between India & Arab world
- HQs of ASSOCHAM – New Delhi | President – Nirmal K. Minda | SG – Col Saurabh Sanyal | Established in – 1920

News - 385

- GVMC + Moscow = a Memorandum of Cooperation (MoC) to strengthen collaboration in smart city development, urban transport & digital innovation
  - During 5th International Transport Summit – held in Moscow
- Aim: To develop a modern, efficient & technology-driven urban transportation system in Visakhapatnam
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

News - 386

- C-DAC + GSI = an Umbrella MoU to strengthen collaboration in geoscience, mineral exploration & disaster management
- Aim: To accelerate discovery of critical minerals & Rare Earth Elements (REE)
- HQs of C-DAC – Pune, Maharashtra | Director General – Magesh Ethirajan (functions under MeitY)
- HQs of GSI – Kolkata, West Bengal | Director General – Smt. Varsha Ashok Aglawe | Established in – 1851

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News - 387

- Jupiter Wagons Ltd (Kolkata) + LRS (Italy) = partnered to establish India's 1st fully integrated private-sector railwheel manufacturing platform
- Stake in Jupiter Tatravagonka Railwheel Factory Pvt Ltd: LRS – 15% | SIMEST S.p.A. – 10%
  - This combined 25% investment is valued at – €28 million
- It combines an existing operational facility in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar
- Odisha expansion is backed by an investment of ₹2,500 Cr

News - 388

- PHL (MoCA) + Noemi Aerospace (Norway) = a non-binding MoU to explore collaboration in next-generation sustainable aviation technologies
- HQs of Pawan Hans Limited (PHL) – New Delhi | CMD – Sunil Kumar Nagdawne | Established in – 1985

News - 389

- LASPL + Massivit 3D Printing Technologies (Israel) = an MoU to establish India's 1st commercial installation of large-format additive manufacturing technology for composite tooling & critical aerospace components
- Lohia Aerospace will manufacture, finish & certify tooling through its AS9100D & NADCAP-certified facilities
- HQs of Lohia Aerospace Systems (LASPL) – Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh | CEO – Anurag Lohia | Established in – 2019

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News - 390

- DPIIT (MoC&I) – signed 5 strategic MoUs with industry leaders and ecosystem enablers
  - Cashfree Payments, Darwin Dynamics, Vultr India, Cars24 Services, & Council for Startup India (CSI)
- Aim: To expand access to digital infrastructure, technology, mentorship, investment and global markets for DPIIT-recognised startups and help them scale sustainably
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)

News - 391

- CCRAS + BIS = an MoU to jointly develop globally benchmarked quality standards & strengthen scientific research & conformity assessment across Ayush sector
- As of signing, BIS Ayurveda Sectional Committee manages 128 Indian Standards for traditional medicine sector
  - 243 Ayush standards have been developed across all Ayush domains over past 3 years
- Location of CCRAS – New Delhi | DG – Prof. Vaidya Rabinarayan Acharya
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

Join us

News - 392

- PMS Bazaar + NSDL Database Management Ltd = partnered to facilitate SEBI Accredited Investor certification process for eligible investors & entities
  - At 'PMS Bazaar Bengaluru Conclave'
- NDML Accreditation Agency – authorised to issue Accredited Investor Certificates
- HQs of PMS Bazaar – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Founder & Director – R. Pallavarajan
- HQs of NSDL Database Management Ltd – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sameer Gupte

News - 393

- MoSPI signed 2 MoUs with Institute of Data Engineering, Analytics & Science Foundation (IDEAS) & ISI, Kolkata
  - For undertaking research studies
- IDEAS will develop a desktop-based software tool for GDP Nowcasting
  - It is a technique used to estimate current economic growth in near real-time ahead of official data releases
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 394

- MSME + DPIIT = an MoU to accelerate commercialisation, quality standardisation & market penetration of India's GI products
- DPIIT – nodal department responsible for registration & legal protection of Geographical Indications in India
  - Under Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act
- They will facilitate onboarding of GI collectives & authorised users onto ONDC & Government e-Marketplace (GeM)
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)
- Minister of MSME: Jitan Ram Manjhi | Constituency – Gaya, Bihar
  MoS in Ministry of MSME: Shobha Karandlaje

News - 395

- Airtel Business + ITI Ltd = collaboration to help Indian enterprises accelerate digital transformation, strengthen cyber resilience & modernise legacy infrastructure
- HQs of Airtel Business – New Delhi | CEO – Sharat Sinha
- HQs of ITI Limited – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Chairman & Managing Director – Shri Rajesh Rai

News - 396

- DIBD (MeitY) + NITI Aayog = signed a Statement of Intent (SoI) to advance multilingual, voice-first AI solutions for inclusive governance under 'BHASHINI for Seva/Sanchalan' initiative
- Through BHASHINI Sahayogi, it will leverage BhashaDaan for collection, curation & dissemination of linguistic data
- This collaboration spans 5 flagship BHASHINI sub-programmes: BHASHINI Udyat | BHASHINI Mitra

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- BHASHINI AppMitra | BHASHINI Sahayogi | BHASHINI Pravakta

- HQs of Digital India BHASHINI Division – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag | Established in – 2022
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Kumar Lahiri

News - 397

- PCIM&H + IPC = renewed their MoU for 3 years to continue implementing 'One Herb, One Standard' initiative
- 1st MoU (signed in 2022) – PCIM&H and IPC jointly developed 50 monographs of medicinal plants during Phase 1
- HQs of IPC – Ghaziabad, UP | Secretary-cum-Scientific Director – Dr. V. Kalaiselvan | Established in – 2005
- HQs of PCIM&H – Ghaziabad, UP | Director – Dr. Raman Mohan Singh | Established in – 2010

News - 398

- India + SACU = signed ToR for negotiations towards a Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA) at Vanijya Bhawan, New Delhi
  - 5 member states of Southern African Customs Union (SACU) – South Africa, Namibia, Botswana, Lesotho & Eswatini
- HQs of SACU – Windhoek, Namibia | Chairperson (rotating) – His Honour Ndaba Nkosinathi Gaolathe (Botswana) | Established in – 1910

News - 399

- MCX + NISM = an MoU at 'Global Commodity Conclave 2026' to establish "MCX-NISM Centre for Commodity Markets"
  - Aim: To strengthen professional capability, research & responsible participation in India's commodity markets
- MCX holds a dominant market share in India's commodity derivatives segment, controlling:
  - 100% – of base metals | 99.61% – of energy | 100% – of precious metals trading
  - NCDEX – holds remaining 3.9% market share
- HQs of MCX – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Mr. C.S. Verma | MD & CEO – Praveena Rai | Established in – 2003
- HQs of NISM – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Director – Sashi Krishnan

News - 400

- BHEL + Hystar AS (Norway) = partnered to enable phased indigenisation & local manufacturing of Proton Exchange Membrane (PEM) electrolyser systems for green hydrogen projects in India
- HQs of BHEL – New Delhi | Chairman & MD – Koppu Sadashiv Murthy

News - 401

- DGPC (Bhutan) + JSW Neo Energy Ltd = signed a Shareholders' Agreement (SHA) in Thimphu, Bhutan
  - For joint development of 920 MW Punatsangchhu-III Hydroelectric Project in Wangdue Phodrang Dzongkhag
- It will be developed through a JV company (DGPC - 51% & JSW Neo Energy - 49%)
- JSW Energy reported a total locked-in generation capacity of 32.4 GW, comprising:
  - 14.9 GW – operational | 13.5 GW – under construction | 4 GW – pipeline

Join us

- Operating hydro portfolio – 1,781 MW (India's largest private hydropower generator)

- Bhutan – Thimphu – Bhutanese Ngultrum | PM – Tshering Tobgay | Monarch – Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck

News - 402

- Department of Mines & Geology (Andhra) + CSIR-NGRI = an MoU for a ₹140 Cr critical mineral exploration project
  - Focused on identifying lithium & gallium deposits in Vempalle & Thummalapalle areas of Kadapa Basin
- Preliminary studies conducted by – NGRI (in & around Thummalapalle)
  - Tummalapalle uranium mine – operated by Uranium Corporation of India Ltd (UCIL)
  - Project is funded under National Mineral Exploration Trust (NMET)
- National Critical Minerals Mission (NCMM) – approved by Cabinet on Jan 29, 2025 | Outlay – ₹34,300 Cr over 7 years
- Under mission, GSI has been tasked with conducting 1,200 exploration projects from 2025 to 2031
- Andhra Pradesh – created a special policy in 2025 for mining 30 critical minerals & 24 minor minerals
- Mines Department (Andhra) + IIT (ISM) Dhanbad-TEXMiN = agreement to establish a Centre of Excellence for mining research & skill development
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- HQs of CSIR-NGRI – Hyderabad, Telangana | Director – Dr. Prakash Kumar

News - 403

- NIIMH (Hyderabad) + SEMIRI (Kerala) = an MoU for systematic digitisation & preparation of a descriptive catalogue of SEMIRI's collection of medical manuscripts
- SEMIRI – preserved a vast collection of more than 30,000 manuscripts
- Digitisation will be carried out under CCRAS-NIIMH's "Collection, Digitization and Cataloguing of AYUSH Manuscripts and Rare Books" project
- Aim: To protect fragile originals from damage caused by repeated physical handling
- This is 2nd such CCRAS-NIIMH manuscript-digitisation MoU in 2026
  - 1st: CCRAS-NIIMH + Berhampur University (Odisha) = an MoU to digitise over 2,000 palm-leaf Ayurvedic manuscripts preserved at South Odisha Cultural Study Centre

News - 404

- ISMA + ICAR-ISRI (Lucknow) = an MoU to establish an 'Advanced Centre for Quality Sugarcane Seed Production'
  - For sugar mills in UP & wider subtropical sugarcane-growing region
  - Centre will be established at – ICAR-ISRI, Lucknow
- HQs of ISMA – New Delhi | President – Mandava Prabhakar Rao | Director General – Deepak Ballani

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News - 405

- Tata Power + IIT Bombay = signed a Master Research Agreement (MRA) at IIT Bombay campus
  - To accelerate scaling & commercialisation of lab-scale innovations in next-generation energy technologies & advanced clean energy solutions
- Tata Power currently holds a diversified portfolio across entire power value chain
  - Total operational & under-construction capacity – surpassed 26 GW
- HQs of Tata Power – Mumbai | Chairman – N. Chandrasekaran | MD & CEO – Praveer Sinha
- Director of IIT Bombay – Prof. Shireesh Kedare

News - 406

- RIL + Rolls-Royce = to partner on design, development, manufacturing & delivery of a sovereign indigenous combat engine for India's 5th-generation Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) programme
- They will explore forming a dedicated Aerospace Gas Turbine Complex in India
  - It will be positioned as a centre of excellence for power & propulsion technology
- Proposed engine is in 110-130 kN thrust class & reported to deliver more than 120 kilonewtons
  - It is intended to power more advanced AMCA Mk2 variant, with its production beginning in 2036
- AMCA – 1st fighter jet programme for which MoD opened manufacturing to private sector
- MoD approved AMCA Programme Execution Model in May 2025 | Aeronautical Development Agency – executing body
- Formal Requests for Proposals (RFPs) – issued to 3 shortlisted teams on May 27, 2026
  - Comprising: TASL bidding independently, a consortium of L&T & BEL, and a consortium of Bharat Forge & BEML
- AMCA Mk1 – to be powered by US-made GE F414 engine | It is expected to make its 1st flight around 2029
- HQs of Reliance Industries Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Mukesh Ambani | Founded in – 1973
- HQs of Rolls-Royce Holdings plc – London, UK | Chair – Dame Anita Frew | CEO – Tufan Erginbilgic

News - 407

- UNHCR + SICCI-UNHCR Partnership Forum + Ethiraj College for Women (Autonomous) = an MoU to strengthen collaboration in education, research & community engagement
  - To promote refugee self-reliance & inclusion in India, including Sri Lankan refugees residing in Tamil Nadu
- Department of Social Work at Ethiraj College for Women – to act as nodal department for coordinating & implementing collaborative activities
- HQs of UNHCR – Geneva, Switzerland | High Commissioner – Barham Salih | Established in – 14 December 1950

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News - 408

- PhonePe + DPIIT = an MoU to support DPIIT-recognised startups by offering transaction credits through its Payment Gateway & access to Indus AppStore
- PhonePe + MeitY = an MoU to share insights from PhonePe PulsePro to support PM GatiShakti mission for national infrastructure planning, economic analysis and urban & rural development
- PulsePro metrics – to be integrated into PM GatiShakti National Master Plan portal
  - It is managed in collab with Bhaskaracharya National Institute for Space Applications & Geo-informatics (BISAG-N)
- HQs of PhonePe – Bangalore, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Sameer Nigam | Founded in – 2015
- HQs of DPIIT – New Delhi | Secretary – Amardeep Singh Bhatia | Founded in – 1995 (Functions under Ministry of C&I)
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
  MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

News - 409

- Jindal Steel + IIT Hyderabad = an MoU to establish 1st-of-its-kind Jindal Steel Centre of Excellence (CoE)
  - At IITH campus in Kandi, Sangareddy, Telangana
  - For High-Strength, Value-Added & Value-Engineered Steel Products & Solutions
- HQs of Jindal Steel – New Delhi | Chairman – Naveen Jindal
- Director of IIT Hyderabad – Prof. Budaraju Srinivasa Murty

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News - 410

- Hardeep Singh Puri – signed 2 key agreements with Mauritius
  - 1st – a government-to-government MoU on oil & gas cooperation
  - 2nd: IOCL + STC (Mauritius) = a 5-year Sales & Purchase Agreement under which IOCL will supply Mauritius' entire import requirement of petrol (motor spirit), diesel (high speed diesel), marine gas oil & Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)
- India currently produces around 267-272 million tonnes of refined petroleum products annually from 23 refineries
- Mauritius also developed a National Biofuel Policy Framework supported by Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)
- Mauritius – Port Louis – Mauritian Rupee | PM – Navin Ramgoolam | President – Dharambeer Gokhool

News - 411

- Chhattisgarh signed 2 MoUs with BISAG-N & NLDSL to strengthen use of geospatial technology & integrated logistics data under 'PM GatiShakti' framework
- During PM GatiShakti & LEADS 2025 Dissemination Workshop – held in Raipur
  - Jointly organised by – Commerce & Industries Department (Chhattisgarh) & DPIIT
- Chhattisgarh: Capital – Raipur | CM – Vishnu Deo Sai | Governor – Ramen Deka
- Location of BISAG-N – Gandhinagar, Gujarat | DG – T P Singh | Founded in – 2003
- HQs of NLDSL – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | Chairman – Rajat Kumar Saini | Established on – 30 Dec 2015

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News - 412

- Forest Department (HP) + ISB-BIPP = a 5-yr MoU to unlock HP's estimated ₹22,600 Cr untapped forest & pastoral economy potential through science & technology-enabled governance
- ₹22,600 Cr in untapped value across 5 bio-resources: Amla – ₹8,700 Cr | Pine needles – ₹5,500 Cr
  - Wild mangoes – ₹4,800 Cr | Sal seeds – ₹2,400 Cr | Rhododendron flowers – ₹1,200 Cr
- 'Forest Intelligence Platform' – piloted in Palampur Forest Division, with data already used in Palampur's working plan
- Grazing portal – to be developed under Himachal Pradesh Grazing Policy, 2026
- HP: Capital – Shimla & Dharamshala | CM – Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu | Governor – Kavinder Gupta

News - 413

- Nagaland + Tvaksas Renewable Pvt Ltd (Pune, MH) = a 25-year Power Purchase Agreement (PPA) to develop a 20 MW solar power plant at Tizit in Mon district
  - It marks state's 1st private solar Independent Power Producer (IPP) initiative
- Project will be set up at – Lapa Lampong village in Tizit
  - It is proposed as a Phase-I development with a capacity of 20 MW, to be commissioned within 20 months
- Nagaland's present peak electricity demand – 203 MW | It is projected to rise to 482 MW by 2034-35
- Nagaland: Capital – Kohima | CM – Neiphiu Rio | Governor – Nand Kishore Yadav

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News - 414

- CBN + PHARMEXCIL = an MoU to promote legitimate pharmaceutical exports while strengthening regulatory oversight & preventing diversion of controlled substances
- India is globally recognised as "Pharmacy of the World" with its pharmaceutical exports grown to $31.11 billion in FY26
- CBN administers facilitation, regulatory & enforcement provisions of Narcotic Drugs & Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985
- CBN & PHARMEXCIL will develop a Voluntary Code of Conduct (VCC) for pharmaceutical exporters
  - It will remain voluntary & non-binding without creating additional statutory or financial obligations beyond existing laws
- HQs of CBN – Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh | Narcotics Commissioner – Dinesh Bouddh | Established in – 1950
- HQs of PHARMEXCIL – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Mr. Namit Joshi | Established in – 2004

News - 415

- UP + Yamanashi Prefecture (Japan) = signed 4 MoUs at 'Japan-India Business Networking Event'
  - at Indira Gandhi Pratishthan, Lucknow, as part of 5-day 'UP-Japan Investment Meet 2026'
- A ₹600 Cr fund declared by Kotaro Nagasaki (Yamanashi Governor) to support Yamanashi-based MSMEs investing in UP
- 4 MoUs:
  - 1st: Invest UP + Technical Training & Research Centre = to focus on technical training & workforce development

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- 2nd: UP Tourism Department + Japanese partners = to promote Buddhist-circuit tourism
- 3rd: Covered development of Japanese Global Capability Centres (GCCs) in Noida & Greater Noida
- 4th: UP Labour Department + Representatives of Yamanashi Prefecture = to ensure a consistent supply of Japanese-language-proficient workers to meet employment requirements in Japan

- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel
- Japan – Tokyo – Yen | PM – Sanae Takaichi

❖ Important Obituaries in August 2026:

- **Brigadier Basant Kumar Ponwar** (Retd) – an Army Veteran & Jungle Warfare Pioneer
  (He is a highly decorated 1971 India-Pakistan War hero and the visionary architect of India's modern counter-insurgency doctrine)
- **Nirmal 'Nimsdai' Purja** (Nepal) – a Record-breaking Mountaineer & former British-Nepali Soldier
- **Franco Baresi** (Italy) – a Football Legend & AC Milan Captain
- **Vishwa Nath Sharma** – Former (14th) Chief of Army Staff (COAS) of the Indian Army
- **Kailash Chandra Pant** – a Hindi Writer
  (Awards: Padma Shri in 2026, Sahitya Bhushan Samman, Nirala Sahitya Samman, Sahitya Shiromani Samman, & Sanskriti Gaurav Samman)
- **Dr. Dnyandeo Yashwantrao (D. Y.) Patil** – Former Governor of Tripura, Bihar, & West Bengal
  (Padma Shri in 1991)
- **Justice Manmohan Singh Liberhan** – a retired Indian Judge
  (He gained national prominence for heading the investigation into the 1992 Babri Masjid demolition.)
  (He served as the Advocate General for Haryana, was elevated as a judge to the Punjab and Haryana High Court in 1987, and later served as the Chief Justice of both the Madras High Court and the Andhra Pradesh High Court.)
- **Pradeep Rawat** – a Veteran Actor
- **Major General Sunil Kumar Razdan** (Retd) – India's first wheelchair-borne Army General
  (Kirti Chakra in 1995)
- **William F. "Bill" Rasmussen** – Visionary co-founder of ESPN
  (He was inducted into the Sports Broadcasting Hall of Fame in 2025.)
- **Raja Sen** – Acclaimed Bengali Filmmaker
  (3 National Film Awards, Indira Gandhi Lifetime Achievement Award in 2015)
- **Sankaramanchi Janaki** ("Sowcar Janaki") – Legendary South Indian actress
  (Padma Shri in 2022 | She acted in nearly 400 films spanning Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, and Malayalam cinema.)
- **Chandrashekhar Y. Shilpi** – a renowned Sculptor & Master Craftsman
  (Awards: National Handicraft Award in 2024, Karnataka Rajyotsava Award in 2014, Karnataka Shilpakala Academy Honorary Award in 2012)

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❖ Important One-liner Meetings, Conferences & Summits in August 2026:

- First Session of the India-Rwanda Joint Trade Committee (JTC) – **New Delhi**
  (Indian delegation was led by Amit Kumar)
- Bharat International Rice Conference (in Oct'26) – **New Delhi**
- Meeting of Heads of National Statistical Offices (NSO) of BRICS Member Countries – **Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh**
  (Theme - "Quality Statistics as Driver of Change")
- Global AI & Digital Summit 2026 (in Oct) – **Seoul, South Korea**
  (co-hosted by - World Bank Group)
- 9th edition of India Medical Device 2026 – **New Delhi**
  (Theme - "Towards Viksit Bharat: Advancing India as a Global Hub for Quality Medical Devices")
  (Organised by = Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers + FICCI)
- 2nd National Port Security Conference 2026 – **New Delhi**
- 17th Session of the Conference of the Parties (COP17) to the UNCCD – **Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**
  (Theme - "Restoring Land, Restoring Hope.")
- "Srijan: Voices from the Loom", a special gathering – **New Delhi**
  (Organised by - Ministry of Textiles)
- "IIHT SUTRA 2026: 1st National Conclave of the Indian Institutes of Handloom Technology" – **New Delhi**
  (Theme - "IIHTs: Weaving the Future of the Indian Handloom Sector – Educate • Innovate • Transform")
- National Conference on Affordable Housing Reforms - "Reimagining Affordable Housing: From Scheme to Sustainable Ecosystem" – **New Delhi**
  (Organised by - Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs)
- 4th Session of India-Namibia Joint Trade Committee – **New Delhi**
- 7th BRICS ICT (Information & Communication Technologies) Working Group Meeting – **Pune, Maharashtra**
- Meeting of Heads of BRICS Competition Authorities – **Udaipur, Rajasthan**
- 12th BRICS Environment Ministers Meeting – **New Delhi**
  (Presided over by - **Bhupender Yadav**)
- 5th edition of SEMICON India 2026 – **New Delhi**
  (Theme - "Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem")
- 7th Meeting of the BRICS Working Group for Cooperation in Information and Communication Technologies – **Pune, Maharashtra**
- 3rd edition of IIMA Healthcare Summit 2026 – **Ahmedabad, Gujarat**
  (Theme - "Advancing AI in Healthcare")

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❖ Some Important Species found in August 2026:

- "Pseudolaguvia khairii", a new Catfish species – discovered in Odisha
- "Ammachi's Cascade Frog", "Sendenyu Cascade Frog", "Beautiful Cascade Frog", 3 new species of cascade frogs – discovered in Tripura, Nagaland, West Bengal (respectively)

❖ Some Important Acquisitions & Mergers in August 2026:

- IRDAI approved the acquisition of Magma General Insurance by Patanjali Ayurved and the Dharampal Satyapal (DS) Group for nearly ₹4,500 crore. Patanjali Ayurved will acquire a 73.56% stake in Magma General Insurance, while the Dharampal Satyapal (DS) Group, the maker of Rajnigandha pan masala, will acquire a 24.5% stake from existing shareholders of the Adar Poonawalla Group, including Sanoti Properties, Celica Developers and Jaguar Advisory Services.

- NB Holdings Corporation, a wholly owned subsidiary of Bank of America Corporation (BoFA), will acquire a 49.9% stake in Jio Credit, the lending arm of Mukesh Ambani's Jio Financial Services (JFS), for ₹18,268.22 crore, or $1.9 billion, through a preferential allotment of equity shares and warrants.

- RBI officially approved the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) to increase its aggregate shareholding in HDFC Bank Limited up to 9.99% of the bank's paid-up share capital or voting rights.

- CCI officially approved Prudential Corporation Holdings Limited's proposal to acquire a 75% majority stake in Bharti Life Insurance Company Limited for an initial cash consideration of ₹3,500 crore (approximately $389 million).

- CCI approved Tata Steel's proposed acquisition of an additional 23% equity stake in TM International Logistics Ltd (TMILL). TMILL, a public limited company, is a 51:23:26 joint venture between Tata Steel, IQ Martrade and NYK Europe.

- Google has secured the winning $10 million bid at a bankruptcy auction to acquire the massive enterprise dataset of defunct Spirit Airlines. Google beat out AI recruitment firm Mercor, which placed the next-highest bid at $7.5 million.

- L&T (Larsen & Toubro) has signed a Share Purchase Agreement (SPA) to divest 100% of its equity stake in its wholly owned subsidiary, L&T Network Services Pvt Ltd (LTNSPL), to Vyoma for a total consideration of ₹30 crore.

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- India's Ranks in various Reports/Indexes
- Venues & Themes of All Important Meetings/Summits/Conferences (It includes some extra events too.)
- MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships in One-liner form
- Important Days & Themes
- Latest GDP Predictions by various organisations

Important Books & Authors	
"Bringing the Cheetah Back to India"	Prashant Agrawal
"Triumph of the Indian Republic" autobiography" (Released by - PM Narendra Modi)	Ram Nath Kovind
"Empress: The Definitive Biography of Sridevi"	Dhiraj U. Kumarr

Important Days	
August 1-7	World Breastfeeding Week (by WABA + WHO + UNICEF) (Theme - "Breastfeeding for a Sustainable start in Life: Strengthen What Works")
August 1-15	Swachhata Pakhwada 2026
August 1	World Lung Cancer Day (since 2012) (Theme - "Together Through Lung Cancer")
	7th Muslim Women's Rights Day (Muslim Mahila Adhikar Divas) (The day commemorates the enactment of "Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act, 2019".)
	World FinTech Day (The day commemorates the death anniversary of Cosimo de' Medici, an Italian Banker and politician, known as "Father of the Modern Banking System".)
	World Wide Web (WWW) Day
August 3	16th Indian Organ Donation Day (From 2010 to 2022, it was celebrated on 27 November. In 2023, it moved to 3rd August, to mark the anniversary of India's 1st successful heart transplant.)
August 4	National Bone and Joint Day (since 2012)
	International Clouded Leopard Day
August 6	2nd edition of International Day of Awareness of the Special Development Needs and Challenges of Landlocked Developing Countries (LLDCs)
	81st Hiroshima Day

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	(The day commemorates the atomic bombing of Hiroshima in Japan by the US in 1945. The bomb was nicknamed "Little Boy".)
August 7	National Javelin Day (A tribute to Neeraj Chopra's historic Olympic gold medal at Tokyo 2020)
	National Handloom Day (August 7, 1905, marked the start of the Swadeshi Movement at Calcutta Town Hall.)
	Sustainable Agriculture Day (by Maharashtra) (The day marks the birth anniversary of Bharat Ratna Dr. M.S. Swaminathan.)
August 8	Quit India Movement Day or August Kranti Diwas (The day marks the 84th anniversary of the launch of Quit India Movement in 1942.)
August 9	81st Nagasaki Day (The day commemorates the atomic bombing of Nagasaki in Japan by the US in 1945. The bomb was nicknamed 'Fat Man'.)
	UN International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples (Theme - "Honoring Indigenous Midwives: Safeguarding Life and Well-being")
August 10	World Lion Day (Theme - "Coexistence in a Changing Climate")
	World Biofuel Day
August 11	World Steelpan Day
August 12	World Elephant Day (Theme - "Bringing the World Together to Help Elephants") (India is home to nearly 60% of the world's wild elephant population, with 33 Elephant Reserves and 150 identified Elephant Corridors, as per the 2023 Report on Elephant Corridors in India)
	International Youth Day (Theme – "Different Contexts, Common Aspirations.")
August 13	International Left Handers Day (First held in 1976 by Dean R. Campbell, founder of the Left-handers Club.)
	World Organ Donation Day
August 14	Partition Horrors Remembrance Day (The annual memorial day honors the lives lost, immense suffering, and massive displacement of millions during the 1947 Partition of British India.)
August 15	India Day (declared by Boston, Massachusetts, US)
	80th Independence Day (marking the completion of 79 full years of freedom since breaking away from British colonial rule in 1947.)
	National India Hub Day (officially declared by Illinois Senate, US)
August 19	World Photography Day (Theme – "Home")
	World Humanitarian Day (Theme - "Honouring Fallen Humanitarians and Calling For Greater Protection of Health Care.")
August 20	Sadbhavana Divas or Harmony Day (It marks the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi.)
	World Mosquito Day (It is a commemoration of British doctor Sir Ronald Ross's discovery in 1897 that female anopheline mosquitoes transmit malaria between humans.)
	Akshay Urja Diwas or Renewable Energy Day (since 2004) (Initiated by - Ministry of New and Renewable Energy)
August 21	World Senior Citizen's Day

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	International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism (Theme - "Healing Through Memory")
August 22	International Day Commemorating the Victims of Acts of Violence Based on Religion or Belief (since 2019)
August 23	3rd National Space Day (It marks the historic anniversary of Chandrayaan-3's soft landing on the lunar south pole.)
	International Day for the Remembrance of the Slave Trade and its Abolition (by UNESCO)
August 26	International Dog Day
August 23-27	World Water Week (Theme – "Water for People and Progress")
August 27	World Lake Day
August 28	World Sanskrit Day
August 29	National Sports Day (to honor the birth anniversary of hockey legend Major Dhyan Chand)
	International Day Against Nuclear Tests
August 30	National Small Industry Day
	International Day of the Victims of Enforced Disappearances (Theme - "Victims First. Actions Now.")
August 31	International Day for People of African Descent (Theme – "Expanding the Human Rights of People of African Descent")

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